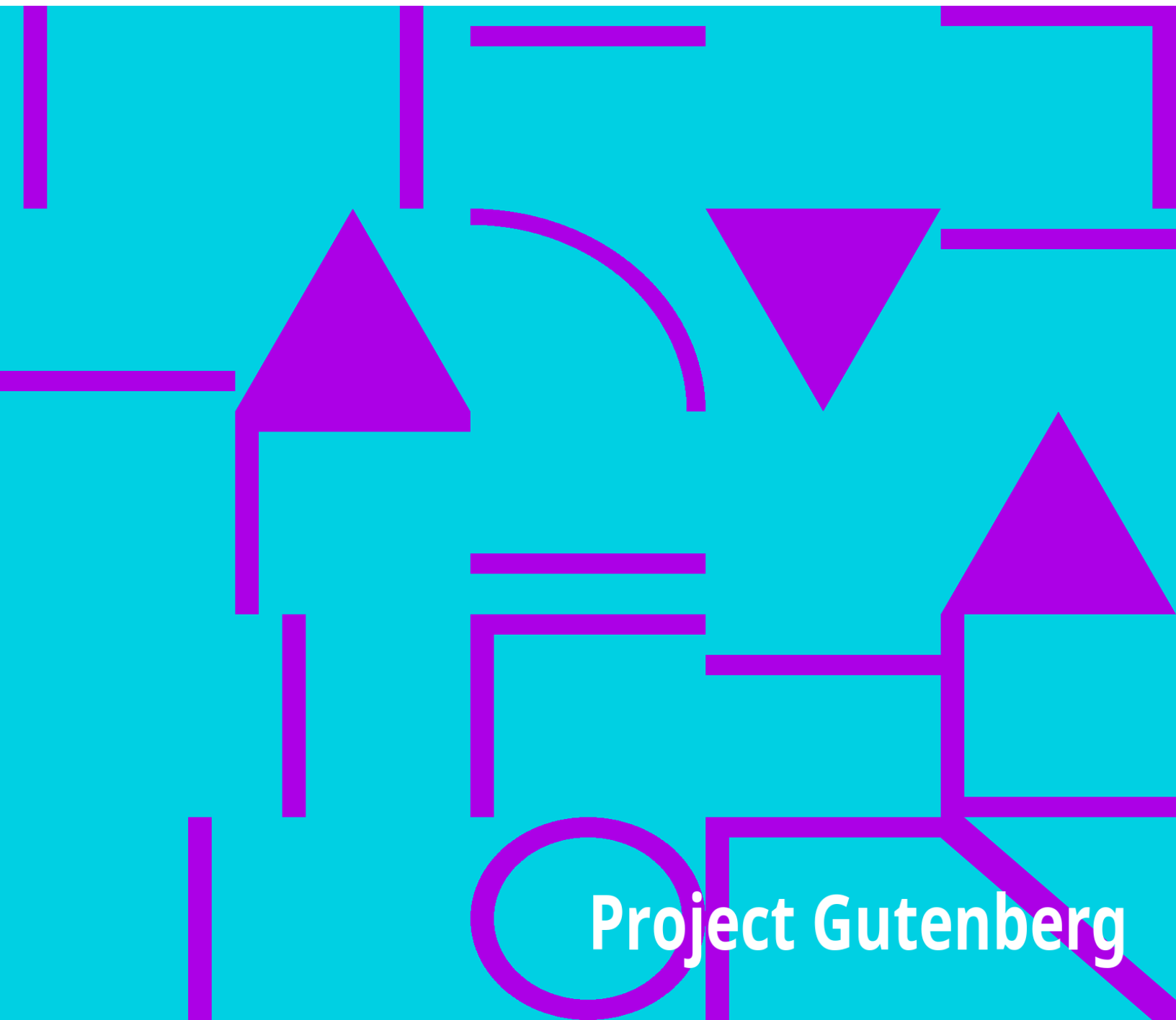


# The Praise of a Godly Woman

Hannibal Gamon

An abstract geometric pattern consisting of various red lines, triangles, and a circle on a black background. The lines are of different thicknesses and orientations, creating a complex, layered effect. Some lines form right angles, while others are diagonal or curved. A single circle is located in the lower-left quadrant of the pattern.

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# The Praise of a Godly Woman

Hannibal Gamon

An abstract geometric pattern composed of various shapes including triangles, squares, circles, and lines, all rendered in a vibrant cyan color against a white background. The shapes are scattered across the lower half of the page, creating a dynamic and modern visual effect.

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Title: The Praise of a Godly Woman

Author: Hannibal Gamon

Release date: November 16, 2008 [eBook #27280]

Language: English

Other information and formats: [www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/27280](http://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/27280)

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\*\*\* START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE PRAISE OF  
A GODLY WOMAN \*\*\*

Transcriber's notes:

Original spelling and punctuation were retained, including u/v and i/j substitution. Footnotes have been placed between paragraphs to make the html version easier to work with. Some of the Latin note text was illegible, many thanks to the Distributed Proofreaders Volunteers who helped look up the references in various internet sources.

# THE PRAISE OF A GODLY WOMAN.

A Sermon preached at the Solemne Funerall  
of the Right Honourable Ladie, the Ladie  
FRANCES ROBERTS, at *Lanhide-rock-Church*  
in *Cornwall* the tenth of  
August, 1626.

By

**HANNIBALL GAMON, Minister of the word  
of God, at S<sup>t</sup>. *Maugan* in the same Countie.**

*1 Cor. 4. 5.*

Therefore iudge nothing before the time, vntill the Lord come,  
who will bring to light the hidden things of darknesse, and will  
manifest the counsells of the hearts, and then shall euery man  
haue praise of God.

*Galath. 3. 28.*

There is { Neither Iew nor Greek,  
Neither Bond nor Free,  
Neither Male nor Female, for yee are all one in Chrift Iesus.

S<sup>t</sup>. Hierom. Eustoch.

—*In seruitute Christi nequaquam Differentia sexuum valet, sed mentium.*

Idem ad Principiam.

*Non facie vllam inter Sanctas Feminas Differentiam, quod  
Nonnulli inter Sanctos Viros & Ecclesiarum Principes, stulte  
facere confueverunt.*

LONDON,

Printed by *I.H.* for *Iohn Grismond*, and are to be sold at his shop in  
*Idie-Lane* at the signe of the Gunne. 1627.



TO THE TRVLV  
NOBLE IOHN ROBERTS,  
Son and Heire to the Right  
Honourable RICHARD *Lord* ROBERTS  
of *Truro*: the Vnualuable Riches of  
fincere Grace here, and of Eternall  
Glory hereafter.

HONOVABLE SIR,



Although it bee true (which a worthy Diuine<sup>[1]</sup> obferueth) that formall Hypocrites are heartned and hardned in their lewd courfes & falle conceits of happineffe, when they heare more infamous Sinners than themfelues, glorioufly and flatteringly commended at their Deaths; yet we need not feare any fuch bad effect by the Funerall-commendation of Gods true Saints; becaufe the publike Testimonie of their iuft Praifes doth not onely make the wicked more inexcufable, and the Glory of Gods Graces fhine farre brighter to Posteritie; but alfo enkindleth in the hearts of the godly a greater fire of Zeale for imitation. Thefe are fome of the Ends, why it hath euer been and is ftill an vnreprouable Cuf tome in Gods Church, that the Godly fhould be *Marked*<sup>[2]</sup> and *Honoured*<sup>[3]</sup> at their Deaths, as *Hezekiah* was by all *Iudah & Ierufalem*: *Valentinean*, *Satyrus* and *Theodofius* by Saint *Ambrofe*<sup>[4]</sup>: *Bafil*, *Gregory* and *Gorgonia* by *Nazianzen*<sup>[5]</sup>: *Nepotian*, *Paula* and *Marcella* by *S. Ierom*<sup>[6]</sup>. Had not their Holy Liues and Happie Deaths beene publifhed by fuch vnpartiall Pens, wee fhould haue bin ignorant now of many excellent Courfes of fanctified Men and Women, of many comfortable workings of the Holy Ghoft in them, and fhould haue wanted many inflaming Motiues to follow their religious fteps. Vpon this confideration I was bold to commend vnto Gods people the more than Ordinary paffages of your Honourable Mothers Holy Life and Death: wherein I haue as a Chriftian fpoken the truth of a Chriftian, that is, (as Saint *Ierom*<sup>[7]</sup> protefteth in a like cafe) made a true Narration; not a Vain-glorious Panegyrick. Let Poets and Oratours praife thofe women, which *Poppæa*-like<sup>[8]</sup>, are graced with all other things fauing a Gracious Heart: Let them commend their Wit, Wealth, Beautie, Nobilitie,

and other Gifts of Fortune (as they call them) in stead of Vertues<sup>[9]</sup>. Wee the Ministers of Christ, and Stewards of the Mysteries of God, must adorne none with the Honourable Attributes of Heauenly Praise; but such as are truly beautified, enriched, and ennobled with the Purity and Power of Gods Feare in their Humble Soules<sup>[10]</sup>. This praise the Lord will Prosper<sup>[11]</sup>, which is vttered in that *Wisdome*<sup>[12]</sup>, whereof the *Feare of the Lord is the beginning*. But for the Saints themselves: I dare say with Saint *Augustine*<sup>[13]</sup>, that they desire more the Imitation, than the Commendation of their vertues: and therefore to tell you the truth (as the same Father doth his friend) you should neuer haue heard mee commend this deceased Lady, but in hope, that Gods Graces in Her might by this meanes, suruiue in your religious Imitation, and not only in you and all them that are of Her bloud; but also in all them that haue heard or shall reade this Sermon. This is all the gaine I looke and pray for, that Gods<sup>[14]</sup> word, which I haue faithfully alledged (not without some Illustrations (I confesse) borrowed from the holy Fathers<sup>[15]</sup>, whereof I need not to be ashamed) may be constantly practised by vs all. For when all is done and said, assure your selfe (Deare Sir) it is only the Life of Grace, the Grace of the *Feare of the Lord* can truly Honour you, or any vpon earth, sweetly comfort you at your Death, and eternally Glorifie your Soule and Bodie in Heauen. Abandon then I beseech you in the name of Christ<sup>[16]</sup>, all iniquitie, and all workers of iniquitie, yea abominate the sweetest sin, to which your youthfull affections are most endeared, else you will neuer be able to encline and enlarge them to the pursuit and practise of so excellent and Glorious a Grace as the *Feare of the Lord*; because this godly Feare and the impenitent Allowance of any lust, is as incompatible as Heauen and Hell: so that if you should hate to be diuorced from your Bosome-sin whatsoeuer it be (which God forbid) you could haue no true right and interest to the precious promises of this and of that other life<sup>[17]</sup>. Thinke on this continually, and hold it your greatest Honour, the Noblest employment of your Soule, as it is indeed, to keep your selfe (as a King<sup>[18]</sup> did before you.) from your iniquitie. *Quod si tu (quod procul absit) nolueris, ego liber ero. Epistola, immo concio me hæc mea, cum lecta fuerit, absoluet.*<sup>[19]</sup> And so I rest, being mindfull of your Vertues,

*Saint Mauganthe*  
19. Auguft 1626.

Yours in all Christian Deuotion,  
and heartiest prayer to  
God for you,

HANNIBAL GAMON.

## FOOTNOTES:

[1] M<sup>r</sup>. Bolter Difc. of true Happineffe, p. 61.

[2] Pfalm. 37. 37. Deut. 34. 7, 10, 11, 12. Hebr. 3. 2. & 11. cap.

[3] 2 Chron. 32. 33.

[4] S. Ambr. tom. 3.

[5] Greg. Nazian. Orat. 30. Orat. 28. Orat. 25.

[6] S. Ierom. Ad Heliod. Ad Euftoch. Ad Princip. Ad Ocean.

[7] Testor Iesum cui illa feruiuit & ego feruire cupio, me utramq, in partē nihil fingere; sed quafi Christianū de Christianā quæ sunt vera proferre, id est, Hiftoriam scribere non Panegyricum. S. Ierom, Epitaph. Paulæ.

[8] Poppæa cuncta alia fuere præter Honestum animum. Tacit. Annal. l. 13.

[9] Laudauit ipse Nero apud rostra formam eius & quod diuinæ formæ parens fuisset, aliaque fortunæ munera pro Virtutibus. Id. Annal. l. 16.

[10] Esai. 61. 3.

[11] Ecclef. 15. 10.

[12] Prou. 9. 10.

[13] Epist. 125. where S. Augustine refuseth to commend vnto a wicked Husband his godly wife that was dead, not onely because she desired not his praise, saying: *Laudem ab hominibus iam illa non quærit, imitationem verò tuā tantum quærit etiam defuncta, quantum te dilexit etiam diffimilem viua*; but also because her Husband loued Her not, which he proueth thus: *Nam utiq si amares, cum illa effe post mortem desiderares, quod profectò non eris, si quālis es, talis eris.*

[14] Ier. 23. 22, 28. 1 Pet. 4. 11. Tit. 2. 8. 2 Tim. 2. 15. 1 Tim. 4. 13. & 6. 3.

[15] —*Ingenuo pudore qui ornabat ætatem, quid cuius esset, confiteri ... Illud (aiebat) Tertulliani, istud Cypriani, hoc Lactantij, illud Hilarij est. Sic Minutius Fælix, ita Victorinus, in hunc modum est locutus Arnobius. S. Ierom. ad Heliodor de Nepotian.*

[16] 2 Theff. 3. 6. 2 Tim. 2. 19. Prou. 4. 14. 1 Cor. 5. 11. Ephef. 5. 11. Pfalm. 26. 4, 5. & 119. 32, 36, 128. 2 Chron. 19. 2. & 20. 37.





## THE PRAISE OF A Godly Woman.

PROV. 31. 30.

—But a woman that feareth the Lord, *ſhee ſhall be praised.*



Praise is a Debt (ſaith *Gregory Nazianzen*<sup>[20]</sup>) and it muſt be paid, not to men alone, but to women alſo; yet not to euery woman, be ſhee neuer ſo noble, wittie, wealthy or faire<sup>[21]</sup>, vnleſſe ſhe be godly withall: For *fauour is deceitfull, and beautie is vaine; but a woman that feareth the Lord, ſhee ſhall be praised.*

A promiſe this is and affirmatiue,  
and an affirmatiue promiſe hath

The Diuiſion.

two parts in it. The firſt is the Partie to whom it is made, and ſhee is *Muliertimens Dominum*. A woman that feareth the Lord, which is alſo the reaſon why ſhe ſhall be praised: euen becauſe ſhe is a woman *fearing the Lord*. The ſecond is the thing promiſed, and that is *Laudabitur, ſhe ſhall be praised.*

### FOOTNOTES:

[17] 1 Tim. 4. 8.

[18] Pſal. 18. 23.

[19] S. Ierom. ad Caſtorin. Materteram.

[20] Orat. 25. fol. 439. Rom. 13. 7, 8.

[21] Non poſſumus reprehendere diuini artificis opus; ſed quem delectat corporis pulchritudo, multo magis illa delectet venuſtas, quæ ad imaginem, Dei eſt intus,

*non foris comptior. S. Ambr. Inſtit. Virg. c. 4. Prou. 11. 22. Eccle. 11. 2. ... Homo igitur mihi non tam vultu quam affectu admirand<sup>s</sup> emineat atque excellat: vt in his laudatur, in quibus etiam Deus prophetico iudicio laudatur de quo ſcriptum eſt Pſal. 66. 5. Terribilis in conſiliis ſuper filios hominum; cuius opera coram Deo luceant, qui bona iugibus operibus facta contexat. Id. ib. cap. 3.*

In the former, it is not enough that ſhe is a woman, becauſe euery woman is not *Timens*, one that *Feareth*, nor ſufficient that ſhe *Feareth*; becauſe euery woman that feareth is not *Timens Dominum*, one that *feareth the Lord*; but ſhe that ſhall be praised, is all three. 1. A woman by nature<sup>[22]</sup>, where the weaker her ſex is, the more ſhee ſhall be commended. 2. By Grace<sup>[23]</sup>, a woman that *feareth*, where the continuall act of this Fearing is required. 3. *That feareth the Lord*, where the right Object of her continuall feare is limited.

I.

And in the latter we are to conſider; Firſt, to what matters, *Laudabitur*, her praiſe will reach, and in what reſpect to *Ipfæ* Her perſon. Then ſecondly, When ſhe ſhall be praised; not for the preſent, perhaps, no more than ſhe hath beene heretofore; yet *Laudabitur*, the time will come when ſhe ſhall be praised, and then too her praiſe ſhall ſo be, that it ſhall be ſtill. Thirdly, of whom ſhee ſhall haue praiſe, for *Laudabitur* is an action, and muſt bee done of ſome agent, therefore we muſt finde who ſhall praiſe her, and they will fall out to be her Huſband and her Children (if ſhe haue them<sup>[24]</sup>) and if they faile in this dutie, then the godly ſhall praiſe her; and if they ceaſe to doe it, then her own workes ſhall praiſe her, yea rather than faile, God himſelfe ſhall praiſe her, which is beſt of all. So ſure ſhe is to be praised, not for the preſent onely, but for euer. And ſo this Text beſides that it is a *Promiſe*, it is alſo a *Motiu*e to ſtirre vs vp to feare God, that ſo we alſo may haue true and eternall praiſe of God. It is both, and both waies wee to haue vſe of it, as of a *Promiſe*, and as of a *Motiu*e: both theſe waies at once; *A woman that feareth the Lord ſhe ſhall be praised.*

II.

## FOOTNOTES:

<sup>[22]</sup> *Naturale vocabulū eſt Fæmina. naturalis vocabuli generale, Mulier.—Tert. de Virg. Veland. cap 4.*

[23] Aliud est Timere simpliciter, aliud Timere Deum—quippe timere & amare simpliciter prolata, affectione: cu<sup>m</sup> additamento autē virtutes significāt. Simples nempe affectiones insunt naturaliter nobis tanquam ex nobis, Additamenta ex Gratiā. S. Bern. de Grat. & lib. Arb.

[24] Mulier enim no naturā nomen est vxoris, sed vxor coditione nomen est mulieris. Tert. ib. c. 5. Gen. 2. 23. Hæc vocabitur mulier, quoniam de viro suo sumpta est: Quia sumpta est (inquit) de viro suo, non quia virum experta ... Non enim corruptelæ, sed sexus vocabulum est. Gal. 4. 4. Luke 1. 28. S. Ambr. ibid. c. 5.

A weake sex<sup>[25]</sup> to beginne with, and yet being strengthened by Grace<sup>[26]</sup>, no impediment; but that a woman as wel as a man may feare the Lord, and haue praise of him, and so become the partie who shall, and one Reason too, why *shee shall be praised*.

A Promise, and Motiue.

I.  
*The partie that shall be praised.*

For a woman must be more good than nature, art, policie, preferment can make her, else shee is not good enough for Gods Spirit to praise her. He commends neither men nor women considered in their pure Naturalls only, in that estate of corruption, they all heare alike to their disgrace, that they are *All vnder sinne*<sup>[27]</sup>, *All come*<sup>[28]</sup> *short of the glory of God*, and are *All the children of*<sup>[29]</sup> *wrath*, because they *Are without all feare of God*<sup>[30]</sup>

By nature then both sexes are alike faultie, alike discōmendable in Gods sight, and so they should be in ours. We should not dispraise women more than men, for the sex sake only (as some doe<sup>[31]</sup>) because they haue as noble soules as men, for<sup>[32]</sup> soules haue no sexes, (as Saint *Ambrose* faith) nor praise women for the endowments of the flesh onely (as other some doe<sup>[33]</sup>) vnlesse they be adorned also with the sauing Graces of the Spirit, whereof a chiefe one is not noble birth, great wealth, excellent wit, or rare beautie: but *the feare of the Lord*, his treasure.<sup>[34]</sup> This godly feare is that, that makes a Woman in relation<sup>[35]</sup> to God, praise-worthy. And good reason it should do so, if we regard the weaknesse of a woman, in whom so excellent a Grace as *the feare of the Lord*, is found, and the Noblenesse of fearing the Lord, being so found.

## FOOTNOTES:

[25] 1 Pet. 3. 7. Ier. 50. 37. Nah. 3. 13. Gal. 3. 27, 28.

[26] —*Ex parte natura (nisi fit fortitudo maioris gratiae) facilius incarnatur ad malum sexus formineus.* Bonau. L. 2. d. 21. q. 3. p. 18.

[27] Rom. 3. 9.

[28] Rom. 3. 23.

[29] Ephef. 2. 3.

[30] Rom. 3. 18.

[31] Eurip. Plutarc. *de Tranquilit Mulier quantibuis proba, Mulier tamen est.*

[32] *Anima enim sexum non habet.*—*De Virg. som. 1. lib: 3. fol. 99.*

First, a womans weaknesse is naturally<sup>[36]</sup> greater than the mans, and therefore by how much her flesh is weaker, and her spirit lesse willing, by so much the combate she hath, is more difficult, and the victory she gets, more commendable. I know a man (*Blesensis* by name) that thought two things should excuse him at the dreadfull day of iudgement, the Frailty of his flesh, and the Ignorance of his minde; but then he feared lest God would iudge men by womē, whose sex being more fraile, more ignorant than that of mens, were for all that oftentimes more holy, more deuout than many men.

Secondly, the *Feare of the Lord* is the truest Nobilitie (as *Gerfon*<sup>[37]</sup> proues) the noblest grace that can ennoble and extoll a man or a woman. Other naturall, ciuill, and meerely morall excellencies, perfections, and endowments a woman may haue, nay (which is neereft the point) other kindes of Feare she may haue, and yet be base, seruile, cursed as *Iezebel*<sup>[38]</sup>, not praise-worthy, as namely, if she feare men<sup>[39]</sup>, or what else besides more than God, or not for God (as Saint *Bernard*<sup>[40]</sup> limits) or if shee feare God as a Iudge, in respect of his punishments only<sup>[41]</sup>, & not as a Father for loue of his goodnesse, and from an hatred of wickednesse, or if she haue cast off the feare of the Lord, which shee hath seemed to haue, or if shee puts off his *Feare* from time to time, and continues not in it.

## FOOTNOTES:

[33] Cornel. Agrip. *de Nobilit. fæminei sexus.* Bocacius *de claris mulieribus.*

[34] Ef. 33. 6.

[35] Caiet. in. loc.

[36] *Naturaliter etiam maior lucti est inter carnem et spiritū mulieris quam viri: quantò enim caro eius infirmior, & spiritus minus promptus, tātò pugna difficilior—& victoria commēdabilior. Pet. Blef. ser. 33. p. 420. Timeo autem ne fortè viri à virginibus iudicentur: Comparatione tamē non Auctoritate: quia per duo tantum scilicet: per Fragilitatē carnis & Ignorantiam mentis putobā, &c. ser. 35. p. 428.*

[37] *Tractat. de Nobilitate, part. 2. p. 52. lit. E. Et Greg. Naz. Orat. 13. tom. I. fol. 352.*

[38] *2 Kings 9. 34. Act. 14. 25. 1 Ioh. 4. 18.*

[39] *Matth. 10. 28. Ef. 51. 12.*

Looke we then first to the Obiect of the *Laudable womans feare*, that he whom she feareth be the Lord, in respect of his Mercy and Iustice both; then to the continuall employment of her *Feare*, not one that hath feared him, or will feare him; but one that doth feare him for the present, and continueth therein, else shee is not a woman *Timens Dominum, Fearing the Lord*, and so not worthy to be *praised*.

First then (that the Obiect may be right) the<sup>[42]</sup> *Lord is her feare*, who shal be praised. For if He be not, all exquisitenesses besides are nothing in comparison; and if He be, all sufficiencies (remarkable in that sex) are improved, and all Duties (obserueable in the feare of the Lord) are practised. To see this the better, let vs follow *Tertullians*<sup>[43]</sup> rule, and oppose one against another, a vessell of dishonour against a vessell of honour, a woman not Fearing, against a woman Fearing the Lord.

I.  
*The Obiect of her  
feare.*

She that fears not the Lord, sets light by Gods anger and her Husbands<sup>[44]</sup>, not caring whether they bee pleased or displeased. Shee neglects to plant the feare of the Lord in her childrens hearts, chusing rather to be an example of wickednesse vnto them, and to misplace them in marriage for sinister respects. She brings want of things necessary to her family by her wastefulnesse, brauery, and idlenesse. She contemnes her naturall and legall kindred, lifts vp her selfe aboue her equalls, disdaines her inferiours, dishonours her place by an ouer-loftie or an ouer-bafe and contemptible behauiour in the same. She alienates the hearts of Gods people from her, by neglecting the offices of courtesies and

*A womā fearlesse of  
God.*

helpfulnesse. She declines and vnderualewes the most searching meanes of Saluation, the Word, Prayer, Conference, Repentance, Meditation, Sacraments; in a word (according to Saint *Ambroses*<sup>[45]</sup> Distinction) she feares hell torments, because shee hath sinned, but shee feares not Gods displeasure, lest she should sinne, and therefore shee liues and dies in worldlinesse, wantonnesse, pride, hatred, variance, emulations, wrath, strife, reuenge, impatiencie, gluttonie, or some such darling sinne: and tell me (Beloued) if such a woman not beautified and adorned with religion and the feare of the Lord, be worthy to bee praised of the Lord? I am sure the ancient Fathers<sup>[46]</sup> declaime bitterly against her filthy heart, false haire, adulterate paintings, naked breasts, new-fangled fashions of superfluous, monstrous attire: & the holy Scriptures<sup>[47]</sup> vilifie her to her face, threatening her (notwithstanding all her other ornaments and excellencies of nature, art, policie, preferment,) that without this *Feare of the Lord*, it shall not be well with her, *Ecclef. 8. 13. The Lord will come neare to her to iudgement, he will be a swift witnesse against her, Mal. 3. 5. She shall leaue her memorie to be cursed*<sup>[48]</sup>, and her reproach shall not be blotted out, *she shall be counted vngodly of all*<sup>[49]</sup>, more bitter than death<sup>[50]</sup>. As rottennesse in her husbands bones<sup>[51]</sup>, As spittle<sup>[52]</sup>, yea As a Dogge<sup>[53]</sup>, and at last she shall be cast into hell fire, *Saluâ Veniâ*, without pardon from God, because (saith *Tertullian*<sup>[54]</sup>) she hath sinned *Saluo metû*, without any feare of God.

## FOOTNOTES:

[40] *Convertatur ad ipsum etiam Timor tuus, quia peruersus est timor omnis, quo metuis aliquid præter eum aut non propter eum. S. Ber. in cap. Ieiun. fer. 2.*

[41] *Quid magnū est, pænā timere? Quis enim nō timet? quis Latro, quis sceleratus, quis nefarius? &c. S. August. de Verb. Apost. fer. 15. fol. 332. tom. 10.*

[42] *Deut. 10. 12. 2 King. 17. 36. Luk. 12. 5. Ef. 8. 13. Mal. 1. 6.*

[43] *Loquacitas in ædificatione nulla turpis, si quando turpis. Itaque si de aliquo bono sermo est, res postulat contrarium quoque boni recensere. Quid enim sectandum sit, magis illuminabis, si quod vitandū sit, proinde digesseris. Tertul. de Patien. c. 5. tom. 2.*

[44] *Esth. 1. 12, 17, 20, 22. Eccl. 26. 26. Ef. 36. 9. & 3. 16. Prou. 30. 33. Ecclef. 25. 13. & alibi passim. Vbi verò timor Dei non est, ibi dissolutio vitæ est. S. Aug. de Temp. fer. 213. tom. 10.*

[45] *Aliud est timere quia peccaueris, aliud timere ne pecces. Et ibi est formido de supplicio, hic sollicitudo de præmio. Epist. 84. tum. 3. Est quem timor Dei ligat, qui non expauescit ad vultus hominū, sed ad memoriam gehennalium tormentorum. Et hic quidem peccare non metuit, sed ardere. S. Bern. de Tripl. Coherens: Vincul. &c. Ep. 33. 14.*

[46] *Tertul. de Habit. Mulieb. & de Cultu Fæm. tom. 2. S. Cyprian de Discipl. & Hab. Virg. to. 2. Greg. Naz. aduerf. mulier: Ambitosè se ornantes. to. 2. S. Ephræm aduerf. improbas mulieres tom. 1. if his workes. Riuet. l. 3. c. 21.*

[47] *2 King. 9. 20, 30, 34. Ep. 3. 16, &c. & 32. 9, 10, 11. 1 Pet. 3. 3, 4. Matth. 5. 36. & 6. 27. Ecclef. 25. 13, 19.*

But on the other side what personall sufficiency, what singular duty is there requisite in a Woman, either in respect of God, or of her husband, children, kindred, seruants, place, and of Gods people, which the life of Grace, the Grace of the Feare of the Lord doth not animate, aduance, and accomplish? This godly Feare ennobleth Nobilitie, beautifieth Beautie, enricheth wealth, teacheth wit, wisdom. She that hath this *Feare*, dare not for her heart, but be loath to offend her husband, and deny her inferiority<sup>[55]</sup>, but be an example of godlinesse to her children<sup>[56]</sup>, prouide things necessary for her seruants<sup>[57]</sup> both in health and in sicknesse; loue her naturall and legall<sup>[58]</sup> kindred, esteeme her equals aboue her selfe<sup>[59]</sup>, countenance and relieue her inferiours<sup>[60]</sup>, maintaine the dignitie of her place by all such vertues as may discharge the<sup>[61]</sup> same; winne the affections of Gods people, to her more and more, by the offices<sup>[62]</sup> of courtesies, salutations, gifts, visitations, inuitations and of helpfulnesse; yea she that feares God, dare not for her heart but *Honour them that feare God, Psal. 15. 4.* but keepe her set tasks<sup>[63]</sup> of hearing, reading, fasting, praying, meditating, moderating passionate distempers, and of all other gracious exercises, of Self-deniall<sup>[64]</sup>; so that there is not any knowne<sup>[65]</sup> sinne which she nourisheth, alloweth, or goeth on in, but quaketh and trembleth at the very first thoughts, yea motions and inclinations thereunto, as being in the sight<sup>[66]</sup> of an inuisible God, vnder the perpetuall presence of his All-seeing glorious pure eye, which shee will not prouoke to anger by any sinne, for all the gold that euer the Sunne made, or shall make while it stands in Heauen<sup>[67]</sup>.

*A womā fearing the Lord.*



## FOOTNOTES:

[48] *Ecclef. 23. 26. Prou. 10. 7.*

[49] *Ecclef. 26. 25.*

[50] *Ecclef. 7. 26*

[51] *Prou. 12. 4.*

[52] *Ecclef. 26. 21.*

[53] *Ecclef. 26. 25.*

[54] *Sic ergò & ipſi, ſaluâ veniâ in gehennam detrudentur, dum ſaluô metû peccant. De pœnit. c. 5. Reuel. 21. 8. & 22. 15.*

[55] *Gen. 3. 16. Eph. 5. 23.33. 1 Cor. 7. 34.*

[56] *1 Tim. 5. 10. 2 Tim. 1. 5. & 3. 15. Tit. 2. 4. Deut. 6. 7.*

[57] *Prou. 31. 15, 21. Matth. 8. 6.*

[58] *1 Tim. 5. 4. Eph. 2. 7, 10. & 4. 4. Ruth 4. 15. Exod. 18. 7.*

[59] *Phil. 2. 3. Rom. 12. 10, 16.*

[60] *Iam. 2. 1. 1 Tim. 6. 18.*

[61] *Titus 2. 3.*

[62] *Luk. 1. 45, 56. Prou. 1. 20 & 5. 20 Gal. 6. 10 1 Tim 5. 10 Iob 6. 14*

This glorious deſcription of a woman fearing the Lord, is not mine (Bleſſed Brethren) but the Scriptures, wherein I finde; 1. The cauſe of her Feare to be not Selfe-Loue<sup>[68]</sup>, but the Loue of God; not the ſpirit of Bondage<sup>[69]</sup>; but the Spirit of Adoption: 2. The Obiect of her feare to be not the precepts of men<sup>[70]</sup>, but the Commandements of God<sup>[71]</sup>: not his Threats only<sup>[72]</sup>, but his Promiſes alſo<sup>[73]</sup>: not his Anger only againſt fin<sup>[74]</sup>, but his Mercy alſo in Chriſt<sup>[75]</sup>: not his Prefence only, as a Reuenging Iudge<sup>[76]</sup>, but his Forbearance alſo as a louing Father<sup>[77]</sup>. 3. The workings of her Feare to be in the heat of temptations and afflictions, not Deſpairing<sup>[78]</sup>; but Beleeuing the forgiuenefſe of her finnes, not Limiting God to the preſent danger; but<sup>[79]</sup> waiting for his mercy, not Diſtruſting his Prouidence; but hoping for Good<sup>[80]</sup>: not Murmuring againſt him; but praifing Him, and praying vnto Him<sup>[81]</sup>, yea (which is the proper Act of her Feare) not Louing any fin, but



hating and eschewing all sin<sup>[82]</sup>, not out of a slavish terrour of punishment; but chiefly because it is Sinne, an Infinite euill; and because an Infinite Good God, whom she loueth (saith Saint *Augustine*) is offended by it, though she should neuer goe to Hell-fire to be punished for it<sup>[83]</sup>.

## FOOTNOTES:

[63] *Gal. 6. 9. Iam. 1. 19. 1 Tim. 4. 13. 1 Theff 5. 17. Luk. 2. 37. Ephef. 4. 26. Phil. 4. 5. 1 Pet. 3. 4. Luk. 9. 23. & 14. 26.*

[64] *Pfal. 18. 23. & 77. 10. Gen. 39. 9. Prou. 16. 6. & 8. 13.*

[65] *Gen. 17. 1. Pfal. 6. 8. & 116. 9. Act. 10. 33. 2 Cor. 6. 17. Iob 34. 21. Prou. 15. 3. & 5. 22. 2 Chron. 16. 9 1 King. 17. 1. Magna est cautela peccati, Dei semper presentiam timere. S. Aug. de Temp. tom. 212. tom. 10.*

[66] *Multum enim refrænât homines cōscientia, si credamus nos in cōspectu Dei uiuere, si non, tantum quæ gerimus uideri desuper, sed etiam quæ cogitamus, aut loquimur, audiri a Deo putamus &c. Lact. de Irâ Dei. c.8.*

[67] *Ef. 3. 8. 1 Cor. 3. 22. Psalm. 119. 14.72. 127.162.*

[68] *2 Tim. 1. 7 & 3. 2.*

[69] *Rom. 8. 15.*

[70] *Ef. 29. 13.*

[71] *Deut. 4. 10. Ef. 66. 2. Eccl. 12. 13. Prou. 13. 13. Pfal. 119. 161.*

[72] *Pfal. 119. 120. & 52. 6.*

[73] *2 Cor. 7. 1. Heb. 4. 1. Pfal. 130. 4.*

[74] *Deut. 5. 9*

[75] *Hos. 3. 5. Pfal. 33. 18 & 130. 4.*

[76] *Ier. 5. 22. Act. 10. 2, 33.*

[77] *Mal. 1. 6. Of. 3. 5. Hebr. 12. 9.*

Laftly, in the Scriptures I finde Perseuerance or Constancie<sup>[84]</sup> to be euer an inseperable Attendant vpon her Feare! For she is not one that hath not yet tasted of this sauing Grace, or else not continued in the same; but she is a woman for the present, *Timens Dominum, Fearing the Lord*. You shall neuer finde Her otherwife, than (as God would haue her) *In the feare of the Lord all the day*

II.  
*The continuance of  
her Feare.*

*long, Prou. 23. Fearing and keeping his Commandements alwaies, Deut. 4. Doing her Husband Good and not euill all the daies of her life, verſe the 12. of this Chapter.*

It is true indeed, as Feare is oppoſed to Diffidence, *Luke 1.* So ſhe ſerues God without a Diſtruſtfull Feare all the daies of her life; becauſe of Gods continuall preſence with Her<sup>[85]</sup>, continuall mercy towards Her<sup>[86]</sup>, continuall power<sup>[87]</sup> ouer Her, in Strengthening, Helping, and Vpholding Her, *Eſai. 41. 10.* But yet as Feare is oppoſed to Negligence, ſo ſhe ſtill feares God, leſt ſhe ſhould be ſecure by reaſon of his Power which is inuincible<sup>[88]</sup>; of his Wiſdome, which is infallible<sup>[89]</sup>; of his Mercy, which is compaſſionate<sup>[90]</sup>; and of his Juſtice, which is inflexible<sup>[91]</sup>.

### FOOTNOTES:

[78] *Ier. 17. 17. Eccleſ. 2. 8.*

[79] *Pſal. 33. 18. 20. Eccleſ. 2. 7.*

[80] *Pſal. 115. 11. & 56. 3. Eccleſ. 2. 9.*

[81] *1 Cor. 10. 10. Pſalm. 22. 23. Act. 10. 2.*

[82] *Exod. 20. 20. Eccleſ. 15. 13. Prou. 8. 13. & 16. 6. 2 Tim. 1. 7. 1 Ioh. 4. 18. Hof. 3. 5. Pſal. 97. 10. Ier. 4. 18. & 2. 19.*

[83] *Verò-Chriſtianus—proficiēdo perueniet ad talem animū, vt plus amet Dominum quàm timeat Gehēnam: vt etiamſi dicat illi Deus, vt ere delicife carnalibus ſempiternis & quantum potes; pecca, nec morieris, nec in Gehēnam mitteris, ſed mecum tantummodo non eris; exhorreſcat et omninò non peccet, non iam vt in illud quod timebat non incidat, ſed ne illum quem ſic amat, offendat. De Catechiz. Rudib. cap. 27. tom. 4. fol. 912.*

[84] *Ierem. 32. 39, 40. Deut. 4. 10. Prou. 23. 17. & 14. 2. 1 Tim. 2. 15.*

[85] *Matth. 28. 20 Ef. 43. 1, 2.*

[86] *Ier. 14. 9. Lam. 3. 22, 23.*

[87] *2 Cor. 12. 9. Ef. 26. 4. & 45. 24. Pſal. 121. & 35. 24. Rom. 8. 26.*

It is as true alſo (which *Gerſon* and others haue obſerued<sup>[92]</sup>) that many times a Deuout Soule is ſo diſquieted with a flauifh Feare of the Aduerſary; that ſhe feares leſt ſhe hath not any true Feare of Gods Maieſtie; but yet (*B. B.*) ſay the *Pelagian* what hee can to the contrary, ſuch is the

Euerlaftingneffe of Gods Loue<sup>[93]</sup>, Mercie<sup>[94]</sup>, and Couenant<sup>[95]</sup>, the Vnconquerablenesse of his Power<sup>[96]</sup>, the Immortality of his Word<sup>[97]</sup>, the Certaintie of his Promises<sup>[98]</sup>, the Efficacie of Christs Spirit<sup>[99]</sup>, Prayer<sup>[100]</sup>, Merits<sup>[101]</sup>, and of Faith in them<sup>[102]</sup>; yea such is the durable vigour of this fauing Grace of *the Feare of the Lord*<sup>[103]</sup>, that being once rooted by God, (as Saint *Augustine* vrgeth) it cannot be remoued; but through it we may perfeueringly adhere vnto God according to his promise: *I will put my Feare in their hearts, that they shall not depart from me, Ier. 32. 40. with Pſal. 80. 17.* She then that truely hath this *Feare*, doth ſo feare the Lord in Loue, and loue him in feare<sup>[104]</sup>, that as in the midſt of Gods not Conſuming, but Conſummating Anger (for ſo Saint *Augustine*<sup>[105]</sup> calls Gods Anger towards the Godly) ſhee can fee the yerning and relenting Bowels of a Compaſſionate Father, ſo in the height of Satans Terrifying iniectiōs, ſhe can ſhunne and abhorre Gods Diſpleaſure<sup>[106]</sup>, more than all other miſeries of Punishments, and therefore in what ſtate ſoeuer ſhe be of Conſolation or Deſertion, ſhee is ſtill the ſame Woman, *Timens Dominum, Fearing the Lord.*

## FOOTNOTES:

[88] *Matth. 10. 28. Deut. 28. 58.*

[89] *Eſai. 29. 15, 16. Pſal. 50. 21.*

[90] *Eſai. 43. 25. & 63. 9. & 49. 13, 15.*

[91] *Eſai. 42. 14.*

[92] *De diuerſis tentat. Diaboli, part 3. M<sup>r</sup>. Greenham 5. part, among his Rules for an Afflicted minde.*

[93] *Eſai. 54. 8, 9, 10. c. 49. 15. Ier. 31. 3. 36. c. 33. 20, 21. Ioh. 13. 1. Rom. 8. 38, 39. Mat. 12. 20. Eſai. 42. 3.*

[94] *Pſalm. 103. 17. 2 Sam. 7. 15.*

[95] *Pſal. 89. 28, 34. Eſai. 55. 3. c. 59. 21. Ier. 32. 40.*

[96] *Ioh. 10. 29. Iude verſ. 24. 1 Pet. 1. 5. Eſai. 26. 4. Pſal. 80. 17. Manus Dei eſt iſta, non noſtra vt non diſcedamus à Deo, manus inquā eius eſt iſta, qui dixit, Timorem meum dabo in cor eorū &c. S. Aug. de Bono perfeuer. c. 7. to. 7. Ier. 32. 27.*

[97] *1 Pet. 1. 23. 1 Ioh. 3. 9.*

[98] *Ephef. 1. 13. Numb. 13. 19. Iof. 21. 45. 1 Ioh. 5. 10. Hebr. 7. 27. c. 11. 11. Rom. 4. 21. 1 Cor. 1. 9.*

[99] *Efai. 59. 21. Ephef. 1. 13, 14. c. 4. 30. Ioh. 14. 16, 17. 1 Ioh. 2. 27.*

[100] *Luke 22. 32. Ioh. 17. 15, 20. Rom. 8. 34. Hebr. 7. 25.*

[101] *1 Pet. 1. 2, 3, 4, 5. 1 Ioh. 5. 4, 18.*

[102] *1 Pet. 5. 9. Ephef. 6. 6. Matth. 16. 18.*

[103] *Ierem. 31. 40. Perfeuerantiam enim promifit Deus, dicens: Timorem meum dabo in cor eorum vt à me non recedant. Quod quid eft aliud quàm talis ac tantus erit Timor meus, quem dabo in cor eorum, vt mihi perfeuerantèr adhæreant? Idem de Bono Perfeuer. c. 2. tom. 7. Rom. 11. 29.*

Thus wee haue feene who ſhe is, who *ſhall be praised*, leſt we ſhould praife Her vnawares, whom we ſhould not praife. And now it were good we did thinke a little better on the Reaſon, why *ſhe ſhall be praised*, euen becauſe ſhe is ſuch *a woman fearing the Lord*.

For if any thing, ſo rare and excellent a Grace as the *Feare of the Lord* is, ſhould moue vs to affect it, and labour for it, eſpecially being found in ſo weake a Veſſell

*The Reaſon.*

as a Woman is<sup>[107]</sup>. For I could tell you, there are more *Michals*<sup>[108]</sup> than *Abigails*<sup>[109]</sup>, more *Iezebels*<sup>[110]</sup> than *Sarah's*<sup>[111]</sup>, more proud *Vaſthy's*<sup>[112]</sup>, than humble *Eſthers*<sup>[113]</sup>, more Fearefull women, than Women *Fearing the Lord*; and therefore the rarer ſuch Phœnixes are (as S. *Ierom* calls them<sup>[114]</sup>) not *One* to be found by wiſeſt *Salomon*<sup>[115]</sup>, among a *Thouſand*, greater is her praife *that feareth the Lord*<sup>[116]</sup>.

## FOOTNOTES:

[104] *Abſit enim vt timore pereat amor, ſi caſtus eſt timor. S. Aug. in Pſal. 119. tom. 8.*

[105] *Eſt ira conſummationis, & eſt ira cōſumptionis, (nam omnis Vindicta Dei, Ira dicitur) ſed aliquando ad hoc vindicat Deus, vt perficiat: aliquando ad hoc vindicat, vt damnet. Idem in Pſal. 58 to. 8. f. 599.*

[106] —Qui glutine Deo conglutinator, id eſt charitate ... terribilius & horribilius ipſâ Gehenna iudicat, in re leuiſſima vultū omnipotentis ſcientèr offendere. S. Bern. de Tripl. Coharen. Vincul.

[107] *1 Pet. 3. 7. Vir itaq, nominatus est, quòd maior in eo Vis est quàm in fæmina, & hinc Virtus nomen accepit. Item Mulier à mollicie est dicta ... velut Mollier. Lact. de Opf. Dei. cap. 12.*

[108] *1 Sam. 18. 21. & 25. 41.*

[109] *2 Sam. 6. 16, 20.*

[110] *1 King. 21. 7. 2 King. 9. 22, 30.*

[111] *1 Pet. 3. 6.*

[112] *Efth. 1. 12.*

[113] *Efth. 8. 5.*

[114] *Optima fæmina rarior est Phænice. Malarum fæminarū tam copiosa sunt examina &c. S. Ier. epist.*

[115] *Ecclef. 7. 28. Prou. 3. 10.*

[116] *Laus tantò maior deferri solet, quantò est bonum rarius quod exigit Laudem. S. Aug. lib. 1. de Ciuit. Dei. cap. 28. tom. 5.*

Then I muſt tell you, that euery Feare is not commendable. Not that Feare which is Hypocritically, for this is Superſtition, when men feare the Feare of Idolaters<sup>[117]</sup>. Not that feare which is Worldly, for this is wicked ſelfe-Loue, when men feare Men<sup>[118]</sup>, Loſſe of Goods, Fire and faggot, more than God the Onely Soueraigne Commander of the Soule, the Only Dreadfull Threatner of euerlaſting Burnings. Nor that feare which is Seruile<sup>[119]</sup> or adulterate<sup>[120]</sup>, for this is no Vertue (proues *Parif.*) when men feare the *Euill of Puniſhment* only; not the *Euill of Sinne*, as an Adultereſſe feares the Comming home of her Huſband; but feares not the Committing of Adultery. Nor is that feare commendable, which is Diſtruſtfull or Immoderate like *Ruben* (as *Gerſon*<sup>[121]</sup> alludes) growen great, and lying with *Bilhah*, for this is Infidelitie when men tie Gods Grace to preſent deliuerance out of danger, without a Beleeuing and waiting Spirit for his Mercie, *Eſai. 28. 16.*

But the *Feare* for which a *Woman ſhall be praiſed*, is informed by Wiſdome, inſtructed by Vnderſtanding, directed by Counſell, ſtrengthned by Might, gouerned by Knowledge, adorned with Pietie, as Saint *Ambroſe* collects out of the eleuenth of *Eſay*<sup>[122]</sup>. It is a Faithfull feare truſting in God<sup>[123]</sup>, and making Him her *Feare*, *Eſai. 8. 13.* and her Hope too in the Day of Euill, not without this feruent Prayer vnto Him then: *Be not thou a Terrour vnto me, Ier. 17. 17.* A chaſt and *Cleane Feare*<sup>[124]</sup>, *Cleanſing from all filthineſſe*

of the flesh and Spirit.<sup>[125]</sup> A Reuerent and Godly Fear<sup>[126]</sup>, Preparing the heart, Humbling the Soule in Gods fight<sup>[127]</sup>, Trembling at his Word<sup>[128]</sup>, not Difobeying it, Elschewing<sup>[129]</sup> euill, Working righteoufneffe and Giuing much almes<sup>[130]</sup>. A Bleffed Feare it is<sup>[131]</sup>, Bleffing them that haue it, Bleffing the Lord that giues it, Praifing Him and faying: *That his Mercy endureth for euer*<sup>[132]</sup>.

## FOOTNOTES:

<sup>[117]</sup> *Efai. 8. 12 Col. 2. 20.*

<sup>[118]</sup> *2 Tim. 3. 2. Mat. 10. 28. Quis animæ Dominator, nifi Deus folus? Quis iste, nifi ignium comminator? ... Illi potius metum confecandū &c. Tertul. aduerf. Gnoft. c. 9. tom. 3.*

<sup>[119]</sup> *Timor Seruilis nō eft Virtus, quialicet mala declinari faciat: non tamen hoc facit benè, id eft faudibilitè; immo ilitè et brutalitè, videlicet folo metæ feræ, ita enim occupat animum & intentionam timentis, oraculos cordis ad folam pænæ euafionem habeat &c. Paris. de Virtutibus, fol. 81. lit. H. & Paludan. l. 3. d. 34. q. 3.*

<sup>[120]</sup> —*Coniun quæ adulterinum animū gerit, etiam fi timòre viri non adulterium perpetrât: tamen quod deeft aperi, ineft voluntati, Cafta verò alitèr timet: nam & ipfa times virum; fed caftè. Deniq, timet illa, no vir infeftus adueniat, ifta ne offenfus abfcedat. S. Aug. epift. 120. c. 21. to. 2.*

<sup>[121]</sup> *Ruben violat Balamdum nimium grandis effectus eft, quia timor fi fimius eft, dum fe custodire nititur, format inutiles imaginationes, quibus fe connoluens à falutaribus impeditur. Tract. 10. fuper, Magnificat. part 3.*

<sup>[122]</sup> *Lege Efaiam: vide quantia fubiecerit timorem vt faceret irreprehenfibilam & bonum Timorem. Spiritus inquit Sapientia &c. Talle Timori Domini ifta & eft irrationabilis & infapiens Timor, vnus ex illis: Foris pugnæ, intus Timores. In Pfal. 118. Ser. 5. tom. 4.*

Laftly, it is an Euerlafting Feare, euer encreafing<sup>[133]</sup>, and *Enduring for euer*<sup>[134]</sup>, though not in refpect of the Act of Declination or elschewing of finne<sup>[135]</sup>, becaufe in Heauen there is no feare of finning<sup>[136]</sup>; yet in refpect of the Act of Celebration or Reuerencing God, becaufe there the Saints doe nothing elfe; but ftill Giue Glory to Him, and Worship Him with humble Acknowledgement of their owne Vnworthineffe, *Pfal. 19. 9. with Reuel. 4. 10. 11.*

Now (Honourable and Beloued) though I haue fet nothing at all besides this Heauenly Manna before your eyes; yet your full Soules muſt not Loath it. For if that only is to be praized which is excellent<sup>[137]</sup>, then (by your leaue) I muſt ſtand ſomewhat longer vpon the Excellencie of this *Feare*, before a *Woman* can be *praized* that hath it.

The Excellencie of  
Godly Feare.

## FOOTNOTES:

[123] *Pfal.* 115. 11. & 147. 11. *Eſai.* 50. 10.

[124] *Pfal.* 19. 9

[125] *2 Cor.* 7. 1.

[126] *Hebr.* 12. 28.

[127] *Eccleſ.* 2. 17. & 21. 6.

[128] *Eſai.* 66. 2. *Eccle.* 2. 15.

[129] *Iob* 1. 1.

[130] *Act.* 10. 35, 2, 31. *Eccleſ.* 25. 1.

[131] *Pfal.* 112. 1. & 128. 1.

[132] *Pfal.* 135. 13. & 118. 4 & 22. 23.

[133] *1 King.* 18. 3. 12. *Tob.* 14. 4.

[134] *Pfal.* 19. 9. *Reuel.* 7. 10, 11 & 19. 1, 3, 4, 5, 6.

[135] *Bonau. lib.* 3. d. 34. q. 3. p. 89. *Tho. Aquin.* II q. 79. a. II

[136] *In cælo, vbi non eſt peccatum Gloria eſt & perpetua laus & indefeſſæ præconia. S. Ierom. ad Therdoram. Epitaph. Lucinij. Timorem Offenſa & Timorem Pænæ. Gloria Timorem Patriæ propter coram imperfectionem nō paritur. In tuto enim erimus et â pænæ et ab offenſa. Pariſ. de Virtutibus, lit. A. F.*

[137] *Laudare plus eſt quàm probare & prædicare. Nam Laudamus id quod excellit &c. Auſo. Popma de Differen. Virt. l. 3.*

I demand then what doe you count Excellent? Riches, Honour, Life. Why, theſe are neuer well gotten, nor well kept; but by *the Feare of the Lord*. So ſaith *Salomon*, *By the feare of the Lord are Riches and Honour, and Life*<sup>[138]</sup>. Say what you will, it muſt needs be an Excellent thing wherwith Chriſt Ieſus Himſelfe was Filled, and that was with *The Spirit of this Feare*,

*Efai. 11. 2.*<sup>[139]</sup>. An excellent thing which God Himselfe so earnestly desires to be still in vs, and that is this Feare. O (saith He) *that there were such an Heart in them, that they would feare me, and keepe my Commandements alwaies*<sup>[140]</sup>, which is indeed the *whole Dutie of Man*<sup>[141]</sup>; without which (Saint Bernard concludes) *Euery man is Nothing*. He is not a Man (reasons a Schoole-man<sup>[142]</sup>) but the Shadow of a Man; because He imployes not his Soule to that noble End for which he had it, namely, to be squared and ruled by the feare of the Lord: without which no man can so much as Begin to be wise, because this Feare is the Beginning<sup>[143]</sup> of wisdom, nor so much as Begin to Loue God, because this Feare is the Beginning of the Loue of God<sup>[144]</sup>. It is the Salt (alludes *Blesensis*) that must be in euery Sacrifice<sup>[145]</sup>, in euery Worke we doe, so that there is no *Seruing God*, no *Reioycing* in Him<sup>[146]</sup>, no heartie *Repenting*<sup>[147]</sup>, no *Chast Conuersing*<sup>[148]</sup>, no *Perfecting Holiness*<sup>[149]</sup>, no *Working out our Saluation*, but with *Feare and Trembling*<sup>[150]</sup>; nay there is no *Saluation*, no *Blessedness* without *Continuing in this Feare*<sup>[151]</sup>, *Prou. 28. 14*. Againe, is not that Excellent, that will make vs more Excellent than our Neighbours<sup>[152]</sup>, that will Exalt vs aboue them, that will keepe our hearts from Hardning<sup>[153]</sup>, our Houses from Ouertthrowing<sup>[154]</sup>? but nothing can doe this; but this *Feare of the Lord*. This feare (saith *Parif.*<sup>[155]</sup>) can cause a spiritual Earth-quake in a mans Heart, able to ouertrow all the Devils strongest holds, any<sup>[156]</sup> *Bosome-finne*, be it neuer so pleasing and profitable, by reason of that Contrarietie and Opposition<sup>[157]</sup> that is betweene Lying in any Sweet Sinne, and Liuing in Gods Feare and Fauour, as you may see, *Leuit. 25. 36*.

## FOOTNOTES:

<sup>[138]</sup> *Prou. 22. 4. & 19. 23. Ecclef. 1. 11, 12. & 23. 27. & 40. 26, 27. & 10. 20, 22.*

<sup>[139]</sup> *Inter Laudes meas & illa est eximia: quod ipsum Christum Dominū Apothecam, immo fontem Gratiarum omnium & Virtutum replere dictus sum &c. Parif. de Moribus, fol. 99. Lit. P.*

<sup>[140]</sup> *Deut. 5. 29.*

<sup>[141]</sup> *Ecclef. 12. 13. Deum time—Ergo si hoc est omnis Homo, absq, hoc Nihil omnis Homo. Serm. 20. in Cant.*



[142] *Vfus enim humani animi pendet à Timore conspicuus Diuini tanquam à primi regula. Caiet. in Ecclef. c. 8 13. v.*

[143] *Prou. 9. 10. Iob 28. 28.*

[144] *Ecclef. 25. 12.*

[145] *Leuit. 2. 13. Pet. Blef. fer. 36. p. 430.*

[146] *Pfal. 2. 11.*

[147] *2 Cor. 7. 11. Eccl. 21. 6.*

[148] *1 Pet. 3. 2.*

[149] *2 Cor. 7. 1.*

[150] *Philip. 2. 12.*

[151] *Ecclef. 2. 10. 1 Tim. 2. 15.*

Laftly, this is an Excellent Feare, becaufe it is *A fountaine of Life*<sup>[158]</sup>: wherefore? *To driue away Sinnes*<sup>[159]</sup>, Sinnes which haue beene committed by Repentance (faith S. Bernard) and Sinnes whereto we are Tempted, by Refiftance<sup>[160]</sup>; and yet this is not all the Excellencie of this Feare: For it is *A fountaine of life* alfo: *To Caufe vs to finde fauour at our Deaths*<sup>[161]</sup>; and which is more, Such an Excellent Feare as will make vs *Not feare, nor be afraid*<sup>[162]</sup>. Whereupon Saint *Auguftine*<sup>[163]</sup> concludes for my purpofe: *Discat timere, qui non vult timere: Discat ad tempus effe Sollicitus, qui femper vult effe fecurus*. Let him learn to feare, that would not feare: Let him be wary and cautelous for a time, that would be happie and fecure for euer. *Tertullian* giues the reafon<sup>[164]</sup>, because if *We feare to Offend*, by Fearing we will take heed, left we Offend, and by Taking heed, we fhall be in fafetie; otherwife if wee prefume and be not alwaies watchfull ouer our hearts left they offend, we cannot be *Saued*<sup>[165]</sup>, *Ier. 4. 14. Qui follicitus eft, is verè poterit effe fecurus*: He that is not ouer-bold on his owne ftrengh<sup>[166]</sup>; but confident in *Christ*<sup>[167]</sup>, and liues not fecurely in the minion-delight of any knowne finne; but ftands in fuch continuall awe of Gods *Prefence, Precepts, Promifes, Threats*, that he dare not fo much as once make any offer of incurring his Difpleafure by the impenitent Allowance of any finne in his heart<sup>[168]</sup>, and ftudies to do euey Good worke as carefully, as if it were the Laft he should doe in this World, and as exactly, as if his whole Saluation depended vpon it, fuch a Man (in Ancient

*Tertullians iudgement*<sup>[169]</sup>) may be truely secure of Perseuering in Grace here; and of being Glorified hereafter<sup>[170]</sup>, *1 Thess. 5. 15, 24.* Once more I haue done. Is not that an excellent thing that is for the Good of them that haue it, & of their children after them? Riches, Honour, Beautie, Policie, these and the like are not oftentimes so, as we see by woefull experience in *Nabal, Haman, Abfalom, Achitophel*; but *the feare of the Lord* is euer so, *for the Good of them that haue it, and for their children after them*, as the Prophet faith, *Ier. 32. 39.* and God himselfe before him, *Deut. 5. 29.*

## FOOTNOTES:

[152] *Prou. 12. 26. Ecclef. 15. 5.*

[153] *Prou. 28. 14.*

[154] *Ecclef. 27. 3.*

[155] *Ego sum Tempestas ad liberationem & salutem, Terræmotum spiritualem in corde humano faciens, et omnia Diabolica ædificia in eo subuertens et discutiens ab eodem. Parif. de Moribus fol. 99. lit. F.*

[156] *Prou. 8. 13. & 16. 6. Psal. 119. 6, 36. 117. 128. v. Iam. 2. 10. Psal. 86. 11.*

[157] *Sed aiunt quidā: Satis Deum habere si corde & animo suspiciatur, licet actu minus fiat. Itaq se saluo metu et fide peccare; hoc est Saluâ castitate, matrimonia violare, Saluâ pietate, parēti venenum temperare. Tertul. de Pœnit. c. 5. tom. 2.*

[158] *Prou. 14. 27.*

[159] *Ecclef. 1. 21.*

[160] *Timor Domini expellit peccatum, sine quod iam admissum est, sine quod tentat intrare. Expellit sanè illud quidem pœnitende, hoc Resistendo. Serm. de Diuers. Affect.*

[161] *Ecclef. 1. 13.*

[162] *Ecclef. 34. 14. Exod. 20. 20. Prou. 1. 33. & 19. 23. Psal. 27. 1, 2, 3. & 34. 4.—Auferendi sunt metus, sed ita, vt hic solus relinquatur, qui quoniam legitimus ac verus est, solus efficit, ut possint cætera omnia non timeri, Lact. de Vero Cultu. l. 6. c. 17. Qui enim Deum veracitèr timet, nihil terrenum & caducum timet, immo ex ipso Timore Dei, ipsis Timoribus supereffertur. Bonau. lib. 3. d. 34. q. 1. p. 62.*

[163] *De Temp. Serm. 214. tom. 10.*

[164] *Nam qui præsumit, minus veretur, minus præcauet, plus periclitatur &c. De Cultu Fæm. cap. 2. & de Pœnit. cap. 6.—Volo te timere & non timere,*

*præsumere & non præsumere, timere vt pæniteas, non timere vt præsumas. Porro præsumere ne diffidas, non præsumere ne torpescas. Ber. cp. 87. ad Oger.*

[165] *Prou. 4. 23. Ier. 4. 14, 18. & 16. 10, 11, 12. Ef. 55. 7. Mat. 15. 19. Nec fufficit non egiffe aliquid impium, si mēte cogitatur impietas. S. Hilar. in Pſal. 65. fol. 424.*

[166] *Prou 28. 26. Rom. 7. 18. & 11. 20.*

[167] *Phil. 4. 13. 2 Tim. 2. 1. & 4. 18. Eph. 6. 10. 2 Chron. 16. 8, 9. et. 20. 12. Deut. 6. 3, 4. Quicquid est circa te vel in te unde possis præsumere, abjice à te, & tota præsumptio tua Deus fit, illius indigens esto, vt implearis &c. S. Aug. in Pſal. 85.*

[168] *Pſal. 66. 18. 1 Pet. 3. 15. Ez. 33. 31. Pſal. 24. 4 Iam. 4. 8. Heb. 10. 22. Redi ad te, intus tibi esto iudex. Ecce in cubiculo tuo abscondito, in ipsa vena intima cordis tui vbi tu solus es, & ille qui videt; illic tibi displiceat iniquitas, vt placeas Deo.... Parum est in vultu, parum est in lingua, in corde noli respicere, id est, noli diligere, noli acceptare. Idem in Pſal. 65. to 8.*

[169] *De cultu Fæm. cap. 2. to. 2.*

[170] *2 Theff. 3. 3. 2 Tim. 2. 19. Ioh. 15. 16. Luke 10. 20. Ioh. 16. 22. & 10. 28, 29. v. Pſal. 35. 5. & 125. 1. Prou. 10. 30.*

There is no want to them that haue this *Feare* of any Good thing that is Good for them<sup>[171]</sup>. For firſt, *Pſal. 25. 14. The ſecret, that is, the feare of the Lord, is with them that feare Him*; and is not that enough, though I ſhould ſay no more with the *Pſalmiſt*, becauſe *Godly Feare is Gods Treafure, Eſai. 33. 6. and Better little with it (ſaith Salomon) than Great Treafure*<sup>[172]</sup>? But there is more behind to moue you further to affect this Excellent Grace. For if you will *Feare the Lord*, He will ſhew you his *Couenant*<sup>[173]</sup> of life and peace<sup>[174]</sup>, Teach you the way that you ſhall chuſe<sup>[175]</sup>, Haue a Booke of remembrance written before Him for you<sup>[176]</sup>: Hee will Ariſe vnto you the *Sunne of Righteouſneſſe with healing in his wings*<sup>[177]</sup>: He wil hide you in his preſence from the pride of men<sup>[178]</sup>, Keepe you ſecretly in a *Pauiſion* from the ſtrife of tongues, *Deliuere you in Temptation euen againe*<sup>[179]</sup>; yea He will take pleaſure in you<sup>[180]</sup>, Pitie you as a Father doth his children<sup>[181]</sup>, Fulfill your Deſire, Heare your crie and ſaue you<sup>[182]</sup>. And what is all this, but in a word (the word of my Text) *Hee will praiſe you*, which is the Thing Promiſed to a woman fearing the Lord.

*Ipfæ Laudabitur: She ſhall be praiſed.*

She shall be so; but may not that labour be spared? For a man would thinke, she hath been praised all this while; because Godly Feare, the Grace of God in Her, and the onely cause of her Praise, hath beene alreadie so much commended vnto you? No (Beloued) my Text (you see) applies and appropriates this praise to *Ipſa*, Her own Person, by vertue indeed of *the Feare of the Lord*. For were it not for that, it were better Contemning Her, yea Contending<sup>[183]</sup> with Her, than Commending Her, because that is a constant marke of the Godly to Contemne the vngodly, *Pſal.* 15. 4. This, of the wicked to Praise the wicked, to Blesse the Couetous, whom *the Lord abhorreth*, *Pſal.* 10. 3. It is not her Friendship, no nor *Carnis bona* (as Saint *Ierom*<sup>[184]</sup> calls them) *the Good endowments of the flesh*, can priuiledge him from a *Curſe*, if so be, he praise her without or aboue<sup>[185]</sup> her Deserts, *Prou.* 27. 14. Onely *the feare of the Lord*, with the excellent fruits thereof, is Gods Gift<sup>[186]</sup>, for which (saith *Fulgentius*<sup>[187]</sup>) she ought, and he may safely commend her, because then, not shee; but *Gods Grace* in her is *Praised*, *Epheſ.* 1. 6. Yea then, *not she*, but *God himſelfe is Glorified* in Her, *Gal.* 1. 24.

II.  
*The thing promised.*

*In what respect to*  
*Ipſa.*

## FOOTNOTES:

<sup>[171]</sup> *Pſal.* 34. 9, 10. *Ecclef.* 40. 26, 27. & 1. 16.

<sup>[172]</sup> *Prou.* 15. 16.

<sup>[173]</sup> *Pſal.* 25. 14.

<sup>[174]</sup> *Mal.* 2. 5.

<sup>[175]</sup> *Pſal.* 25. 12.

<sup>[176]</sup> *Mal.* 3. 16.

<sup>[177]</sup> *Mal.* 4. 2.

<sup>[178]</sup> *Pſal.* 31. 20, 21.

<sup>[179]</sup> *Ecclef.* 33. 1.

<sup>[180]</sup> *Pſal.* 147. 11.

<sup>[181]</sup> *Pſalm.* 103. 13. *Mal.* 3. 17.

<sup>[182]</sup> *Pſal.* 145. 19.

But what? is not *She Praised*, when Her Husband, Her Children, Her Kindred, Her Friends, Her Attendants, Her Wit, Her Wealth, Her Beautie, Her Nobilitie, or all these and the like of Hers are commended? Yes, all these come very neere Her, and mutually receiue lustre and eminencie from this Godly Feare; but they are not *Ipfa*, Her selfe, that is,<sup>[188]</sup> principally Her Soule truly Generous, and ennobled with the *Feare of the Lord*. Vntill such an Humble Soule be found in Her, She is not She, that *shall be adorned with the Garment of praise*, *Efai. 61. 3.* Therefore Saint *Ierom*<sup>[189]</sup> would not commend in Noble *Marcella* any thing saue Her owne Godly selfe. *Ipfa Laudabitur*: She is She that shall be Praised.

### FOOTNOTES:

<sup>[183]</sup> Prou. 28. 4 & 24. 24. & 17. 15. Eccl. 10. 23, 29. Tho. Aquin. 22. q. 115. a. 2. Corp.

<sup>[184]</sup> *Ego carnis bona quæ semper & ipse contempnit, in animæ laudibus nō requiram—ad Heliodor. Epitah. Nepot.*

<sup>[185]</sup> Prou. 27. 14. *Vox autem grandis, laus excedens mensurā Meritorum hīs intelligitur—Parif. de Moribus. fol. 123. lit. M.*

<sup>[186]</sup> *Ef. 26. 12. 1 Cor. 15. 10. & 12. 6. Phil. 2. 13. Ier. 32. 40.*

<sup>[187]</sup> *Laudari in bonis operibus debes; sed in eo quod operaris, hominū laudes expectare non debes—Deus Laudetur in operibus tuis. De statu Vidu. ad Gallam epist. 2. Si qua fane in Sanctis digna laude vel admiratione intueor, clarā luce veritatis discutiens, profectò reperio Laudabilem siue Mirabilem alium apparere atque alium effe, & Laudo Deum in Sanctis eius. S. Bern. Ser. 13. in Cant.*

<sup>[188]</sup> *1 Pet. 3. 4. Enimverò quis non animæ dabit summam omnem, cuius nomine totius Hominis mentio titulata est. Tertul. de Anima. cap. 13.*

And so we see how far forth Praise is to be extended to Her. Now to speak of the Extent of Her Praise: Let the word haue his full latitude. *Laudabitur* is generall, no kinde is limited. 1. Therefore for the Extent, to be praised euery manner of way. 2. For the Time when it shall be best for her. 3. For the Praiser, by him who can best doe it. Of all these briefly.

First, what praise she shall haue. 1. Euen that (which being true) is euer accompanied with Dearest Loue to her person<sup>[190]</sup>. 2. Highest estimation of Gods abundant

I.  
What Praise she  
shall haue. The

graces in Her<sup>[191]</sup>. 3. Frequent Commemoration of them<sup>[192]</sup>. 4. Moderate Lamentation at her Death<sup>[193]</sup>. 5.

*Extent of  
Laudabitur.*

Solemne Funerals according to the Dignitie of her place<sup>[194]</sup>. 6. And aboue all, with precise imitation of her excellent Vertues<sup>[195]</sup>. All this Honour God allowes Her, that honours Him with His Feare<sup>[196]</sup>. But because all Praise is properly in Words (as the Schoole-man teacheth<sup>[197]</sup>) and better words shee cannot haue to praise Her, than God himselfe speakes<sup>[198]</sup>, therefore she shall be Commended in no other, neither in regard of God, nor of her Husband, Children, Kindred, Seruants, and Gods People.

First in respect of God, she shall be praised for One of his Excellent<sup>[199]</sup>, Hidden Ones<sup>[200]</sup>: for one of his Iewels, which hee will make vp<sup>[201]</sup>: for His Daughter<sup>[202]</sup>, His Sister<sup>[203]</sup>, His Mother<sup>[204]</sup>, His Spouse<sup>[205]</sup>, His Loue<sup>[206]</sup>, His Doue<sup>[207]</sup>, His Faire<sup>[208]</sup> one, as Faire as the Moone, as Pure as the Sun<sup>[209]</sup>: as the Moone by inherent, and as the Sun, by imputed Righteousnesse. To her Husband she shall bee commended, as the Louing Hinde and pleasant Roe<sup>[210]</sup>, the Desire of his eyes<sup>[211]</sup>; An Helpe like vnto Himselfe<sup>[212]</sup>; His Companion<sup>[213]</sup>; for A Pillar of rest<sup>[214]</sup>, so that He shall haue no need of spoile<sup>[215]</sup>; for a Good Portion<sup>[216]</sup>, a speciall Fauour<sup>[217]</sup> and Gift of the Lord<sup>[218]</sup>; a Double Grace<sup>[219]</sup>, Doubling the number of his Daies<sup>[220]</sup>, Fattening his bones<sup>[221]</sup>, and making him knowne in the Gates, when he sitteth among the Elders of the Land<sup>[222]</sup>: for a Tower against Death vnto him<sup>[223]</sup>: A greater Blessing vnto him than either House or Inheritance<sup>[224]</sup>, Aboue children and the Building of a Citie to continue his Name<sup>[225]</sup>, yea for a Crowne vnto her Husband<sup>[226]</sup>, not a Gold-ring on his finger; nor a chaine of Gold about his necke, nor a Brouche in his hat; but for a Crowne vpon his head (an Ornament more conspicuous and eminent than the former, the Principall Ensigne of Princes<sup>[227]</sup>) gracing him that hath her, as much as a Crown doth Him that weareth it: so that there is none aboue her, that feareth the Lord<sup>[228]</sup>, None greater than she, not Great Men, nor Iudges, nor Potentates<sup>[229]</sup>: Her Grace is aboue Gold<sup>[230]</sup>. Her Price is farre aboue Rubies<sup>[231]</sup>. Her Continent minde cannot be valewed<sup>[232]</sup>, and by reason of Her, her Husband is a Blessed Man<sup>[233]</sup>, Not like other men<sup>[234]</sup>.

## FOOTNOTES:

[189] ... *Nihil in illâ laudabo, nisi quod proprū est. S. Ierom ad Princip. And so of Paula he faith. Nihil laudabimus nisi quod proprium est & de purissimo sanctæ mentis fonte profertur. Id. ep. ad Eustoch. Nam cum omnia opera sua laudauerit Deus, cælum, terram &c. vbi ad Hominē vētum est, solus non videtur esse laudatus propter quem omnia generata sūt. Quæ igitur causa est, nisi fortè ea, quia alia in specie sunt, Homo in occulto? quia aliorum Gratia foris, huius intus est. Aliorum in Natiuitate, huius in Corde.—Ideo ergò homo non antè laudatur, quia non in forensi pelle, sed in interiore Homine antè probandus, sic prædicandus est. S. Ambros. Infit. Virg. cap. 3. tom. 1.*

[190] 2 Ioh. 1. 1. Hebr. 13. 1. Ephef. 5. 25.

[191] 1 Theff. 5. 13.

[192] Mark. 14. 9. Pſal. 112. 6.

[193] Gen. 23. 2. Ioh. 11. 33, 35. 1 King. 14. 13. 1 Thef. 4. 13. Ecclef. 22. 11, 12 & 38. 16, 17.

[194] Act. 8. 2. 2 Chron. 32. 33.

[195] Iam. 5. 10. Hebr. 12. 1. & 13. 7. 1 Cor. 11. 1.

[196] 1 Sam. 2. 30. Deut. 26. 19. Ioh. 12. 26. Esai. 8. 13. *Timor Hominis, Dei Honor est. Tert. de Pænit. c. 7*

[197] Tho. Aquin. 22. q. 103. a. 1. ad 3.

[198] Pſal. 12. 6.

[199] Pſal. 16. 3.

[200] Pſal. 83. 3.

[201] Mal. 3. 17.

[202] 2 Cor. 6. 18,

[203] Cant. 4. 9.

[204] Matth. 12. 50.

[205] Hof. 2. 19.

[206] Cant. 2. 10.

[207] Cant. 2. 14.

[208] Cant. 2. 13.

[209] Cant. 6. 10.

[210] Prou. 5. 19.

[211] Ezek. 24. 16. Ecclef. 36. 22.

[212] Gen. 2. 18. Ecclef. 36. 24.

[213] Mal. 2. 14.

[214] Ecclef. 36. 24.

[215] Prou. 31. 11.

[216] Ecclef. 26. 3, 23.

[217] Prou. 18. 22.

[218] Ecclef. 26. 14.

[219] Ecclef. 26. 15.

[220] Ecclef. 26. 1.

[221] Ecclef. 26. 13.

[222] Prou. 31. 23.

[223] Ecclef. 26. 22.

[224] Prou. 19. 14.

[225] Ecclef. 40. 19.

[226] Prou. 12. 4. *Non annulus, non torques aureus, non monile, fed Corona.*  
*Cartw. in Prou.*

[227] P<sup>sa</sup>l. 21. 3. E<sup>st</sup>h. 2. 17

[228] Ecclef. 25. 10.

[229] Ecclef. 10. 24.

[230] Ecclef. 7. 19.

[231] Prou. 31. 10.

[232] Ecclef. 26. 14. 15.

To Her Children shee shall be Commended; because by her they haue a place of Refuge<sup>[235]</sup>; by Her they haue good meanes to bring and continue true Honour vpon them<sup>[236]</sup>, and if They (the Fruit) be a great Blessing<sup>[237]</sup> (as it is to haue Issue by such a One) what is the Root that beareth it<sup>[238]</sup>?

But I must hasten: How shall she be Praised in respect of her Parents? euen as *Rachel*<sup>[239]</sup> for doing seruice to them as to her Masters (the true propertie of one that *feareth the Lord*<sup>[240]</sup>.) In respect of her kindred by mariage, as *Ruth*,



louing them<sup>[241]</sup>, Dealing kindly with them<sup>[242]</sup>, and Cleauing vnto them<sup>[243]</sup>. And in respect of her kindred by bloud, as *Eſther*, who did the Commandement of *Mordecai* when ſhe was a Queene, like as when ſhe was brought vp with Him<sup>[244]</sup>, who was exceedingly grieued at his Griefe<sup>[245]</sup>, and procured the Enlargement and Deliuerance of her kindred with her *Feaſts*<sup>[246]</sup>, her *Teares*<sup>[247]</sup>, and the Hazard of her *Life*<sup>[248]</sup>.

In regard of her Seruants alſo, ſhe ſhall be commended becauſe ſhe Buildeth her Houſe<sup>[249]</sup>: *Shee is like the Merchants ſhip, She fetcheth her food from farre*<sup>[250]</sup>, *She giueth meat to her Houſhold*<sup>[251]</sup>, *She cloatheth them all with Scarlet*<sup>[252]</sup>, and *Shee looketh ſo well to their waies*<sup>[253]</sup>, that *As the Sunne when it ariſeth in the high Heauen; So is her beautie in the Ordering of her Houſe*<sup>[254]</sup>.

Laſtly, becauſe all the Eſſentiall Glory and Faireneſſe, which is to bee found in the whole Church, *The Woman cloathed with the Sunne*<sup>[255]</sup>, as that of Iuſtification & Sanctification &c. belongs to euery Member of the Church<sup>[256]</sup>, and cōſequently to euery *Woman fearing the Lord*, therefore to Gods people ſhe ſhall be commended, as one of the Hands of the Church *dropping with ſweet ſmelling Mirrhe*<sup>[257]</sup>: as the *Curtaines of Salomon*<sup>[258]</sup>; *As a Lilly among thornes*<sup>[259]</sup>; *A Garden incloſed: A Spring ſhut vp. A Fountain ſealed*<sup>[260]</sup>.

## FOOTNOTES:

[233] *Ecclef.* 26. 1.

[234] *Ecclef.* 36. 23. *Sine Muliere igitur Homo non habet Laudem, in Muliere prædicatur, &c. S. Ambros. Inſtit. Virg. cap. 3. tom. 1.*

[235] *Prou.* 14. 26. & 11. 22.

[236] *Deut.* 5. 29. *Pfal.* 112. 2.

[237] *Pfal.* 127. 3.

[238] *Pfal.* 128. 3.

[239] *Gen.* 29. 9.

[240] *Ecclef.* 3. 7.

[241] *Ruth.* 4. 15.

[242] *Ruth.* 1. 8.

[243] *Ruth.* 1. 14. & c. 2. 11

[244] *Eſth.* 2. 20.

[245] *Eſth.* 4. 4.

[246] *Eſth.* 4. 16.

[247] *Eſth.* 8. 3.

[248] *Eſth.* 4. 11, 16.

[249] *Prou.* 14. 1.

[250] *Prou.* 31. 14.

[251] *Prou.* 31. 15.

[252] *Prou.* 31. 21.

[253] *Prou.* 31. 27.

[254] *Ecclef.* 26. 16.

[255] *Reuel.* 12. 1.

But when ſhall ſhee haue all this Praise and of whom? Not by and by, nor of Euery one<sup>[261]</sup>, for Praise is not comely in the mouth of euery one, of euery ſcoffing *Iſhmael*.

But firft of the Time.

II.  
*When ſhe ſhall be  
Praiſed.*

Many when they heare a Promiſe (and a Promiſe I told you at firſt, this is) thinke to haue it by and by; but they marke not, that a Promiſe and the Fruition of it is not all at once. It muſt be waited for<sup>[262]</sup>, eſpecially this Promiſe of Praise: *Vntill the Lord come* (as the Apoſtles limit the Time) *and then*, at his Appearing, *ſhe ſhall haue praiſe of God*<sup>[263]</sup>. *Then at his Appearing*<sup>[264]</sup>, *Her Faith ſhall be found vnto Praise and Honour, and Glory*. Therefore in the mean while, beſt for her to *Feare the Lord*, and ſo be praiſe-worthy, than to be praiſed for the preſent.

1. Not only becauſe it is ſafeſt praifing Her as a Maſter of a ſhip is (ſaith S. Ambroſe<sup>[265]</sup>) when ſhe is ſafely arriued in the Hauen, paſt all danger of ſhipwracke: or growing more proud by her praiſe (which many Liuing doe) as *Herod* for one<sup>[266]</sup>, and that Philoſopher for another, whoſe ſoule being before no bigger than a mans finger, became ſo puft vp and ſwolne with others commending him, that (as *Arrianus* reports) it grew greater than two Cubits<sup>[267]</sup>.

## FOOTNOTES:

[256] *Gal. 3. 28. Epheſ. 4. 15.16. Cant. 2. 10.—Cum ipſos cogitatis amantes, non virum & Fæminam, ſed verbum &c. Animam ſentiat, oportet. Et ſi Chriſtum & Eccleſiam dixerō, idem eſt, niſi quod Eccleſiæ nomine non vna Anima, ſed multarum vnitas, vel potius vnanimitas deſignatur. S. Bern. ſerm. 61. in Cant.*

[257] *Cant. 5. 5.*

[258] *Cant. 1. 5.*

[259] *Cant. 2. 2.*

[260] *Cant. 4. 12.*

[261] *Luk. 6. 26. Eccleſ. 15. 9.*

[262] *Eſay 28. 16. 30. 18. 40. 31. 64. 4. Heb. 10. 36, 37, 38. Hab. 2. 3, 4.*

[263] *1 Cor. 4. 5.*

[264] *1 Pet. 1. 7. Et nos ergò nō a nobis laudem exigamus, nec præripiamus iudicium Dei & præueniamus ſententiam iudicis, ſed ſuo Tempori, ſuo Iudici reſervemus. S. Ambros. in Luc. l. 8. c. 17. tom. 5. 2 Tim. 2. 5. Eccleſ. 11. 27.28.*

[265] *Nam si laudari antè Gubernator non potest quam in portum nauem deduxerit: quomodò laudabis Hominē prius quàm in stationem mortis successerit? S. Ambr. de Bono Mort. c. 8. tom. 4. Meritò ergò differtur, vt sequatur fœnerata eius Laudatio, cuius dilatio non dispendium; sed incrementum est ... Et ideo laudatio eius non in exordio; sed in fine est. Nemo enim nisi legitimè certauerit, coronabitur. Ideoq, sapiens tibi dicit: Antè mortem non laudes hominem quemquam. Ratio. Quia in fine hominis nudantur opera eius. Id. Instit. Virg. c. 3. tom. 1.*

2. Nor only becaufe actuall praise is in the lips of the praiser, and so a wicked woman may be praised, and yet not be worthy of it, and a godly woman may be praise-worthy, and yet not haue it, whereas praise-worthinesse is euer in the partie to be praised, and fewest (you know) haue this worth; but many haue praise without it, therefore praise-worthinesse is the Nobler Grace of the two, and consequently best for a Woman to be worthy of praise, though she be not praised for the present.

3. But one of the chiefest Reasons is this; becaufe indeed all our earthly praise is *Laudatur*, that is, for the present; but continueth not. Is, but shall not be. Sometimes a godly woman is commended, and sometimes she is not. As *S. Paul* praised the *Corinthians*<sup>[268]</sup>, *Now I praise you Brethren*, and by and by he saith: *Shall I praise you in this? I praise you not*: whereas This praise here promised so Is, that it *shall be* still, and that cannot be in this Transitory world; but in Heauen, where Her praise that feareth the Lord for euer, endureth for euer: *Laudabitur, She shall be praised*.

The best Time then for commending Her is yet to come, and that from Him who can best doe it; But I must tell you first, this Time should neuer come, could the scoffing *Ishmaels* of our daies be heard railing vpon, iesting at, belying and flandering Her and Him *that feareth the Lord*. It was euer their Deuillish propertie<sup>[269]</sup> with many disgracefull censures to dimme the glory of the children of Light, spitefully to aggrauate their tender frailties, rather than to commend their vnreproueable Graces. So of old they scourged the Primitiue Christians with their viperous, virulent tongues<sup>[270]</sup>; but as Saint *Ierome* thanks God that He was counted worthy to be hated of the world<sup>[271]</sup>; so should euery good man and woman, not much trouble themselues for the vniust censures and disconceits of witleffe and worthlesse prophanenesse; but rather (as *Paulinus*<sup>[272]</sup> exhorts) haue more

III.  
*Of whom shee shal  
be praised.*

regard to their good name, left any sparkle or appearance of euill truly proceed from them, whereby any flame of euill report may be kindled, and so to liue, that none may speake euill of them without lying. For maugre the malice of all Sensualists, the Time will come, when euery man and woman that feareth God, shall haue praise of God<sup>[273]</sup>, 1 Cor. 4. which is the best praise, when all is done<sup>[274]</sup>, 2 Cor. 10. Yea (Beloued) that you may not count *the Lord flacke* concerning his promise<sup>[275]</sup>, Saint Iames tells you, *This comming of the Lord draweth neere*<sup>[276]</sup>: *Behold the Iudge standeth at the doore, He is readie to iudge the Quicke and the Dead* (saith Saint Peter<sup>[277]</sup>) readie to commend them, whom the world hath condemned; and to condemne them, whom worldlings haue commended: readie to reueale vnto the whole world the good workes of the godly, *Honorifico pietatis testimonio*, with an honourable approbation of their blessed godlinesse; & also to reueale vnto the whole world the wicked Deeds of the vngodly, *Manifesto impietatis vituperio*, with a publike, and open, vncontrouleable Discommendation of their curfed wickednesse<sup>[278]</sup>: yea the Iudge is ready to turne *Laudabitur* into *Laudatur*, her praise worthinesse that feareth Him for euer, into euerlasting Praise; so that should her Husband and Children faile to praise Her, which yet they do not, for they commend Her in the 29. verse of this Chapter, saying: *Many daughters haue done vertuously; but thou excellest them all*<sup>[279]</sup>: or should the Godly cease to praise Her, which they will neuer do either here or in Heauen<sup>[280]</sup>. Here Her remembrance is so sweet in all their mouthes, that they say:<sup>[281]</sup> Let her Memory be blessed: *Let her bones flourish out of her place*; and *Let the name of Her that was honoured be continued vpon her Children*<sup>[282]</sup>: or should Her owne workes giue ouer praising Her in the Gates, which they are forbidden to doe, vers. 31. of this Chapter; yet God himselfe will haue *Her workes follow her to Heauen*<sup>[283]</sup>, and *Accepting of her*<sup>[284]</sup>, and *Them, by Christ Iesus*<sup>[285]</sup>, *Hee himselfe will praise Her, that hath made Him Her Feare*<sup>[286]</sup>, *Her praise*<sup>[287]</sup>, saying: *Well done thou good and faithfull seruant, thou hast beene faithfull ouer a few things, I will make thee ruler ouer many things, Enter thou into the ioy of thy Lord*<sup>[288]</sup>. Where it is best to leaue Her, euen with her Lord, taking more ioy (as a Schoole-man teacheth truly) in praising Him, than in contemplating her owne praise, in Glorifying God, than in her owne Glorification<sup>[289]</sup>.

## FOOTNOTES:

[266] Act. 12. 21.

[267] Arrian. *Epict.* l. 3. c. 2.

[268] 1 Cor. 11. 1, 22

[269] 2 Kings 9. 11. Act. 24. 5. & 26. 24. Neh. 6. 13.

[270] Tert. *Apolog.* c. 7. &c. Arnob. *aduerf. Gent. M. Fælix in Octau.*

[271] *Gratias ago Deo meo, quod dignus fum, quem mundus oderit. S. Ierom. Afellæ.*

[272] *Ephef. 5. 15. Phil. 4. 8, 9. 2 Cor. 8. 20. 1 Pet. 2. 12. Heb. 11. 39. Eccl. 41. 12.—Nec ex nobis fcintilla procedat, per quam aduerfus nos finiftræ famæ flamma confletur—Nos id agamus, vt malè de nobis nemo loqui, abfque Mendacio poffit. Paulin. epift. ad Celant.*

[273] 1 Cor. 4. 5.

[274] 2 Cor. 10. 18. Iob. 12. 43.

[275] 2 Pet. 3. 9.

[276] *Iam.* 5. 8, 9.

[277] 1 Pet. 4. 5.

[278] Mat. 25. 34, 41.

[279] *Prou.* 31. 28, 29.

[280] *Cant.* 6. 9.

[281] *Ecclef.* 39. 10. *Ecclef.* 44. 15. *Ecclef.* 49. 1.

[282] *Ecclef.* 46. 11, 12.

[283] *Reuel.* 4. 13.

[284] *Gen.* 4. 4. Act. 10. 35. 1 Pet. 2. 5.

[285] *Hebr.* 13. 15.

[286] *Efai.* 8. 13.

[287] *Deut.* 10. 21.

[288] *Matth.* 25. 21.

But though we haue brought a Godly Woman where ſhe would be, to Heauenly Praise, and Honour, and Glory, and found them by Gods free

fauour in Chrift giuen vnto Her; yet who is fuch a Woman? We haue not found Her yet; and why not yet? Because among other reafons, as Saint *Ierom* was afraid to entreat of the Death of that Venerable Matron *Paula*<sup>[290]</sup>; fo am I to fpeake of the Deceafe of this Honourable Lady. Therefore giue me leaue (beloued) to deferre the vncomfortable Paffions of her Death, vntill I be a little better heartened by relating fome of the laudable actions of her Life.

For the fubiect then of my Text, I dare fay, in regard of the Defcription thereof, your owne confciences haue made the Application, and doe witneffe for Her, that She was *A Woman fearing the Lord*. A Woman indeed, & fo the *Weaker Veffell*<sup>[291]</sup>, yet neuertheleffe Honour to be giuen Her in that refpect; but rather the more (as Saint *Peters* inference will allow) because though fhee had *This Treafure of the Feare of the Lord in an Earthen and in a Weaker Veffell*<sup>[292]</sup>, yet Gods ftrengh was made perfect in her Weakneffe. And it is S. *Ieroms* rule<sup>[293]</sup>, you fhould iudge of Vertues, *Non Sexa, fed Animo*: Not by the Sex, but by the Minde and conftant purpofe of a Regenerate Heart: This makes the Difference of force in the feruice of Chrift, not either Male or Female.

*Application. The  
Lady deceafed.  
Mulier Timēs  
Dominum.*

Suruey then (if you please) as briefly as you wil, the feuerall workings of Her Godly Feare.

## FOOTNOTES:

[289] *Perfecta Die laudatio magis animā perficit, quàm Dei fruitio, quia magis lætatur in Gloriâ & plus gaudebit de Dei gloriâ & honore, quàm de fuâ Glorificatione, & plus iocundabitur in laudando Dominū, quàm in confiderādo proprium bonū. Bonau. l. 3. d. 1. q. 1, p. 66. A fclm. Profolog. c. 15. & 16.*

[290] *Quid agimus anima? cur ad mortem eius venire formidas?—S. Ier. Epitaph. Paulæ. Epift. ad Principiam. Gal. 3. 28.*

[291] *1 Pet. 3. 7.*

[292] *Efaï. 33. 6. 2 Cor. 4. 7.*

[293] *—Non confiderantes Holdam & Annam ac Debboram, viris tacētibus prophetaffe, & in feruitute Chrifti nequaquam differentiam Sexuum valere; fed Mentium. S. Ierom. Euftoch.*

Firſt to Her Head, her Subiection and Helpfulneſſe like that of Saint *Auguſtines* Mother to his Father<sup>[294]</sup>.

*The workings of  
Godly feare in  
regard of Her:  
Husbād: Children.*

To Her Children, her tenderest Affection and Sollicitouſneſſe to plant *the feare of the Lord* in their hearts, to fit them with worthy Matches out of Religious Families, to adorne her onely Sonne with the richeſt endowments of Grace and Learning: Witneſſe her Letters to that Learned Profefſour<sup>[295]</sup> in our famous Vniuerſitie, worthy to be kept as a Monument of her truly Noble ſpirit and Godly Deſire (like that of *Gregory Nazianzen's* Siſter) to haue the fruit of her Body become the fruit of the Spirit<sup>[296]</sup>.

To Her Parents, ſhee was another *Rachel*, another *Marcella*<sup>[297]</sup>.

*Parents.*

To Her Kindred by mariage another *Ruth*, and to them by bloud another *Hefter*.

*Kindred.*

To Her Seruants, ſhee was bountifull in their Health; compaſſionate (as *Fabiola*<sup>[298]</sup>) in their Sickneſſe, either of Minde or of Body, prouiding for them (like the Centurion) both ſpirituall and corporall Phyſicke.

*Seruants.*

To All, Her whole Deportment was ſo Louely, ſo ſweet, what *by the law of kindneſſe in her tongue*<sup>[299]</sup>, Salutations, Gifts, Almes-Deeds, Viſitations, Inuitations, and by other offices of courteſies and Hoſpitalities, that Her Amiable Behauiour was a powerfull Meanes, an attractiue Load-ſtone to draw vnto Her the hearts and loues of as many as knew Her, yea as but heard of Her.

*Religious  
Deportmēt to all.*

But vnto Gods children ſhe euer only afforded the deareſt pangs, the higheſt Degree of her kindeſt Affection<sup>[300]</sup>: Their company ſhe moſt loued, and they Hers. Not ſo much in regard of Her fauour towards them, which was great; but chiefly by reaſon of that ſpiritual Helpe and refreshment, which they might get by conuerſing with Her in the choiceſt paſſages of Sanctification. For ſhee had the Art to vphold holy conferences about perplexities of conſcience, Relapſes into ſin, and Remedies againſt the ſame: Shee had the

*Eſpecially vn-vnto  
Gods people.*



skill to beget many ioyfull Meditations of mortifying Grace and euerlasting Glory: She had the Zeale to nourish Heauenly mindednesse, boldnesse in the waies, and cheerefulnesse in the exercises of Religion and Deuotion.

### FOOTNOTES:

[294] *S. Aug. Confeff. lib. 9. cap. 9.*

[295] *Doct. Prideaux Rector of Exceter College in Oxford.*

[296] *Greg. Nazian. in Laudem Gorgon. Orat. 25.*

[297] *S. Ier. ad Princip. Nusquam sine Matre &c.—*

[298] *Id. Epitaph. Fabiola.*

[299] *Prou. 31. 26.*

Touching Her submissiō to the Meanes of Saluation: O what delight shee tooke here and in *London*, to heare conscionable and searhing Sermons! It was Her onely Pleasure in that Citie (as she professed) to frequent them there; yea what Griefe was it vnto Her (as it was vnto Saint *Ambrose*) to heare of the Death of any of Gods zealous Minifters<sup>[301]</sup>?

*Constant vse of the  
Meanes of  
Saluation.*

And should I be filent, yet Her Oratory in her house hereby, this Church too (a part whereof her Zeale, together with her Honourable Husbands Loue to Gods House newly erected) that Closset also of Hers in *Truro*, yea euery place almost would speake aloud of her constant reading, hearing, meditating on the Word, solemne Humiliations, solitary conferences with her God, feruent prayers and eiaculations, which (as the sweetest incense) shee euer and anon sent vp to the Throne of Grace for the pardon of her finnes, the fauour of God, the spirituall Good of her Dearest Husband, Children, and Gods Church.

### FOOTNOTES:

[300] *Pfal. 16. 3. Pfal. 119. 63, 79. Gal. 6. 10. 1 Pet. 2. 17. Coloff. 1. 4.*

[301] *Paulin. in Vita D. Ambrof.*

But adde vnto all theſe, another more ſpeciall, eſſentiall, and ſuperiour working of Her Godly Feare, and that was Her continuall Combating againſt all ſinne, euen Her moſt commanding ſin whatſoeuer that was<sup>[302]</sup>. For there

*Vnfained Reſolution  
to mortifie her moſt  
preuailing Sinne.*

was a time to my knowledge, when after the preaching vnto Her of the power and efficacie of Gods promiſes, and of Chriſts Death and Reſurrection, for the mortifying and maſtering of any boſome and beloued ſinne, you might eaſily ſee in Her, how willingly ſhe yeelded vnto the Sanctifying worke of the Holy Ghoſt for the Ouer-comming of her ſtrongeſt corruptions, how heauily ſhee was diſpleaſed with relapſes into ſmaller offences of daily incurſion againſt the generall and conſtant purpoſe<sup>[303]</sup> of her heart not to ſinne in anything; how faithfully ſhe reſted vpon thoſe ſweeteſt<sup>[304]</sup> promiſes of God (which ſhe confeſſed ſhe had not erſt ſo well weighed) for the mortifying of ſpeciall infirmities, and how vnfainedly ſhee reſolued to ſet her Faith on worke, to draw not onely aſſurance of pardon from the Merit of Chriſts Death and Reſurrection; but alſo that Power and efficacie which is in them, to *Die to Sinne, and Liue to Righteouſneſſe*.<sup>[305]</sup>

## FOOTNOTES:

<sup>[302]</sup> *Pſal.* 18. 23. *Rom.* 7. 21, 22, 23, 24.

<sup>[303]</sup> *Pſal.* 119. 6, 8. *Act.* 11. 23.

<sup>[304]</sup> *Mic.* 7. 18. 1 *Ioh.* 1. 9. *Rom.* 6. 14. *Ez.* 36. 25. 2 *Cor.* 12. 7, 9.

<sup>[305]</sup> *Rom.* 6. 4, 5, &c. *Vis, inquam, illa Chriſti mortis nobis comunicatur, vt per hāc Chriſtivim moriamur peccato, ſicut Chriſtus peccato ſemel mortitus eſt, id eſt, non vt peccatum nobis non imputitur, (id enim ad Iuſtificationem pertinet) ſed vt peccati vis iam non ſit in nobis efficax, immo verò contrā freti vi illā Chriſti, cui per Spiritum Sanctum coniuncti ſumus, peccatum occidamus.— piſtiemò quia non ſatis eſt nō peccare; ſed etiam benè agere oportet, eadem vis illa Chriſti, quā victor peccati et mortis in carne noſtrā viuere cœpit Deo— nobiſcum comunicata facit vt &c.* *Beza epiſt. Theolog.* 45. p. 211.

This was the Life of this Elect Lady fearing the Lord, and therefore ſhe hath right and intereſt to all thoſe Honourable Attributes of Praise, which you heard euen now God himſelfe giue her in His owne words.

But O my Soule what doſt thou? Why art thou yet afraid to come to her Death? as if while I held my peace and were buſied in Her Praiſes, Her Death could be deferred?

*Bountie to the  
Poore.*

Alàs it could not by all the Meanes that were uſed. For *No man* (ſaith the Preacher) *hath power ouer the ſpirit to retaine the ſpirit*<sup>[306]</sup>. Then ſpeake of her Death I muſt, and yet (to make uſe of *S. Ierom's* words in a like caſe) *Quis poſſit ſiccis oculis Paulam narrare morientem*<sup>[307]</sup>? Who can relate the Death of the Lady *Frances Roberts* without ſhedding ſome Teares of Compaſſion, of Deuotion, yea and of Compunction too<sup>[308]</sup>? Shee deſerues ſome Teares from vs (Beloued) as well as from the Poore, weeping now and ſhewing the Coats and garments which this *Dorcas* made for them, while ſhe was with them<sup>[309]</sup>.

But to ſtop the current of them a little longer. Begin we with Gods mercifull preſeruation of Her in *London* from the noyſome Peſtilence; becauſe ſhe acknowledged it (as was meet) with humble Thankfulneſſe<sup>[310]</sup>. And then

*Thãkfulneſſe for  
Deliuerance from  
the Plague.*

remember, that vpon Her returne home, being ſummoned by Sickneſſe, by and by ſhe ſet her  *Houſe in order*, like *Hezekiah*; She ſpake to the Hearts of Her Children, Friends, and Seruants, that were then about Her (like *Iacob*) by putting them in remembrance of Her Departure and their Duties: She hungered and thirſted after the Body and Bloud of Her Deareſt Sauour, which ſhee receiued with Due Examination<sup>[311]</sup> of Her Knowledge; Faith; Loue and Repentance, with reuerent Geſture, heartie Thankfulneſſe, deuout Attention, and very Fruitfully to the greater ſtrengthning and refreshing of Her Soule then traueſſing for the other Life.

## FOOTNOTES:

<sup>[306]</sup> *Eccleſ. 8. 8.*

<sup>[307]</sup> *S. Ierom. Euſtoch. Epitaph. Paul.*

<sup>[308]</sup> *Neq, parũ diſtat inter has lachrymas Deuotionis & ætatis vtiq, iam virilis, atque eas quas primæus ætas inter infantiaë vagit' emiſit, lachrymas vtiq, pænitentiaë & confeſſionis. Veruntamen longè amplius vtriſque procèdunt aliæ quædã lachrymæ, quibus in funditur ſapor vini. Illas enim lachrymas verè in vinũ mutari dixerim, quæ Fraternæ Compaſſionis affectu in feruore prodeũt*

*charitatis, pro qua etiā ad horam tui ipsius immemor esse, sobria quadā ebrietate videris. S. Bern. in Epiph. Dom. Serm. 3.*

[309] Act. 9. 36.

[310] P<sup>sa</sup>l. 91. 7. P<sup>sa</sup>l. 50. 15. P<sup>sa</sup>l. 33. 1.

And now (Beloued) that she lieth on the bed of Languishing, we must not be austere in reprehending euery Infirmitie; but Pitifull in considering the tender frailtie of it.

*Worthy receiving  
the Sacrament.*

For what though shee were (as Sicke folke are commonly<sup>[312]</sup>) more Passionate than others, yea than Her selfe in Her health, yet if God iudgeth not according to the strange Effects and Symptoms of Her sicknesse, not according to the short moment and violent passions of Her Death; but according to the holy Actions of Her Health, the former Affections of Her Heart, and the Generall Course of Her Life<sup>[313]</sup>; then it is our Dutie, not seuerely to censure her passionatenesse, who by reason of the parching Feauer of the Spirit, as well as of the Body, was disquieted in her Imagination (as the Physitian of the body could discern) though not in her Memory. Consider therefore O Man (as that excellent Physitian of the Soule aduise thee<sup>[314]</sup>) if thou canst beare with a fraile Body, that thou must much more beare with a fraile Minde and Body too. Consider also O Man, that this her Pettishnesse did more wound her to the heart, than any iniury thou couldst presse her with. Neither doe I speake this to nourish passion in any, or to proue her Anger to be Sinne<sup>[315]</sup>; but to be a lesse Sinne, because her Spirituall and Bodily Distemper was so great, or rather because her Faith quenched the flame of this fiery passion in Christs Bloud, resolved and melted her heart into many penitent Teares afterwards. Oh, said she to me, (pressing her with *Dauids* example, P<sup>sa</sup>l. 131.) In my Health I could digest any iniury, and deemed it base and vngodly, not to be able to doe so; but now (I know not how) me thinkes I am ouer-tender in bearing them. I am impatient indeed, and then I weepe for my impatiencie. For I know (as she her selfe vrged) *The wrath of Man doth not accomplish the Righteousnesse of God*<sup>[316]</sup>.

*Passionatenesse by  
reason of Spiritual  
and Bodily Distemper.*

## FOOTNOTES:

[311] 1 Cor. 1. 28.

[312] [Greek: Dusareston hoi nosountes aporias hupo] *Eurip. Orest.*

[313] M<sup>r</sup>. *Greenham*. 1. Treat. for Afflict. Conf. fol. III. part 2.

[314] *Id. Of Death*, fol. 9. part 2.

Thus shee was Angrie with her selfe for being Angrie with others, and then (according to Saint *Ambroses* rule) it ceased towards them before the Sunne went down<sup>[317]</sup>; and was not this Holy Reuenge on her selfe a true fruit of Euangelicall Repentance? 2 Cor. 7. 11.

*Repentance for the  
fame.*

But aye me! me thinkes I now heare her groaning vnder the dolefull pangs of Death, vnder those pangs of which shee had foretold saying: I shall suffer much more ere I goe hence. And can any haue the heart to heare her groaning pangs, without renting his owne heart from his darling pleasure? without lamenting his owne finnes, which vnlesse he forsake betimes, will bring him to euerlasting Burnings<sup>[318]</sup>? or without learning to compassionate euery weake one, to afflit any one yeelding vp the Ghost, because (as Saint *Ambrose* giues the reason<sup>[319]</sup>) the holy Peopphet *Iob* desired the Blessing of one, that lyes a Dying: *Benedictio morituri, in me veniat: Let the blessing of him that is readie to die, come vpon me!*

*Her Agonie.*

## FOOTNOTES:

[315] *Vitemus ergò aut temperemus iracūdiam: ne fit eius aut in Laudibus exceptio, aut in vitijs exaggeratio. S. Ambr. Off. lib. 1. cap. 21.*

[316] *Iam. 1. 20. Pfalm. 4. 4.*

[317] *Ephef. 4. 26. Vel certè fic: Si irascimini, vobis irascimini, quia commoti estis, & non peccabitis. Qui enim sibi irascitur, quia citò cōmotus est, definit irasci alteri. Id. ibid.*

[318] *Ezek. 18. 13, 30.*

[319] —*Si quem viderimus pauperē moriturum, sumptu iuueamus, & dicat vnusquisq, nostrū: Benedictio morituri in me veniat: Si quē viderimus debilem, non deferamus, si quem in extremis positum, non relinquam*<sup>S</sup>. S. Ambros. de Bono Mort. cap. 8. tom. 4.

Let vs then, not yet, leaue this Departing Saint. For in the midst of this her Agonie, after shee had layen groaning many houres without any articulate or distinct speech, yet vpon triall made of Her sense and memory by demanding of Her, whether she would haue prayers made for Her, she answered plainly: With all my heart, pray, pray. And then as *Gregory Nazianzen*<sup>[320]</sup> reports of his Father, that though He was daily, yea hourly, in great paine before his Death, yet He was euer still and quiet from paine, onely while Diuine Seruice was saying; so this Deuout Lady forgetting (as it were) Her former Groanings, did listen attentiuely to the prayers that were made for Her, without fetching so much as one sob during that time. And afterwards rehearsing distinctly part of the Lords Prayer, you might heare Her, when S. *Stephens* Vision and last words<sup>[321]</sup> were read vnto Her, repeat very often these last words of Her Sauour<sup>[322]</sup>: *O Heauenly Father into thy hands I commend my spirit*. Thus on a sudden I haue told you how she *Dyed in the Lord*<sup>[323]</sup>, and is *with Christ*<sup>[324]</sup>.

Deuotion at Her  
Death.

And though we saw her afterwards mouing her lips; but heard not her Voice, no more than they that were at Saint *Ambroses* Death did heare his Voice; but only saw his lips moue<sup>[325]</sup>; yet we must not thinke *The Spirit of strength*<sup>[326]</sup>, of *Prayer and Grace*<sup>[327]</sup>, is then onely strong, when we heare a Dying Saint pray, because Christs Spirit cries in Gods Children, *Abba, Father*<sup>[328]</sup>, with Vnutterable Groanings<sup>[329]</sup> which we cannot heare, and therefore I doubt not, but this Elect Lady cried loudest in Gods eares, when we heard not her words; and why may we not thinke now, our sinnes hindered vs from hearing them? I am sure, heretofore she hath spoken againe and againe many Heart-piercing speeches to deterre from Sinne, and to allure to Holinesse of Life. If she be not hearkened to now, henceforth wee shall heare Her speake no more. *I charge you therefore before God and the Lord Iesus Christ, and the Elect Angells*:<sup>[330]</sup> you (I say) I charge whomsoever shee hath iustly reprobued for any Sin, that you forsake those Sins; and whomsoever she hath zealously exhorted to holy Duties, that you

performe those holy Duties, for henceforth you shall heare Her speake no more.

## FOOTNOTES:

[320] *Orat. 28. de Funere Patris. Tom. 2.*

[321] *Act. 7. 53, 56, 59.*

[322] *Luke 23. 46.*

[323] *Reuel. 14. 13.*

[324] *Phil. 1. 23.*

[325] *Paulin. in D. Ambrosii Vita.*

[326] *Esaï. 11. 2.*

[327] *Zach. 12. 10.*

But why should I detaine thee (Honourable Lady) any longer? Or what doe you (Beloued) expect more? That our speech also should Die together with Hers, and (as it were) be Buried together with Her. O my Blessed Brethren, suffer neither this Godly Lady, nor Gods word to depart so dishonourably from you.

Suffer not Her so to depart from you; but let her euer liue in your breasts by Esteeming Her very highly in loue for Her workes sake, by Commemorating Gods Graces in Her; but aboue all by Imitating her Faith and Vertues<sup>[331]</sup>. Then you shall not need to grieve very much for Her Absence from you; because she is *with Christ, which is best of all*<sup>[332]</sup>; because she is *Taken away*, not from you; but *from the euill to come*, *Esaï. 57. 1.* From you shee is not Taken, but from seeing the plagues and miseries of this wretched world, yea from seeing the future Deaths of you, Her Dearest friends<sup>[333]</sup>, for whom she would haue wept full bitterly; but you haue greater Cause, if you will heare *S. Ambrose* and *S. Ierome* comforting themselves in a like case, to Reioyce<sup>[334]</sup> and to giue God thanks<sup>[335]</sup>, that you Haue had Her, nay that you Haue Her, if so

*Conclufion. Sed quid ego te morer Frater? quid expectem? vt nostra tecum cōmoriatur et quasi confepeliatur oratio? S. Ambr. de Obitu fratris. Tom. 3.*

I.  
*Imitation of Her Vertues.*



be you follow Her good example, and represent her to the life by your Godly Life.

## FOOTNOTES:

[328] *Gal. 4. 6.*

[329] *Rom. 8. 26.*

[330] *1 Tim. 5. 21.*

[331] *Ideò laude oris ad Hominem vtimur, vt alios apud quos laudatur, in bonam opinionem, & Reuerentiam, & Imitationem ipsius inducamus. Thom. Aquin. 22. q. 91.*

To conclude: I beseech you all (Blessed Brethren) Suffer not the Word of God, which you haue heard this day, for want of the Feare of God, which is *The firmeſt foundation of Gods word*<sup>[336]</sup>, to vaniſh into aire, into nothing, to rebound from your flintie hearts (as a ſhaft ſhot againſt a wall of Adamant<sup>[337]</sup>;) but in Gods Name, Let the Sword of Gods Spirit ſunder euery one of our minion ſinnes from our boſomes: Let Gods pretious promiſe here of praiſing a *Woman that feareth the Lord*, feare vs from our ſtrongeſt corruptions. *Atq vtinam præconia fæminarum, imitarentur viri.* And I may well wiſh with Saint *Ierome*, that Men would emulate and imitate Women in their deſerued attributions of Praiſe<sup>[338]</sup>. Laſtly, if you deſire to know, beſides this motiue of obtaining Heauenly praiſe, what other Meanes you ſhould vſe to get, keepe and increaſe ſuch a godly Feare in you, then conſider the examples of Gods dreadfull iudgements<sup>[339]</sup> on them, that Feare Him not, yea on Chriſt Ieſus Himſelfe purſued for our ſins<sup>[340]</sup> to the fulneſſe of Bitterneſſe by the iuſtice of God, conſider that firſt. Then remember your owne Deaths to haue them before you<sup>[341]</sup>, remember your ſtrict Accounts to be made<sup>[342]</sup>, remember the reſtleſſe Terrour of Conſcience<sup>[343]</sup>, which followes the impenitent, and then or neuer you will *Feare the Lord Greatly*, as *Obadiah* and this Blessed Lady did. Be not deceiued (my Brethren) after

II.  
*Practiſe of Gods word.*

III.  
*Means to Godly Feare.*

IV.  
*So Great a Feare as muſt feare vs from our Boſome Sinne.*



all this Hearing, it is not a Little Feare will serue the turne. For to Feare God but a little (as *Fulgentius* faith) is to contemne Him very much<sup>[344]</sup>. It muſt bee at leaſt ſo Great a Feare, as muſt feare you from your Greateſt, your Sweeteſt Sinne whatſoeuer that be, elſe if you Die in it<sup>[345]</sup> without Repentance (which God forbid) your *Worme ſhall not die, neither ſhall your fire be quenched, and you ſhall be*, not a praiſe, but an *Abhorring to all fleſh*, the laſt verſe of the Prophet *Eſay* with *Iames* 2. 10.<sup>[346]</sup>, and *Ezekiel*. 18. 10, 11, 13.

## FOOTNOTES:

[332] *Phil.* 1. 23.—*Et Chriſtum lædimus cùm euocatos quoſque ab illo quaſi miſerandos non æquanimiſſimè accipimus. Cupio, inquit Apoſtolus, recipi iam ... Ergo votum ſi alios conſequutos impatientèr dolemus, ipſi conſequi nolumus. Tertul. de Patient. cap. 9. Temperet ſanè Dilecti Gaudiū, mæſtitiam deſolatorum, & tolerabilius fiat nobis, quod Nobiſcum non eſt, quia cum Deo eſt. Ber. in Cant. ſer. 27.*

[333] *Non enim nobis ereptus es, ſed periculis.—raptus eſt ne totius orbis excidia, mundi finem, propinquorū funera, &c. S. Ambroſ. de Obitu Fratrū. fol. 17.*

[334] *Lætandum eſt enim magis, quòd talem fratrem habuerim, quàm dolendum, quòd fratrem amiſerim. Illud enim munus, hoc debitum eſt. Idem ibid. fol. 13.*

[335] *Non mæremus quod talem amiſimus, ſed gratias agimus, quòd habuimus, immo habemus. S. Ierom. Epitaph. Paulæ.*

[336] *Baſis quædam Verbi eſt Timor ſanctus. Sicut enim ſimulachrum aliquod in Baſi ſtatuitur—ita verbum Dei in Timore Sancto melius ſtatuitur, fortiùs radicatur, hoc eſt, in pectore timentis Dominum—S. Ambros. in Pſal. 118. Serm. 5.*

[337] *Iam.* 1. 22. *Zach.* 7. 12.

[338] *S. Ierom. epiſt. ad Furiam.*

[339] *1 Cor.* 10. 11. *Reuel.* 14. 7.

[340] *Eſai.* 57. 11. & 53. 5. *Mat.* 27. 46.

[341] *Eccleſ.* 3. 14. *Iob* 7. 1. *Pſal.* 39. 4. & 90. 12.

[342] *2 Cor.* 5. 10. *Matth.* 12. 36.

[343] *Rom.* 2. 15. *Reu.* 6. 16. *Pſal.* 18. 23. *Prou.* 8. 13.

[344] —*Hunc ſi quis parum metuit, valde contemni—B. Fulg. de Myſt. Mediat. ad Trafim. l.2. pag. 215.*

[345] *Si in folo vno peccato decefferit Homo, irreuocabilitèr mittitur in ignem æternum—Gerfon. 2. p. de Mendicit. Spirit. lit. D & H. part. 3.*

[346] *Ex parte enim Auerfionis dicit Iacobus qui offendit in vno factus eft omnium reus, quia fcilicet vno peccato peccando incurrit pænæ reatum, ex hoc, quod contemnit Deum, ex cuius contemptu prouenit omnium peccatorū reatus. Aquin. 12. q. 73. a.1 ad fin. Peccatum enim remitti non poteft, quam difi Voluntas peccato adheret. Idem. p. 3. q. 87. a. 1. c. & q. 86. a. 2. c. Vnde non poteft effe vere pænitenſ, qui de vno peccato pænitet, & non de alio. Si enim difpliceret ei illud peccatum, quia eft contra Deum ſuper omnia dilectum—Sequeretur, quod de omnibus peccatis pæniteret. Id. q. 86. a. 3. c.*

Knowing therefore (as Saint Paul concludes<sup>[347]</sup>) the terrour of the Lord, we perſwade you (Bleſſed Brethren) to feare God Greatly, and to Giue Glory vnto Him<sup>[348]</sup>; then you ſhall haue praife of Him, then hee will glorifie you; and to ſay no more than this (with the Prophet Ieremie<sup>[349]</sup>), which will make the Fearleſſe Sinner inexcufable: Who would not feare thee O Lord, thou King of Nations, thou King of Saints? 1. For thou onely art Holy: 2. For all Nations ſhall come vnto thee, and worſhip thee: 3. For thy iudgements are made manifeſt<sup>[350]</sup>: 4. For there is none like vnto thee, that pardoneth Iniquitie, and paſſeth by the Tranſgreſſion of the remnant of thy Heritage<sup>[351]</sup>? Who would not Feare Thee ſuch an Almighty, All-ſeeing, Juſt, Mercifull Lord God? Put thy feare therefore in our Hearts (as thou haſt promiſed<sup>[352]</sup>) that wee may neuer depart from thee; but clinging inſeparably by a liuely faith, vnto the bleeding wounds of our Bleſſed Redeemer, may without all flauifh Feare<sup>[353]</sup> of Death and Iudgement, Louingly<sup>[354]</sup> appeare before thy Iudgement-ſeat, and without deſperate Crying to the mountains and rocks Fall on vs<sup>[355]</sup>, may ioyfully heare Thee ſay vnto vs: Come ye Bleſſed of my Father, Inherit the Kingdome prepared for you from the foundation of the world<sup>[356]</sup>.

V.  
Reasons to feare the Lord.

VI.  
Prayer for Godly Feare.

Which God grants vnto vs all, for the All-ſufficient Merits of his Deareſt Sonne, the Sweet Lord Ieſus: To whom with Himſelfe and the Holy Spirit be aſcribed All Praiſe, Honour, Glory, Power, Dominion and Maieſtie, now and euer. Amen. Amen.

FINIS.

## FOOTNOTES:

[347] 2 Cor. 5. 10, 11.

[348] Reuel. 14. 7.

[349] Ier. 10. 7.

[350] Reuel. 15. 4.

[351] Mic. 7. 18.

[352] Ier. 32. 39.

[353] *Si enim amamus Christum, vtiq aduentum eius defiderare debemus. Peruersum enim est, & nescio vtrum verū, quem diligis, timere ne veniat, orare, Veniat regnū tuū, & timere, ne exaudiaris. Vnde autem timor? ... Quisquis ergò futurū iudicē times, præsenti cōscientiā tuā corrige. S. Aug. in Psal. 147. tom 3.*

[354] 2 Tim. 4. 8.

[355] Reuel. 6. 16.

[356] Matth. 25. 34.

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# THE PRAISE OF A GODLY WOMAN.

A Sermon preached at the Solemne Funerall of the Right Honourable Ladie, the Ladie  
FRANCES ROBERTS, at *Lanbide-rock-  
Church in Cornwall*, the tenth of  
August, 1626.

By  
HANNIBALL GAMON, Minister of the word  
of God, at *S<sup>t</sup>. Mangan* in the same Countie.

---

1 Cor. 4. 5.

Therefore iudge nothing before the time, vntill the Lord come, who will bring to light the hidden things of darknesse, and will manifest the counsell of the hearts, and then shall euery man haue praise of God.

---

Galath. 3. 28.

There is Neither Iew nor Greeke,  
Neither Bond nor Free,  
Neither Male nor Female, for yee are all one in Christ Iesus.

---

St. Hierom. Eustoch.

— In seruitute Christi nequaquam Differentia sexuum valet, sed inextinguitur.

---

Idem ad Principiam.

Non facio ullam inter Sanctas Fœminas Differentiam, quod Nonnulli inter Sanctos Viros & Ecclesiarum Principes, stulte facere consueuerunt.

---

LONDON,

Printed by I. H. for Iohn Grismond, and are to be sold at his shop in  
*Ivie-Lane* at the signe of the Gunne. 1627.

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TO THE TRVLY  
NOBLE IOHN ROBERTS,  
Son and Heire to the Right Ho-  
norable RICHARD Lord ROBERTS  
of Truro: the Vnualuable Riches of  
Sincere Grace here, and of Eter-  
nall Glory hereafter.

HONOVABLE SIR,



Although it bee true  
(which a worthy  
Diuine<sup>a</sup> obserueth)  
that formall Hypo-  
crites are heartned  
and hardned in their  
lewd courses & false  
conceits of happi-  
nesse, when they heare more infamous Sin-  
ners than themselues, gloriously and flatte-  
ringly commended at their Deaths; yet we

<sup>a</sup> Mr. Salmer Diffe.  
of true Happi-  
nesse, p. 61.



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## THE EPISTLE

need not feare any such bad effect by the Funerall-commendation of Gods true Saints; because the publike Testimonie of their iust Praises doth not onely make the wicked more inexcusable, and the Glory of Gods Graces shine farre brighter to Posteritie; but also enkindleth in the hearts of the godly a greater fire of Zeale for imitation. These are some of the Ends, why it hath euer been and is still an vnreprouable Custom in Gods Church, that the Godly should be *Marked*<sup>b</sup> and *Honoured*<sup>c</sup> at their Deaths, as *Hezekiah* was by all *Judah & Ierusalem*: *Valentinean*, *Satyrus* and *Theodosius* by Saint *Ambrose*<sup>\*</sup>: *Basil*, *Gregory* and *Gorgonia* by *Nazianzen*<sup>¶</sup>: *Nepotian*, *Paula* and *Marcella* by *S. Ierom*<sup>†</sup>. Had not their Holy Liues and Happie Deaths beene published by such vnpartiall Pens, wee should haue bin ignorant now of many excellent Courses of sanctified Men and Women, of many comfortable workings of the Holy Ghost in them, and should haue wanted many inflaming Motiues to follow their religious steps. Vpon this consideration I was bold to commend vnto Gods people the more  
than

<sup>a</sup> Psalm. 37. 37.

<sup>b</sup> Dent. 34. 7, 10, 11.

<sup>c</sup> 12. Hebr. 3. 3. & 11. cap.

<sup>d</sup> 1 Chron. 32. 33.

<sup>e</sup> S. Amb. 10m. 3.

<sup>f</sup> Greg. Nazian.

Orat. {<sup>30.</sup>  
<sup>28.</sup>

<sup>†</sup> S. Ierom.

et { Heliod.  
Euseb.  
Princip.  
Occas.

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## DEDICATORIE.

than Ordinary passages of your Honourable Mothers Holy Life and Death: wherein I haue as a Christian spoken the truth of a Christian, that is, (as Saint *Ierom*<sup>d</sup> protesteth in a like case) made a true Narration; not a Vain-glorious Panegyrick. Let Poets and Oratours praise those women, which *Poppæa*-like<sup>e</sup>, are graced with all other things sauing a Gracious Heart: Let them commend their Wit, Wealth, Beautie, Nobilitie, and other Gifts of Fortune (as they call them) in stead of Vertues<sup>f</sup>. Wee the Ministers of Christ, and Stewards of the Mysteries of God, must adorne none with the Honourable Attributes of Heauenly Praise; but such as are truly beautified, enriched, and ennobled with the Purity and Power of Gods Feare in their Humble Soules<sup>\*</sup>. This praise the Lord will Prosper<sup>g</sup>, which is vttered in that *Wisdom*<sup>h</sup>, whereof the *Feare of the Lord is the beginning*. But for the Saints themselves: I dare say with Saint *Augustine*<sup>i</sup>, that they desire more the Imitation, than the Commendation *am defuncta, quantum se dilexit etiam dissimilem viua*; but also because her Husband loved Her not, which he proueth thus: *Nam viq; si amares, cum illa esset post mortem desiderares, quoniam profectò non eris, si qualis es, talis eris.*

<sup>d</sup> Testor Iesum cui illa seruauit & ego seruire cupio, ne utramq; in paritè nihil fingere, sed quasi christianus de christianâ quæ sunt vera proferre, id est, Historiam scribere non Panegyricum. S. Ierom. Epitaph. Paula.

<sup>e</sup> Poppæa cuncta alia fuere præter Honestum animum. Tacit. Annal. l. 13.  
<sup>f</sup> Laudauit ipse Nero apud rostra fortitiam eius & quiddam diuinae formae parentis suissis, atque fortuna munerata pro Virtutibus. Id. Annal. l. 16.

<sup>g</sup> Esai. 61. 3.  
<sup>h</sup> Eccles. 15. 10.  
<sup>i</sup> Prov. 9. 10.  
<sup>j</sup> Ep. 1. 25. where S. Augustine refuseth to commend vnto a wicked Husband his godly wife that was dead, not onely because she desired not his praise, saying: *Laudem ab hominibus iam illa non querit, imitationem vtrò tuam tantum querit etiam*

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## THE EPISTLE

on of their vertues; and therefore to tell you the truth (as the same Father doth his friend) you should neuer haue heard mee commend this deceased Lady; but in hope, that Gods Graces in Her might by this meanes, suruiue in your religious Imitation, and not only in you and all them that are of Her bloud; but also in all them that haue heard or shall reade this Sermon. This is all the gaine I looke and pray for, that Gods <sup>k</sup> word, which I haue faithfully alledged (not without some Illustrations (I confesse) borrowed from the holy Fathers <sup>l</sup>, whereof I need not to be ashamed) may be constantly practised by vs all. For when all is done and said, assure your selfe (Deare Sir) it is only the Life of Grace, the Grace of the *Feare of the Lord* can truly Honour you, or any vpon earth, sweetly comfort you at your Death, and eternally Glorifie your Soule and Bodie in Heauen. Abandon then I beseech you in the name of Christ <sup>m</sup>, all iniquitie, and all workers of iniquitie, yea abominate the sweetest sin, to which your youthfull affections are most endeared, else you will neuer be able to encline and enlarge

<sup>k</sup> Ier. 23. 12, 28.

<sup>l</sup> Pet. 4. 11. Tit. 2. 8.

<sup>2</sup> Tim. 2. 15.

<sup>2</sup> Tim. 4. 13. &

6. 3.

<sup>l</sup> -- Ingenus pado-  
re qui ornabat eta-  
tem, quid cuius es-  
set, confiteri. Illud  
(auebat) Tertullia-  
ni, illud Cypriani,  
hoc Lactantij, illud  
Hilarij est. Sic Mi-  
nucius Felix, ita  
Vulturnus in hunc  
modum est locutus  
Arnobius. S. Ieron.  
ad Heliodor de Ne-  
potian.

<sup>m</sup> 1 Theff. 3. 6.

<sup>2</sup> Tim. 2. 19. Pron.

4. 14. 1 Cor. 5. 11.

Ephes. 5. 11. Psalm.

26. 4, 5. & 119. 32,

36, 128. 2 Chron.

19. 2. & 20. 37.

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## DEDICATORIE.

large them to the pursuit and practise of so excellent and Glorious a Grace as the *Fear of the Lord*; because this godly Fear and the impenitent Allowance of any lust, is as incompatible as Heauen and Hell : so that if you should hate to be diuorced from your Bosome-sin whatsoever it be ( which God forbid ) you could haue no true right and interest to the precious promises of this and of that other life <sup>a</sup>. Thinke on this continually, and hold it your greatest Honour, the Noblest imployment of your Soule, as it is indeed, to keep your selfe (as a King <sup>b</sup> did <sup>c</sup> before you.) from your iniquitie. *Quod si tu (quod procul absit) nolueris, ego liber ero. Epistola, immo concio me hac mea, cum lecta fuerit, absoluet* <sup>d</sup>. And so I rest, being mindfull of your Vertues,

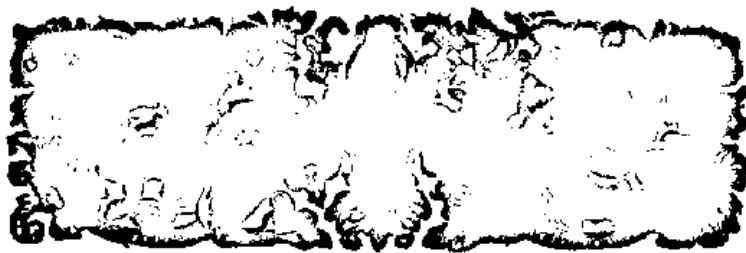
*Saint Maugantbe*  
19. August 1626.

*Yours in all Christian Devotion,  
and heartiest prayer to  
God for you,*

HANNIBAL GAMON.



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## THE PRAISE OF A Godly Woman.

PROV. 31. 30.

*—But a woman that feareth the Lord, shee  
shall be praised.*



Raise is a Debt (saith  
Gregory Nazianzen <sup>a</sup>)  
and it must be paid, not  
to men alone, but to  
women also; yet not to  
euery woman, be shee  
neuer so noble, wittie,  
wealthy or faire <sup>b</sup>, vn-  
lesse she be godly with-  
all: For fauour is deceitfull, and beantie is vaine; but  
a woman that feareth the Lord, shee shall be praised.

A promise this is and affirmatiue, and an affir-  
matiue promise hath two parts in it. The first is  
the Partie to whom it is made, and shee is *Mulier*

*atque excellat: ut in his laudetur, in quibus etiam Deus prophetico iudicio laudatur. Et dicitur scrip-  
tum est Psal 66. 5. Terribilis in conspectu super filios hominum: cuius opera coram Deo luceant, qui  
bona iugiter operibus facta contexat. Id. ib. cap 3.*

B

timens

<sup>a</sup> Orat. 25. fol. 439.

Rom. 13. 7, 8.

<sup>b</sup> Non possumus re-  
prehendere diuini  
artificis opera; sed  
quem delictat cor-  
poris pulchritudo,  
multo magis illa den-  
telle et vanitas, qua  
ad imaginem Dei  
est intus, non serui-  
campior. S. Ambr.  
In Isai. Virg. 6. 4.

Prov. 12. 22 Eccle.

*The Division.*

11. 2. Humoigi-  
tur mihi non tam  
vultu quam affectu  
admirandus emineat

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## A godly Womans Praise.

*timens Dominum.* A woman that feareth the Lord, which is also the reason why she shall be praised: euen because she is a woman fearing the Lord. The second is the thing promised, and that is *Laudabitur*, she shall be praised.

I.

In the former, it is not enough that she is a woman, because euery woman is not *Timens*, one that *Feareth*, nor sufficient that she *Feareth*; because euery woman that feareth is not *Timens Dominum*, one that feareth the Lord; but she that shall be praised, is all three. 1. A woman by nature <sup>c</sup>, where the weaker her sex is, the more shee shall be commended. 2. By Grace <sup>d</sup>, a woman that feareth, where the continuall act of this Fearing is required. 3. That feareth the Lord, where the right Object of her continuall feare is limited.

<sup>c</sup> Naturale vocabulū est *Femina*. naturalis vocabuli generalis, *Mulier*. — Tert. de Virg. Veland. cap 4.

<sup>d</sup> Aliud est *Timere* simpliciter, aliud *Timere Deum* —

II.

quippe *timere* & *timere* simpliciter *prolatum*, *afflictione*: *in addito* *est* *ante* *virtutes* *significat*. *Sic* *ices* *nempe* *afflictiones* *insunt* *naturaliter* *nobis* *tanquam* *ex* *nobis*, *Adiumenta* *ex* *Gratia*. S. Bern. de *Grat.* & *lib. Arb.*

<sup>e</sup> *Mulier enim* *naturā* *nomen* *est* *uxoris*, *sed* *uxor* *conditione* *nomen* *est* *mulieris*. Tert. ib. c.

3. Gen. 2. 23. *Hac* *vocabitur* *Mulier*,

*quoniam* *de* *viro* *suo* *sumpta* *est*. Quia *sumpta* *est* (inquit) *de* *viro* *suo*, *non* *quia* *virum* *experta* — *Non* *enim* *corruptela*, *sed* *sexus* *vocabulum* *est*. Gal. 4. 4. Luke 1. 28. S. Amb. ibid. c. 5.

And in the latter we are to consider; First, to what matters, *Laudabitur*, her praise will reach, and in what respect to *ipsa* Her person. Then secondly, When she shall be praised; not for the present, perhaps, no more than she hath beene heretofore; yet *Laudabitur*, the time will come when she shall be praised, and then too her praise shall so be, that it shall be still. Thirdly, of whom shee shall haue praise, for *Laudabitur* is an action, and must be done of some agent, therefore we must finde who shall praise her, and they will fall out to be her Husband and her Children (if she haue them <sup>e</sup>) and if they faile in this dutie, then the godly shall praise her; and if they cease to doe it, then her own

workes

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## A godly Womans Praise.

3

workes shall praise her, yea rather than faile, God himselfe shall praise her, which is best of all. So sure she is to be praised, not for the present onely, but for euer. And so this Text besides that it is a *Promise*, it is also a *Motive* to stirre vs vp to feare God, that so we also may haue true and eternall praise of God. It is both, and both waies wee to haue vse of it, as of a *Promise*, and as of a *Motive*: both these waies at once; *A woman that feareth the Lord she shall be praised.*

A { *Promise,*  
and  
*Motive.*

A weake sex<sup>e</sup> to beginne with, and yet being strengthened by Grace<sup>e</sup>, no impediment; but that a woman as wel as a man may feare the Lord, and haue praise of him, and so become the partie who shall, and one Reason too, why *shee shall be praised.*

I.  
*The partie*  
*that shall be*  
*praised.*

For a woman must be more good than nature, art, policie, preferment can make her, else shee is not good enough for Gods Spirit to praise her. He commends neither men nor women considered in their pure Naturalls only, in that estate of corruption, they all heare alike to their disgrace, that they are *All vnder sinne*<sup>a</sup>, *All come*<sup>b</sup> *short of the glory of God*, and are *All the children of*<sup>c</sup> *wrath*, because they *Are without all feare of God*<sup>d</sup>.

<sup>a</sup> 1 Pet. 2. 7. 1or. 50. 37. Nah. 3. 13. Gal. 3. 27, 28.

<sup>b</sup> Ex parte natura (nisi sit fortitudo maioris gratiae) facilius incurritur ad malum sexus feminine. Bonon. L. 2. d. 21. q. 3. p. 18.

<sup>c</sup> Rom. 3. 9.

<sup>d</sup> Rom. 3. 23.

<sup>e</sup> Ephes. 2. 3.

<sup>f</sup> Rom. 3. 18.

<sup>g</sup> Eurip. Plutarch. de Tranquillitate. Mulier quantulum proba, Mulier tam est.

<sup>h</sup> Anima enim sexum non habet. De Virg. tom. 1. lib. 3. fol. 99.

By nature then both sexes are alike faultie, alike discomendable in Gods sight, and so they should be in ours. We should not dispraise women more than men, for the sex sake only (as some doe<sup>m</sup>) because they haue as noble soules as men, for<sup>n</sup> soules haue no sexes, (as Saint *Ambrose* saith) nor praise women for the endowments of the flesh onely (as

B 2

other

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o Cornel. Agrip. de  
Nobilit. feminei  
sexus. Bocacius de  
claris mulieribus.

\* Es. 33. 6.  
† Caiet. in loc.

9 Naturaliter ei-  
am maior luctus est  
inter carnem et spi-  
ritum mulieris quam  
viri: quoniam enim  
caro eius infirmior,  
et spiritus minus  
promptus, ratio pug-  
na difficilior. Et  
victoria commenda-  
bilior. Pet. Blesser.  
33. p. 420. Times  
autem ne forte viri  
a virginibus iudi-  
centur: Comparati-  
one tamē non Au-  
dioritate: quia per  
duo tantum scilicet:  
per Fragilitatē car-  
nis et Ignorantiam  
mentis putabā, &c.  
ser. 35. p. 428.  
2 Tractat. de No-  
bilitate, part. 2. f.  
52. l. l. E. Et Greg.  
Naz. Orat. 33. tom.  
2. fol. 352.  
\* 2 Kings 9. 34.  
Acl. 14. 25. 1 Iob.  
418.  
† Matth. 10. 28.  
Es. 52. 12.

other some doe °) vnlesse they be adorned also with the sauing Graces of the Spirit, whereof a chiefe one is not noble birth, great wealth, excellent wit, or rare beautie; but *the feare of the Lord*, his treasure \*. This godly feare is that, that makes a Woman in relation † to God, praise-worthy. And good reason it should do so, if we regard the weaknesse of a woman, in whom so excellent a Grace as *the feare of the Lord*, is found, and the Noblenesse of fearing the Lord, being so found.

First, a womans weaknesse is naturally 9 greater than the mans, and therefore by how much her flesh is weaker, and her spirit lesse willing, by so much the combate she hath, is more difficult, and the victory she gets, more commendable. I know a man (Blesensis by name) that thought two things should excuse him at the dreadfull day of iudgement, the Frailty of his flesh, and the Ignorance of his minde; but then he feared lest God would iudge men by womē, whose sex being more fraile, more ignorant than that of mens, were for all that oftentimes more holy, more deuout than many men.

Secondly, the *Feare of the Lord* is the truest Nobilitie (as Gerson \* proues) the noblest grace that can ennoble and extoll a man or a woman. Other naturall, ciuill, and meere morall excellencies, perfections, and endowments a woman may haue, nay (which is neere the point) other kindes of Feare she may haue, and yet be base, seruile, cursed as *Iezebel* †, not praise-worthy, as namely, if she feare men †, or what else besides more than God



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## A godly Womans Praise.

5

God, or not for God, (as Saint Bernard <sup>c</sup> limits) or if shee feare God as a Iudge, in respect of his punishments only <sup>e</sup>, & not as a Father for loue of his goodnesse, and from an hatred of wickednesse, or if she haue cast off the feare of the Lord, which shee hath seemed to haue, or if shee puts off his Feare from time to time, and continues not in it.

Looke we then first to the Obiect of the *Laudable womans feare*, that he whom she feareth be the Lord, in respect of his Mercy and Iustice both; then to the continuall employment of her Feare, not one that hath feared him, or will feare him; but one that doth feare him for the present, and continueth therein, else shee is not a woman *Timens Dominum, Fearing the Lord*, and so not worthy to be praised.

First then (that the Obiect may be right) the <sup>u</sup> *Lord is her feare*, who shal be praised. For if He be not, all exquisitenesses besides are nothing in comparison; and if He be, all sufficiencies (remarkable in that sex) are improued, and all Duties (observable in the feare of the Lord) are practised. To see this the better, let vs follow *Tertullians* <sup>x</sup> rule, and oppose one against another, a vessell of dishonour against a vessell of honour, a woman not Fearing, against a woman Fearing the Lord.

She that fears not the Lord, sets light by Gods anger and her Husbonds <sup>y</sup>, not caring whether they bee pleased or displeased. Shee neglects to plant the feare of the Lord in her childrens hearts,

<sup>y</sup> *Eph. 1. 12, 17, 20, 22. Ecc. 1. 26. Es. 36. 9. & 3. 16. Prov. 30. 33. Ecc. 1. 25. 13. & alibi possim.*  
*Vbi verò timor Dei non est, ibi dissolutio vite est. S. Aug. de Temp. ser. 233. tom. 10.*

B 3

chusing

<sup>c</sup> *Conuertatur ad ipsam etiam Timor tuus, quia peruersus est timor omnia, quo metuis aliquid præter eum aut non propter eum. S. Ber. in cap. 1. iun. ser. 2.*

<sup>e</sup> *Quid magnū est, iacē timor? Quis enim rō time? quis Latro, quis sceleratus, quis nefarius? &c. S. Aug. de Verb. Apost. ser. 15. fol. 332. tom. 10.*

<sup>u</sup> *Deut. 10. 12.*  
<sup>2</sup> *King. 17. 36. Luk. 12. 5. Es. 8. 13. Mal. 1. 6.*

I.

*The Obiect of her feare.*

<sup>x</sup> *Loquacitas in edificatione nulla turpis, si quando turpis. Itaque si de aliquo bono sermo est, res postulat contrarium quoque boni recensere. Quid enim scilicetandum sit, magis illuminabis, si quod vitandum sit, prouide discesseris. Tertul. de Patien. c. 5. tom. 2.*

*A woman fearlessse of God.*

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## A godly Womans Praise.

chusing rather to be an example of wickednesse vnto them, and to misplace them in mariage for sinister respects. She brings want of things necessary to her family by her wastefulnesse, brauery, and idlenesse. She contemnes her naturall and legall kindred, lifts vp her selfe aboue her equalls, disdaines her inferiours, dishonours her place by an ouer-lostie or an ouer-base and contemptible behauiour in the same. She alienates the hearts of Gods people from her, by neglecting the offices of courtesies and helpfulnessse. She declines and vnderualewes the most searching meanes of Salvation, the Word, Prayer, Conference, Repentance, Meditation, Sacraments; in a word (according to Saint *Ambroses* \* Distinction) she feares hell torments, because shee hath sinned, but shee feares not Gods displeasure, lest she should sinne, and therefore shee liues and dies in worldlinesse, wantonnesse, pride, hatred, variance, emulations, wrath, strife, reuenge, impatiencie, gluttonie, or some such darling sinne: and tell me (Beloued) if such a woman not beautified and adorned with religion and the feare of the Lord, be worthy to bee praised of the Lord? I am sure the ancient Fathers \* declaime bitterly against her filthy heart, false haire, adulterate paintings, naked breasts, new-fangled fashions of superfluous, monstrous attire: & the holy Scriptures <sup>b</sup> vilifie her to her face, threatning her (notwithstanding all her other or-

\* Aliud est timere quia peccaueris, aliud timere ne pecces. Et ibi est formido de supplicio, hic sollicitudo de premio. Epist. 84.

¶ Tim. 3. Est quem timet Dei ligat, qui non expauescit ad vulnus hominis, sed ad memoriam ge-  
brennialium tormen-  
torum. Et hic qui-  
dem peccare non  
metuit, sed ardere.  
S. Bern. de Tripl.  
Coherenti: Vincul.  
¶ Eccl. 33. 14.

¶ Tertul. de Habit.  
Mulieb. & de cul-  
tu Fem. tom. 2. S.

Cyprian. de Discipl. & Hab. Virg. to. 2. Greg. Naz. aduers. mulier: Ambrosius de ornantes. to. 2. S. Ephraim aduers. improbas mulieres tom. 1. in his works. Riuet. l. 3 c. 21. <sup>b</sup> 2 King. 9. 20, 30, 34. Eccl. 3. 16, & 32 9, 10, 11. 1 Pet. 3. 3, 4. Math. 5. 36. & 6. 27. Eccles. 25. 13, 19.

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## A godly Womans Praise.

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naments and excellencies of nature, art, policie, preferment,) that without this *Feare of the Lord*; it shall not be well with her, Eccles. 8. 13. The Lord will come neare to her to iudgement, he will be a swift witnesse against her, Mal. 3. 5. She shall leane her memorie to be cursed <sup>a</sup>, and her reproach shall not be blotted out, she shall be counted ungodly of all <sup>d</sup>, more bitter than death <sup>e</sup>. As rottennesse in her husbands bones <sup>f</sup>, As spittle <sup>g</sup>, yea As a Dogge <sup>h</sup>, and at last she shall be cast into hell fire, *Saluâ Veniâ*, without pardon from God, becauſe (ſaith Tertullian <sup>i</sup>) ſhe hath ſinned *Saluameti*, without any teare of God.

But on the other ſide what perſonall ſufficiency, what ſingular duty is there requiſite in a Woman, either in reſpect of God, or of her husband, children, kindred, ſeruants, place, and of Gods people, which the life of Grace, the Grace of the Feare of the Lord doth not animate, aduance, and accompliſh? This godly Feare ennobleth Nobilitie, beautifieth Beautie, enricheth wealth, teacheth wit, wiſdome. She that hath this *Feare*, dare not for her heart, but be loath to offend her husband, and deny her inferiority <sup>k</sup>; but be an example of godlineſſe to her children <sup>l</sup>, provide things neceſſary for her ſeruants <sup>m</sup> both in health and in ſickneſſe; loue her naturall and legall <sup>n</sup> kindred, eſteeme her equals aboue her ſelfe <sup>o</sup>, countenance and relieue her inferiours <sup>p</sup>, maintaine the dignitie of her place by all ſuch vertues as may diſcharge the <sup>q</sup> ſame; winne the affections of Gods people, to her more and more, by the offices <sup>r</sup> of courteſies, ſalutations, gifts, viſitations, inuitati-

<sup>a</sup> Eccleſ. 13. 26.

<sup>b</sup> Prou. 10. 7.

<sup>c</sup> Eccleſ. 26. 25.

<sup>d</sup> Eccleſ. 7. 26.

<sup>e</sup> Prou. 12. 4.

<sup>f</sup> Eccleſ. 26. 27.

<sup>g</sup> Eccleſ. 26. 25.

<sup>h</sup> Sic ergo & ipſa,

ſaluâ veniâ in ge-

hennam detraden-

tur, dum ſaluâ me-

in peccant. De pe-

nit. c. 5. Reuel. 21. 8.

& 22. 15.

*A woman fea-*

*ring the Lord.*

<sup>k</sup> Gen. 3. 16. Eph.

1. 23-33. 1. Cor. 7.

34.

<sup>l</sup> 1 Tim. 5. 10.

<sup>m</sup> 2 Tim. 1. 5. & 3. 15.

<sup>n</sup> Tit. 2. 4. Deut. 6. 7.

<sup>o</sup> Prou. 31. 15, 21.

<sup>p</sup> Matth. 8. 6.

<sup>q</sup> 1 Tim. 5. 4. 2 Th.

2. 7, 10. & 4. 4.

<sup>r</sup> Gal. 4. 15. Exod.

18. 7.

<sup>s</sup> Phil. 2. 3. Rom.

12. 10, 16.

<sup>t</sup> 1 Cor. 1. 1. 1 Tim.

6. 18.

<sup>u</sup> Titus 2. 3.

<sup>v</sup> Lev. 1. 10, 16.

<sup>w</sup> Prou. 19. 2. 2 Th. 2. 4.

<sup>x</sup> Gal. 6. 1. 1 Tim.

5. 10. Col. 3. 12.

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ons and of helpfullnesse; yea she that feares God, dare not for her heart but *Honour them that feare God*, *Psal.* 134. but keepe her set taskes <sup>c</sup> of hearing, reading, fasting, praying, meditating, moderating passionate distempers, and of all other gracious exercises, of Selfe-deniall <sup>e</sup>; so that there is not any knowne <sup>a</sup> sinne which she nourisheth, alloweth, or goeth on in, but quaketh and trembleth at the very first thoughts, yea motions and inclinations thereunto, as being in the sight <sup>a</sup> of an inuisible God, vnder the perpetuall presence of his All-seeing glorious pure eye, which shee will not prouoke to anger by any sinne, for all the gold that euer the Sunne made, or shall make while it stands in Heauen <sup>7</sup>.

This glorious description of a woman fearing the Lord, is not mine (Blessed Brethren) but the Scriptures, wherein I finde; 1. The cause of her Feare to be not Selfe-Loue <sup>a</sup>, but the Loue of God; not the spirit of Bondage <sup>b</sup>; but the Spirit of Adoption: 2. The Obiect of her feare to be not the precepts of men <sup>c</sup>, but the Commandments of God <sup>d</sup>: not his Threats only <sup>e</sup>, but his Promises also <sup>f</sup>: not his Anger only against sin <sup>g</sup>, but his Mercy also in Christ <sup>h</sup>: not his Presence only, as a Reuenging Iudge <sup>i</sup>, but his Forbearance also as a louing Father <sup>k</sup>. 3. The workings of her Feare to be in the heat of temptations and as-

*Gal.* 6.9. *Iam.* 1.9. *1 Tim.* 4.12. *Thess.* 5.17. *Luk.* 37. *Ephes.* 4.26. *Mat.* 4.5. *1 Pet.* 3.4. *Luk.* 9.23. & 14.26.

*Psal.* 138. 23. & 7.10. *Gen.* 39.9. *reu.* 16.6. & 8.13. *Gen.* 17.1. *Psal.* 5.8. & 116.9. *Ek.* 10.33. *2 Cor.* 17. *Iob* 34. 21. *reu.* 15. 3. & 9. *1. 2 Chron.* 16.9. *King.* 17.1. *Mag.* 1 est cautela peccati, Dei semper esertiam timere. *Aug. de Temp.* 11. 2. 12. tom. 10. *ultimum enim reuerat homin: scōentia, si credamus in cōspēctū Dei uere, si non tamē que gerimus deidi super, sed iam que cogitauit, aut loquimur, dicit a D. o putat* &c. *Lat. de iD.* 1. c. 8.

*Es.* 3.8. *1 Cor.* 13. *Esalm.* 119. 72. 137. 162.

*1 Tim.* 1.7. & 3.2. <sup>b</sup> *Rom* 8.15. <sup>c</sup> *Es.* 29.13. <sup>d</sup> *Deut.* 4.10. *Es.* 66.2. *Ecc.* 12.13. *Prou.* 13. *Psal.* 119. 161. <sup>e</sup> *Psal.* 119. 125. & 52.6. <sup>f</sup> *2 Cor.* 7.1. *Heb.* 4.1. *Psal.* 130.4. <sup>g</sup> *Deut.* 9. <sup>h</sup> *Hos.* 3.5. *Psal.* 33.18. & 130.4. <sup>i</sup> *Ier.* 5.12. *Alt.* 10.2.33. <sup>k</sup> *Mat.* 16. *Os.* 3.5. *br.* 12.9.

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## A godly Womans Praise.

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fictions, not Despairing<sup>1</sup>; but Belceuing the for-  
 giuenesse of her sinnes, not Limiting God to the  
 present danger; but<sup>m</sup> waiting for his mercy,  
 not Distrusting his Prouidence; but hoping for  
 Good<sup>n</sup>: not Murmuring against him; but prai-  
 sing Him, and praying vnto Him<sup>o</sup>, yea (which  
 is the proper Act of her Feare) not Louing any  
 sin, but hating and eschewing all sin<sup>p</sup>, not out of  
 a slavish terrour of punishment; but chiefly be-  
 cause it is Sinne, an Infinite euill, and because an  
 Infinite Good God, whom she loueth (saith Saint  
*Augustine*) is offended by it, though she should ne-  
 uer goe to Hell-fire to be punished for it<sup>q</sup>.

<sup>1</sup> Ier. 17. 17. Eccles. 2. 8.  
<sup>m</sup> Psal. 33. 18. 20. Eccles. 2. 7.  
<sup>n</sup> Psal. 115. 11. & 56. 3. Eccles. 2. 9.  
<sup>o</sup> 1 Cor. 10. 10. Psalm. 22. 13. Act. 10. 2.  
<sup>p</sup> Exod. 20. 20. Eccles. 15. 13. Prov. 8. 13. & 16. 6. 2 Tim. 1. 7. 1 Ibb. 4. 18. Hos. 3. 5. Psal. 97. 10. Ier. 4. 18. & 2. 19.

Lastly, in the Scriptures I finde Perseuerance  
 or Constancie<sup>r</sup> to be euer an inseperable Atten-  
 dant vpon her Feare! For she is not one that hath  
 not yet tasted of this sauing Grace, or else not con-  
 tinued in the same; but she is a woman for the pre-  
 sent, *Timens Dominum*, *Fearing the Lord*. You shall  
 neuer finde Her otherwise, than (as God would  
 haue her) *In the feare of the Lord all the day long*.  
*Prov. 23. Fearing and keeping his Commandements al-*  
*waies, Deut. 4. Doing her Husband Good and not euill*  
*all the daies of her life*, verse the 12. of this Chapter.

II.  
*The continu-*  
*ance of her*  
*Feare.*

It is true indeed, as Feare is opposed to Diffi-  
 dence, *Luke 1*. So she serues God without a Di-  
 strustfull Feare all the daies of her life; because of  
 Gods continuall presence with Her<sup>r</sup>, continuall  
 mercy towards Her<sup>r</sup>, continuall power<sup>t</sup> ouer

<sup>r</sup> *Verò christia-*  
*nus proficundo per-*  
*ueniet ad talem a-*  
*nimū, ut plus amet*  
*Dominum quàm ti-*  
*meat Gebēum: ut*  
*etiam si dicat illi*  
*Deus, utere delicijs*  
*carnalibus sempi-*  
*ternis & quantum*  
*potes pecca, nec mo-*  
*rieris, nec in Gebē-*  
*nam misteris, sed*  
*meum tantummodo*  
*non eris: exhor-*  
*rescat & omnino*  
*non peccet, non tam*

*ut in illud, quod timebat non incidat, sed ne illum quem sic amat, offendant. De Catechiz. Rudib.*  
*cap. 17. item. 4. fol. 912. 1 Ierem. 32. 39, 40. Deut. 4. 10. Prov. 23. 17. & 14. 2. 1 Tim. 2. 15.*  
<sup>t</sup> *Matth. 28. 20. Es. 43. 1, 2. 1 Ier. 14. 9. Lam. 2. 22, 23. 2 Cor. 12. 9. Es. 26. 41. & 41. 24.*  
*Psal. 121. & 35. 24. Rom. 8. 26.*

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<sup>u</sup> Matth. 10. 28.

Deut. 28. 58.

<sup>x</sup> Esai. 29. 15, 16.

Psal. 50. 21.

<sup>y</sup> Esai. 43. 25. &

63. 9. & 49. 13,

15.

<sup>z</sup> Esai. 42. 14.

<sup>a</sup> De diuersis ten-

tat. Diaboli, part 3.

M<sup>r</sup>. Greenham 3.

part, among his

Rules for an Af-

flicted minde.

<sup>b</sup> Esai. 54. 8, 9, 10.

c. 49. 15. Ier. 31. 3.

36. c. 33. 20, 21.

Iob. 13. 1. Rom. 8.

38, 39. Mat. 12. 20.

Esai. 42. 3.

<sup>c</sup> Psalm. 103. 17.

<sup>d</sup> Sam. 7. 15.

<sup>e</sup> Psal. 89. 28, 34.

Esai. 55. 3. c. 59. 11.

Ier. 32. 40.

<sup>f</sup> Iob. 10. 29. Iude

vers. 24. 1 Pet. 1. 5.

Esai. 26. 4. Psal. 80.

17. Manus Dei est

ista, non nostra ut

non discedamus à

Deo, manus in qua

eius est ista, qui

dixit, Timorem me-

um dabo in cor eorū

&c. S. Aug. de Bo-

no persever. c. 7. 10.

7. Ier. 32. 27.

<sup>f</sup> 1 Pet. 1. 23. 1 Iob. 3. 9.

<sup>g</sup> Ephes. 1. 13. Numb. 23. 19. Ios. 21. 45.

1 Iob. 5. 10.

Hebr. 7. 27. c. 11. 11. Rom. 4. 21. 1 Cor. 1. 9.

<sup>h</sup> Esai. 59. 21. Ephes. 1. 13, 14. c. 4. 30. Iob. 14. 16,

17. 1 Iob. 2. 27. 1 Luke 22. 32. Iob. 17. 15, 20. Rom. 8. 34. Hebr. 7. 25.

<sup>i</sup> 1 Pet. 1. 2, 3, 4, 5.

1 Iob. 5. 4, 18. 1 1 Pet. 5. 9. Ephes. 6. 6. Matth. 16. 18.

<sup>m</sup> Ierem 32. 40. Perseuerantiam enim

promisit Deus, dicens: Timorem meum dabo in cor eorū ut à me non recedant. Quod quid est ali-

ud quàm talia ac tantus eris Timor meus, quem dabo in cor eorū, ut mihi perseuerantē adhare-

ant? Idem de Bono Perseuer. c. 2. tom. 7. Rom. 11. 29.

Her, in Strengthening, Helping, and Vpholding

Her, Esai. 41. 10. But yet as Feare is opposed to

Negligence, so she still feares God, lest she should

be secure by reason of his Power which is inuinci-

ble <sup>a</sup>; of his Wisdom, which is infallible <sup>x</sup>; of

his Mercy, which is compassionate <sup>y</sup>; and of his

Iustice, which is inflexible <sup>z</sup>.

It is as true also (which *Gerson* and others haue

obserued <sup>a</sup>) that many times a Deuout Soule is so

disquieted with a flauish Feare of the Aduersary;

that she feares lest she hath not any true Feare of

Gods Maiestie; but yet (*B. B.*) say the *Pelagian*

what hee can to the contrary, such is the Euerla-

stingnesse of Gods Loue <sup>b</sup>, Mercie <sup>c</sup>, and Coue-

nant <sup>d</sup>, the Vnconquerableness of his Power <sup>e</sup>,

the Immortality of his Word <sup>f</sup>, the Certaintie of

his Promises <sup>g</sup>, the Efficacie of Christs Spirit <sup>h</sup>;

Prayer <sup>i</sup>, Merits <sup>k</sup>, and of Faith in them <sup>l</sup>; yea

such is the durable vigour of this sauing Grace of

the Feare of the Lord <sup>m</sup>, that being once rooted by

God, (as Saint *Augustine* vrgeth) it cannot be re-

moued; but through it we may perseueringly ad-

here vnto God according to his promise: *I will*

*put my Feare in their hearts, that they shall not depart*

*from me*, Ier. 32. 40. with Psal. 80. 17. She then that

truely hath this Feare, doth so feare the Lord in

loue,

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## A godly Womans Praise.

11

Loue, and loue him in feare <sup>a</sup>, that as in the midst of Gods not Consuming, but Consummating Anger (for so Saint *Augustine* <sup>c</sup> calls Gods Anger towards the Godly) shee can see the yerning and relenting Bowels of a Compassionate Father, so in the height of Satans Terrifying iniections, shee can shunne and abhorre Gods Displeasure <sup>d</sup>, more than all other miseries of Punishments, and therefore in what statē soeuer she be of Consolation or Desertion, shee is still the same Woman, *Timens Dominum, Fearing the Lord.*

Thus wee haue seene who shee is, who *shall be praised*, lest we should praise Her vnawares, whom we should not praise. And now it were good we did thinke a little better on the Reason, why *she shall be praised*, euen because she is such a woman *fearing the Lord.*

For if any thing, so rare and excellent a Grace as the *Feare of the Lord* is, should moue vs to affect it, and labour for it, especially being found in so weake a Vessell as a Woman is <sup>e</sup>. For I could tell you, there are more *Michals* <sup>f</sup> than *Abigails* <sup>g</sup>, more *Iezabels* <sup>h</sup> than *Sarah's* <sup>i</sup>, more proud *Vasthy's* <sup>k</sup>, than humble *Esthers* <sup>l</sup>, more Fearefull women, than Women *Fearing the Lord*; and therefore the rarer such Phœnixes are (as *S. Ierom* calls them <sup>m</sup>) not *One* to be found by wisest *Salomon* <sup>n</sup>, among a *Thousand*, the greater is her praise *that feareth the Lord* <sup>b</sup>.

<sup>f</sup> 2 Sam. 6. 26, 30. <sup>g</sup> 1 King. 21. 7. <sup>h</sup> 2 King. 9. 22, 30. <sup>i</sup> 1 Pet. 3. 6. <sup>k</sup> Esth. 1. 12. <sup>l</sup> Esth. 8. 5. <sup>m</sup> Optima femina rarior est Phœnice. Malarum feminarū tam copiosa sunt examina &c. S. Ier. epist. <sup>n</sup> Eccles. 7. 28. Prou. 31. 10. <sup>b</sup> Laus tantō maior deferri solet, quantō est bonum rarior quod exigit Laudem. S. Aug. lib. 3. de Ciuit. Dei. cap. 28. tom. 5.

<sup>a</sup> Absit enim ut timore pereat amor, si castus est timor. S. Aug. in Psal. 119. tom. 8.

<sup>c</sup> Est ira consummationis, & est ira consumptionis, (nam omnis Vindicta Dei, Ira dicitur) sed aliquando ad hoc vindicat Deus, ut perficiat: aliquando ad hoc vindicat, ut damnet. Idem in Psal. 58. 20. 8. f. 199.

<sup>d</sup> Qui glissime Deo conglutinator, id est charitate--terribilius & horribilius ipsa Gehenna iudicat, in re lenissima vultū omnipotentis scienter offendere. S. Bern. de Tripl. Cohæren. Vincul.

*The Reason.*

<sup>q</sup> 1 Pet. 3. 7. Vir itaq; nominatus est, quod maior in ea Vir est quam in femina, & hinc Virtus nomen accepit. Item Mulier à mollicie est dicta--velut Mollier. Lat. de Op. f. Dei. cap. 12. <sup>r</sup> 1 Sam. 18. 22. & 25. 41.

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c. *Esaï. 8. 12 Col. 1. 10.*

d. *2 Tim. 3. 1. Mat. 10. 28.*

*Quis autem Dominatur, nisi Deus solus? Quis iste, nisi ignis Consummator? -- Illi: potius metum confesantur &c. Tertul. aduers. Gnost. c. 9. tom. 3.*

*Timor Scruiilis non est Virtus, quia licet mala declinari faciat: non tamen hoc facit bene, id est fideiabiliter; immo milititer et brutaliter, videlicet solo metu ferre, ita enim occupat animum & intentionem timoris, & oculus cordis ad solam pene euasione habet &c. Paris. de Virtutibus, fol. 81. li. H. & Palud. l. 3. d. 34. q. 3.*

*Coniux quoque adulteripum animum gerit, etiam si timore viri non adulterium perpetrat: tamen quod deest operi, inest voluntati. Casta vero aliter timet: non & ipsa timet virum; sed castè. Denique timet illa, ne vir infestus adueniat, illa ne offensam abscindat. S. Aug. epist. 120. c. 21. et 2.*

*3 Ruben violat Balam dum nimium grandis effectus est, quia timor si nimius est, dum se custodire nititur, format inutiles imaginationes, quibus se conuolvens à salutariibus impeditur. Tract. 10. super Magnificat. part. 3. <sup>b</sup> Lege Esaiam: vide quantum subiacet timorem ut faceret irreprehensibilem & bonum Timorem. Spiritus inquit Sapientie &c. Tolle Timori Domini ista & est irrationabilis & insipiens Timor, unus ex illis: Feris pugna, inter Timores. In Psal. 128. Ser. 5. tom. 4.*

Then I must tell you, that euery Feare is not commendable. Not that Feare which is Hypocriticall, for this is Superstition, when men feare the Feare of Idolaters <sup>c</sup>. Not that feare which is Worldly, for this is wicked selfe-Loue, when men feare Men <sup>d</sup>, Losse of Goods, Fire and saggot, more than God the Onely Soueraigne Commander of the Soule, the Only Dreadfull Threatner of euertlasting Burnings. Nor that feare which is Seruile <sup>e</sup> or adulterate <sup>f</sup>, for this is no Vertue (proues *Paris.*) when men feare the *Euill of Punishment* onely; not the *Euill of Sinne*, as an Adulteresse feares the Comming home of her Husband; but feares not the Committing of Adultery. Nor is that feare commendable, which is Distrustfull or Immoderate like *Ruben* (as *Gerson* <sup>g</sup> alludes) growen great, and lying with *Bilhab*, for this is Infidelitie when men tie Gods Grace to present deliuerance out of danger, without a Belceuing and waiting Spirit for his Mercie, *Esaï. 28. 16.*

But the *Feare* for which a *Woman shall be praised*, is informed by Wisdome, instructed by Understanding, directed by Counsell, strengthened by Might, gouerned by Knowledge, adorned with Pietie, as Saint *Ambrose* collectts out of the eleuenth of *Esay* <sup>h</sup>. It is a Faithfull feare trusting in

God,



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## A godly Womans Praise.

13

God <sup>1</sup>, and making Him her Feare, *Eſai. 8. 13.* and her Hope too in the Day of Euill, not without this ſeruent Prayer vnto Him then: *Be not thou a Terror vnto me, Ier. 17. 17.* A chaſt and Cleane Feare <sup>2</sup>, *Cleanſing from all filthineſſe of the fleſh and Spirit <sup>1</sup>.* A Reuerent and Godly Feare <sup>3</sup>, Preparing the heart, Humbling the Soule in Gods ſight <sup>4</sup>, I rembling at his Word <sup>5</sup>, not Diſobeying it, Eſchewing <sup>6</sup> euill, Working righteouſneſſe and Giuing much almes <sup>7</sup>. A Blessed Feare it is <sup>8</sup>, Blessing them that haue it, Blessing the Lord that giues it, Praiſing Him and ſaying: *That his Mercy endureth for ever <sup>9</sup>.*

Laſtly, it is an Euerlaſting Feare, euer encreaſing <sup>1</sup>, and *Enduring for ever <sup>2</sup>*, though not in reſpect of the Act of Declination or eſchewing of ſinne <sup>3</sup>, becauſe in Heauen there is no feare of ſinning <sup>4</sup>; yet in reſpect of the Act of Celebration or Reuerencing God, becauſe there the Saints doe nothing elſe; but ſtill Giue Glory to Him, and Worſhip Him with humble Acknowledgement of their owne Vnworthineſſe, *Pſal. 119. 9.* with *Reuel. 4. 10. 11.*

Now (Honourable and Beloued) though I haue ſet nothing at all beſides this Heauenly Manna before your eyes; yet your full Soules muſt not Loath it. For if that only is to be praiſed which is excellent <sup>1</sup>, then (by your leaue) I muſt ſtand ſome what longer vpon the Excellencie of this Feare, before a Woman can be praiſed that hath it.

*Virtutibus, lit. A. F. <sup>1</sup> Laudare plus eſt quàm probare & predicare. Nam excellit &c. Auſo. Popma de Differen. Viri. l. 3.*

<sup>1</sup> *Pſal. 125. 12. & 147. 11. Eſai. 90. 10.*  
<sup>2</sup> *Pſal. 19. 9.*  
<sup>3</sup> *2 Cor. 7. 1.*  
<sup>4</sup> *Hebr. 12. 28.*  
<sup>5</sup> *Eccleſi. 2. 27. & 21. 6.*  
<sup>6</sup> *Eſai. 66. 2. Eccle. 2. 15.*  
<sup>7</sup> *Iob 1. 1.*  
<sup>8</sup> *Aſt. 10. 35. 2. 7. Eccl. 1. 35. 1.*  
<sup>9</sup> *Pſal. 112. 1. & 128. 2.*  
<sup>1</sup> *Pſal. 135. 23. & 118. 4. & 22. 23.*  
<sup>2</sup> *2 King. 18. 3. 12. Tob. 14. 1.*  
<sup>3</sup> *Pſal. 149. Reuel. 7. 10. 11. & 19. 1, 3, 4, 5, 6.*  
<sup>4</sup> *Roman. lib. 3. d. 14. 9. 3. p. 89. Thom. Aquin. 22. q. 29. a. 11.*  
<sup>5</sup> *In calo, ubi non eſt peccatum Gloria eſt & perpetua laus & indefaſſa praeconia. S. Ierom. ad Theodorum. Epitaph. Lucidij.*  
<sup>6</sup> *Offenſa*  
<sup>7</sup> *Time-rem*  
<sup>8</sup> *Pauca Glo-ria Parua*  
<sup>9</sup> *propter eorum imperfectionem non patitur. In toto animi erimus et à paena et ab offenſa. Pariſ. de*

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**The Excellen-  
cie of Godly  
Feare.**

<sup>b</sup> Prou. 22. 4. &  
19. 23. Eccles. 1. 11,  
12. & 23. 27. &  
40. 26, 27. & 10.  
20, 21.

<sup>c</sup> Inter Laudes me-  
as & illa est exi-  
mia: quod ipsum  
(bristum Dominū  
Apothecam, immo  
fontem Gratiarum  
omnium & Virtu-  
tum replere distul-  
sum &c. Paris. de  
Moribus, fol. 99.  
li. P.

<sup>d</sup> Deut. 5. 23.

<sup>e</sup> Eccles. 12. 13. De-  
um time -- Ergo si  
hoc est. omnis Ho-  
mo, absq; hoc Nihil  
omnis Homo. Serm.  
20. in Cant.

<sup>f</sup> Vnus enim huma-  
ni animi pendet à  
Timore consp. flus  
Diuini tanquam à  
prima regula. Caiet.  
in Eccles. 6. 8. 13. v.

<sup>g</sup> Prou. 9. 10. Iob  
28. 28.

<sup>h</sup> Eccles. 25. 12.

<sup>i</sup> Leuit. 2. 13. Pet.  
Bles. ser. 36. p. 430.

<sup>k</sup> Psal. 2. 11.

<sup>l</sup> 2 Cor. 7. 11. Eccles.  
21. 6.

<sup>m</sup> 1 Pet. 3. 2.

<sup>n</sup> 2 Cor. 7. 1. <sup>o</sup> Philip. 2. 12. <sup>p</sup> Eccles. 2. 10. 1 Tim. 2. 15.

I demand then what doe you count Excellent? Riches, Honour, Life. Why, these are neuer well gotten, nor well kept; but by *the Feare of the Lord*. So saith Salomon, *By the feare of the Lord are Riches and Honour, and Life* <sup>b</sup>. Say what you will, it must needs be an Excellent thing wherewith Christ Iesus Himselfe was Filled, and that was with *The Spirit of this Feare*, Esai. 11. 2. <sup>c</sup>. An excellent thing which God Himselfe so earnestly desires to be still in vs, and that is this Feare. O (saith He) *that there were such an Heart in them, that they would feare me, and keepe my Commandements alwaies* <sup>d</sup>, which is indeed *the whole Dutie of Man* <sup>e</sup>; without which (Saint Bernard concludes) *Euery man is Nothing*. He is not a Man (reasons a Schoole-man <sup>f</sup>) but the Shadow of a Man; because He imployes not his Soule to that noble End for which he had it, namely, to be squared and ruled by *the feare of the Lord*: without which no man can so much as Begin to be wise, because this Feare is *the Beginning* <sup>g</sup> *of wisdom*, nor so much as *Begin to Love God*, because this Feare is *the Beginning of the Love of God* <sup>h</sup>. It is the *Salt* (alludes *Blesensis*) that must be in euery Sacrifice <sup>i</sup>, in euery Worke we doe, so that there is no *Seruing God*, no *Reioycing in Him* <sup>k</sup>, no heartie *Repenting* <sup>l</sup>, no *Chast Conuersing* <sup>m</sup>, no *Perfecting Holinesse* <sup>n</sup>, no *Working out our Salvation*, but with *Feare and Trembling* <sup>o</sup>; nay there is no *Saluation*, no *Blessednesse* without *Continuing in this Feare* <sup>p</sup>, Prou. 28. 14. Againe, is not that Excellent, that will make vs more Excellent than our Neigh-

bours,

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## A godly Womens Praise.

19

bours <sup>a</sup>, that will Exalt vs aboue them, that will keepe our hearts from Hardning <sup>b</sup>, our Houses from Ouerthrowing <sup>c</sup> ? but nothing can doe this ; but this *Feare of the Lord*. This feare (saith *Parif.* <sup>d</sup>) can cause a spiritual Earth-quake in a mans Heart, able to ouerthrow all the Devils strongest holds, any <sup>e</sup>. Bosome-sinne, be it neuer so pleasing and profitable, by reason of that Contrarietie and Opposition <sup>f</sup> that is betweene Lying in any Sweet Sinne, and Liuing in Gods Feare and Favour, as you may see, *Leuit.* 25. 36.

Lastly, this is an Excellent Feare, because it is *A fountaine of Life* <sup>g</sup> : wherefore ? *To drine away Sinnes* <sup>h</sup>, Sinnes which haue beene committed by Repentance (saith *S. Bernard*) and Sinnes where-to we are Tempted, by Resistance <sup>i</sup> ; and yet this is not all the Excellencie of this Feare: For it is *A fountaine of life* also : *To Cause vs to finde fauour at our Deaths* <sup>j</sup> ; and which is more, Such an Excellent Feare as will make vs *Not feare, nor be afraid* <sup>k</sup>. Whereupon Saint *Augustine* <sup>l</sup> concludes for my purpose: *Disceat timere, qui non vult timere : Disceat ad tempus esse sollicitus, qui semper vult esse securus*. Let him learne to feare, that would not feare : Let him be wary and cautelous for a time, that would be happie and secure for euer. *Tertullian* giues the

<sup>a</sup> Prou. 12. 26.  
*Eccles.* 15. 5.

<sup>b</sup> Prou. 28. 14.

<sup>c</sup> *Eccles.* 27. 3.

<sup>d</sup> Ego sum Tempestas ad liberationem & salutem, Terra-motum spiritualem in corde humano faciens, et omnia Diabolica edificia in ea subuertens et destru-tiens ab eodem. *Pa-ris. de Moribus* fol. 99. lit. F.

<sup>e</sup> Prou. 8. 13. & 16. 6. *Psal.* 119. 6; 36. 117. 128. v. *Ian.* 2. 10. *Psal.* 36.

11.

<sup>f</sup> Sed aiunt quidā: Satis Deum habere si corde & animo suspiciatur, licet actū minus fiat. Ita-que saluo metu et fide peccare; hoc est Saluā castitate, ma-trimonia violare, Saluā pietate, pe-rēti venenum tem-perare. *Tertul. de Pēnit.* c. 5. tom. 2.

<sup>g</sup> Prou. 14. 27.

<sup>h</sup> *Eccles.* 1. 21.

<sup>i</sup> Timor Domini expellit peccatum,

sive quod iam admissum est, sive quod tentat intrare. Expellit sanē illud quidem pēnitendo, hoc Resistendo. *Serm. de Divers. Affēl.* <sup>c</sup> *Eccles.* 1. 23. <sup>d</sup> *Eccles.* 34. 14. *Exod.* 20. 20. *Prou.* 1. 33. & 19. 23. *Psal.* 27. 1, 2, 3. & 34. 4. -- Auferendi sunt metus, sed ita, ut his solus re-linquatur, qui quoniam legimus ac verus est, solus efficit, ut possint cetera omnia non timeri. *Lact. de Vero Cultu.* l. 6. c. 17. Qui enim Deum veraciter timet, nihil terrenum & caducum time-t, immo ex ipso Timore Dei, ipsi Timoribus superestertur. *Bonau. lib.* 3. d. 34. q. 1. p. 62. <sup>e</sup> *De Temp. Serm.* 2. 14. tom. 10.

reason,

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f. Nam qui presu-  
 mit, minus vereor,  
 minus precauet,  
 plus periclitatur  
 Eccl. De Cultu Fam.  
 cap. 2. & de Pa-  
 nit. cap. 6. — Vo-  
 lo te timere &  
 non timere, presu-  
 mere & non presu-  
 mēre, timere ut pe-  
 nitent, non timere  
 ut presumas. Por-  
 ro presumere ne  
 diffidas, non pre-  
 sumere ne torpescas.  
 Eer. ep. 87. ad Oger.  
 5. Prov. 4. 23. Jer.  
 4. 14. 18. & 16.  
 10, 11, 12. Es. 55.  
 7. Mat. 15. 19. Nec  
 sufficit non egisse a-  
 liquid impium, si  
 mēte cogitatur im-  
 pietas. S. Hier. in  
 Psal. 65. fol. 424.  
 h. Prov. 28. 26. Rom.  
 7. 18. & 11. 20.  
 i. Phil. 4. 13. 2 Tim.  
 2. 1. & 4. 18. Eph.  
 6. 10. 2 Thron. 16.  
 8. 9. et 10. 12. Deut.  
 6. 3, 4. Quicquid  
 est circa te vel in te  
 unde possis presu-  
 mēre, abice à te, &  
 te à presumptio tua  
 Deus sit, illius indi-  
 gens esto, ut implearis & c. S. Aug. in Psal. 85. h. Psal. 66. 18. 1 Pet. 3. 15. Ez. 33. 31. Psal. 24.  
 4. Iam. 4. 8. Heb. 10. 22. Redi ad te, intus tibi esto iudex. Ecce in cubiculo tuo abscondito, in ipsa vena  
 à timore tui ubi tu solus es, & ille qui videt; illic tibi displiceat iniquitas, ut placeas Deo.  
 Parum est in vultu, parum est in lingua, in corde noli respicere, id est, noli diligere, noli acceptare.  
 Idem in Psal. 65. 10. 8. i. De cultu Fam. cap. 2. to. 2. m. 2 Thess. 3. 3. 2 Tim. 2. 19. Job. 15. 16.  
 Luke 10. 20. Job. 16. 22. & 10. 28, 29. v. Psal. 15. 5. & 125. 1. Prov. 10. 30.

reason<sup>f</sup>, because if *We feare to Offend*, by Fearing  
 we will take heed, lest we Offend, and by Taking  
 heed, we shall be in safetie; otherwise if wee pre-  
 sume and be not alwaies watchfull ouer our hearts  
 lest they offend, we cannot be *Saued*<sup>5</sup>. *Ier. 4. 14.*  
*Qui sollicitus est, is verè poterit esse securus*: He that  
 is not ouer-bold on his owne strength<sup>h</sup>; but con-  
 fident in Christ<sup>i</sup>, and liues not securely in the mi-  
 nion-delight of any knowne sinne; but stands in  
 such continuall awe of Gods *Presence, Precepts,*  
*Promises, Threats*, that he dare not so much as once  
 make any offer of incurring his Displeasure by the  
 impenitent Allowance of any sinne in his heart<sup>k</sup>,  
 and studies to do euery Good worke as carefully,  
 as if it were the Last he should doe in this World,  
 and as exactly, as if his whole Saluation depended  
 vpon it, such a Man (in Ancient *Tertullians* iudge-  
 ment<sup>l</sup>) may be truely secure of Perseuering in  
 Grace here; and of being Glorified hereafter<sup>m</sup>,  
*1 Thess. 5. 15, 24.* Once more and I haue done. Is  
 not that an excellent thing that is for the Good of  
 them that haue it, & of their children after them?  
 Riches, Honour, Beautie, Policie, these and the  
 like are not oftentimes so, as we see by woefull ex-  
 perience in *Nabal, Haman, Absalom, Achisophel*; but  
*the feare of the Lord* is euer so, *for the Good of them*  
*that haue it, and for their children after them*, as the

Prophet



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## A godly Womans Praise.

17

Prophet saith, *Jer.* 32. 39. and God himselfe before him, *Deut.* 5. 29.

There is no want to them that haue this *Feare* of any Good thing that is Good for them <sup>a</sup>. For first, *Psal.* 25. 14. *The secret, that is, the feare of the Lord, is with them that feare Him*; and is not that enough, though I should say no more with the Psalmist, because *Godly Feare is Gods Treasure*, *Esa.* 33. 6. and *Better little with it (saith Salomon) than Great Treasure* <sup>a</sup>? But there is more behind to moue you further to affect this Excellent Grace. For if you will *Feare the Lord*, He will shew you his *Couenant* <sup>p</sup> of life and peace <sup>q</sup>, *Teach you the way that you shall chuse* <sup>r</sup>, *Haue a Booke of remembrance written before Him for you* <sup>s</sup>: *Hee will Arise vnto you the Sonne of Righteousnesse with healing in his wings* <sup>t</sup>: *He wil hide you in his presence from the pride of men* <sup>u</sup>, *Keepe you secretly in a Pavilion from the strife of tongues, Deliuer you in Temptation euen againe* <sup>v</sup>; *yea He will take pleasure in you* <sup>w</sup>, *Pitie you as a Father doth his children* <sup>x</sup>, *Fulfill your Desire, Heare your crie and saue you* <sup>b</sup>. And what is all this, but in a word (the word of my Text) *Hee will praise you*, which is the Thing Promised to a woman fearing the Lord.

<sup>a</sup> *Psal.* 34. 9, 10.  
*Eccles.* 40. 26, 27.  
*Eccl.* 1. 16.

<sup>a</sup> *Prou.* 15. 16.

<sup>p</sup> *Psal.* 25. 14.

<sup>q</sup> *Mal.* 2. 5.

<sup>r</sup> *Psal.* 25. 12.

<sup>s</sup> *Mal.* 3. 16.

<sup>t</sup> *Mal.* 4. 2.

<sup>u</sup> *Psal.* 31. 20, 21.

<sup>v</sup> *Eccles.* 33. 2.

<sup>w</sup> *Psal.* 147. 11.

<sup>x</sup> *Psal.* 103. 13.

*Mal.* 3. 17.

<sup>b</sup> *Psal.* 145. 19.

*Ipsa Laudabitur: She shall be praised.*

She shall be so; but may not that labour be spared? For a man would thinke, she hath been praised all this while; because Godly Feare, the Grace of God in Her, and the onely cause of her Praise, hath beene alreadie so much commended vnto you? No (Beloued) my Text (you see) applies

D

and

II.

*The thing promised.*

*In what respect to Ipsa.*

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<sup>c</sup> Prov. 28. 4. & 14. 24. & 17. 15. Eccl. 30. 23, 29. Tho. Aquin. 22. q. 115. a. 2. Corp.

<sup>d</sup> Ego carnis bona quæ semper & ipse contempnit, in animæ laudibus nõ requiram—ad Heliodor. Epitab. Nepot.

<sup>e</sup> Prov. 27. 14. Vox autem grandis, laus excedens mensuram Meritorum. I. c. intelligitur—Paris. de Moribus. fol. 123. li. 2.

<sup>f</sup> Es. 25. 12. 1 Cor. 15. 10. & 12. 8. Phil. 2. 13. Jer. 32.

<sup>g</sup> 40. Laudari in bonis operibus debes; sed in eo quod operaris, bonum laudes expectare non debes—Deus Laudetur in operibus suis. De Batu Vidu. ad Gal. lam epist. 2. Si quæ sane in Sanctis digna laude vel admiratione intueor, clarâ luce veritatis discutienti, profectò reperio Laudabilem sue Mirabilem aliquid apparere atque aliud esse, & Lau-

do Deum in Sanctis eius. S. Bern. Ser. 13. in Cant. 8 1 Pet. 3. 4. Enim verò quis non anime dabit suam omnem, cuius nomine totius Hominis mentione lata est. Tertul. de Anima. cap. 13.

and appropriates this praise to *Ipsa*, Her own Person, by vertue indeed of *the Feare of the Lord*. For were it not for that, it were better Contemning Her, yea Contending <sup>c</sup> with Her, than Commending Her, because that is a constant marke of the Godly to Contemne the vngodly, *Psal.* 15. 4. This, of the wicked to Praise the wicked, to Bless the Couetous, whom *the Lord abhorreth*, *Psal.* 10. 3. It is not her Friendship, no nor *Carnis bona* (as Saint *Ierom* <sup>d</sup> calls them) *the Goodendowments of the flesh*, can priuiledge him from a *Curse*, if so be, he praise her without or about <sup>e</sup> her Deserts, *Prov.* 27. 14. Onely *the feare of the Lord*, with the excellent fruits thereof, is Gods Gift <sup>f</sup>, for which (saith *Fulgentius* <sup>g</sup>) she ought, and he may safely commend her, because then, not shee; but Gods *Grace* in her is *Praised*, *Ephes.* 1. 6. Yea then, *not she*, but *God himselfe is Glorified* in Her, *Gal.* 1. 24.

But what? is not *She Praised*, when Her Husband, Her Children, Her Kindred, Her Friends, Her Attendants, Her Wit, Her Wealth, Her Beautie, Her Nobilitie, or all these and the like of Hers are commended? Yes, all these come very neere Her, and mutually receiue lustre and eminencie from this Godly Feare; but they are not *Ipsa*, Her selfe, that is, <sup>h</sup> principally Her Soule truly Generous, and ennobled with the *Feare of the Lord*. Vntill such an Humble Soule be found in Her, She is not She, that *shall be adorned with the Garment of praise*, *Esa.* 61. 3. Therefore Saint *Ie-*

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rom<sup>h</sup> would not commend in Noble Marcella any thing saue Her owne Godly selfe. *Ipsa Laudabitur*: She is She that shall be Praised.

And so we see how far forth Praise is to be extended to Her. Now to speak of the Extent of Her Praise: Let the word haue his full latitude. *Laudabitur* is generall, no kinde is limited. 1. Therefore for the Extent, to be praised euery manner of way. 2. For the Time when it shall be best for her. 3. For the Praiser, by him who can best doe it. Of all these briefly.

First, what praise she shall haue. 1. Euen that (which being true) is euer accompanied with Dearest Loue to her person<sup>l</sup>. 2. Highest estimation of Gods abundant graces in Her<sup>k</sup>. 3. Frequent Commemoration of them<sup>l</sup>. 4. Moderate Lamentation at her Death<sup>m</sup>. 5. Solemne Funerals according to the Dignitie of her place<sup>n</sup>. 6. And aboue all, with precise imitation of her excellent Vertues<sup>o</sup>. All this Honour God allowes Her, that honours Him with His Feare<sup>p</sup>. But because all Praise is properly in Words (as the Schoole-manteacheth<sup>q</sup>) and better words shee cannot haue to praise Her, than God himselfe speakes<sup>r</sup>, therefore she shall be Commended in no other, neither in regard of God, nor of her Husband, Children, Kindred, Seruants, and Gods People.

First in respect of God, she shall be praised for

*mine ante probandus, sic predicandus est.* S. Ambros. Instit. Virg. cap. 3. tom. 1. 1. 2. Job. 1. 1. Hebr. 13. 1. Ephes. 5. 25. <sup>k</sup> 1 Thess. 5. 13. 1 Mark. 14. 9. Psal. 112. 6. <sup>m</sup> Gen. 23. 2. Job. 11. 33. 35. 1 King. 14. 13. 1 Thess. 4. 13. Eccles. 22. 11. 12. & 38. 16, 17. <sup>n</sup> Ait. 8. 2. 2 Chron. 32. 33. <sup>o</sup> 1 am. 5. 10. Hebr. 12. 1. & 13. 7. 1 Cor. 11. 1. <sup>p</sup> 1 Sam. 2. 30. Deut. 26. 19. Job. 12. 26. Esai. 8. 13. Timor Hominis, Dei Honor est. Tert. de Penit. c. 7. <sup>q</sup> Tho. Aquin. 22. q. 103. a. 1. ad 3. <sup>r</sup> Psal. 12. 6.

*h* ... Nihil in illa laudabo, nisi quod proprium est. S. Ieron. ad Princip. And so of Paula he saith. Nihil laudabimus nisi quod proprium est, & de purissimo sancta mentis fonte profertur. Id. ep. ad Eustoch. Nam cum omnia opera sua laudauerit Deus, cœlum, terram &c. ubi ad Hominē vē-

I.

*What Praise she shall haue.*

*The Extent of Laudabitur.*

*tum est, solus non videtur esse laudatus propter quem omnia generata sūt. Quæ igitur causa est, nisi forte ea, quia alia in specie sunt, Homo in occulto? quia aliorum Gratia foris, huius intus est. Aliorum in Natiuitate, huius in Corde. -- Ideo ergo homo non ante laudatur, quia non in forensi pelle, sed in interiore Ho-*

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## A godly Womans Praise.

- <sup>f</sup> Psal. 16. 3.  
<sup>g</sup> Psal. 83. 3.  
<sup>h</sup> Mal. 3. 17.  
<sup>i</sup> 2 Cor. 6. 18.  
<sup>j</sup> Cant. 4. 9.  
<sup>k</sup> Matth. 11. 50.  
<sup>l</sup> Hos. 2. 17.  
<sup>m</sup> Cant. 2. 10.  
<sup>n</sup> Cant. 2. 14.  
<sup>o</sup> Cant. 2. 13.  
<sup>p</sup> Cant. 6. 10.  
<sup>q</sup> Prov. 5. 19.  
<sup>r</sup> Ezek. 24. 16.  
<sup>s</sup> Eccles. 36. 22.  
<sup>t</sup> Gen. 2. 18.  
<sup>u</sup> Eccles. 36. 24.  
<sup>v</sup> Mal. 2. 14.  
<sup>w</sup> Eccles. 36. 24.  
<sup>x</sup> Prov. 31. 11.  
<sup>y</sup> Eccles. 26. 3. 23.  
<sup>z</sup> Prov. 18. 22.  
<sup>aa</sup> Eccles. 26. 14.  
<sup>ab</sup> Eccles. 26. 15.  
<sup>ac</sup> Eccles. 26. 1.  
<sup>ad</sup> Eccles. 26. 13.  
<sup>ae</sup> Prov. 31. 23.  
<sup>af</sup> Eccles. 26. 22.  
<sup>ag</sup> Prov. 19. 14.  
<sup>ah</sup> Eccles. 40. 19.  
<sup>ai</sup> Prov. 12. 4. *Non annulus, non torques aureus, non monile, sed Corona. Carum in Prov.*  
<sup>aj</sup> Psal. 21. 3. *Efflu.*  
<sup>ak</sup> 2. 17.  
<sup>al</sup> Eccles. 25. 10.  
<sup>am</sup> Eccles. 10. 24.  
<sup>an</sup> Eccles. 7. 19.  
<sup>ao</sup> Prov. 31. 10.  
<sup>ap</sup> Eccles. 26. 14. 15.

One of his Excellent <sup>f</sup>, Hidden Ones <sup>g</sup>: for one of his Jewels, which hee will make vp <sup>h</sup>: for His Daughter <sup>i</sup>, His Sister <sup>j</sup>, His Mother <sup>k</sup>, His Spouse <sup>l</sup>, His Loue <sup>m</sup>, His Doue <sup>n</sup>, His Faire <sup>o</sup> one, as Faire as the Moone, as Pure as the Sun <sup>p</sup>: as the Moone by inherent, and as the Sun, by impured Righteousnesse. To her Husband she shall bee commended, as the Louing Hind <sup>q</sup> and pleasant Roe <sup>r</sup>, the Desire of his eyes <sup>s</sup>; An Helpe like vnto Himselfe <sup>t</sup>; His Companion <sup>u</sup>; for A Pillar of rest <sup>v</sup>, so that He shall haue no need of spoile <sup>w</sup>; for a Good Portion <sup>x</sup>, a speciall Fa- uour <sup>y</sup> and Gift of the Lord <sup>z</sup>; a Double Grace <sup>aa</sup>, Doubling the number of his Daies <sup>ab</sup>, Fattening his bones <sup>ac</sup>, and making him knowne in the Gates, when he sitteth among the Elders of the Land <sup>ad</sup>: for a Tower against Death vnto him <sup>ae</sup>: A greater Blessing vnto him than either House or Inheri- tance <sup>af</sup>, Aboue children and the Building of a Ci- tie to continue his Name <sup>ag</sup>, yea for a Crowne vnto her Husband <sup>ah</sup>, nor a Gold-ring on his finger; nor a chaine of Gold about his necke, nor a Brouch in his hat; but for a Crowne vpon his head (an Or- nament more conspicuous and eminent than the former, the Principall Ensigne of Princes <sup>ai</sup>) gra- cing him that hath her, as much as a Crown doth Him that weareth it: so that there is none aboue her, that feareth the Lord <sup>aj</sup>, None greater than she, not Great Men, nor Iudges, nor Potentates <sup>ak</sup>: Her Grace is aboue Gold <sup>al</sup>. Her Price is farre a- boue Rubies <sup>am</sup>. Her Continent minde cannot be valewed <sup>an</sup>, and by reason of Her, her Husband is



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## A godly Womans Praise.

21

is a Blessed Man <sup>1</sup>, Not like other men <sup>2</sup>.

To Her Children thee shall be Commended; because by her they haue a place of Refuge <sup>3</sup>: by Her they haue good meanes to bring and continue true Honour vpon them <sup>4</sup>, and if They (the Fruit) be a great Blessing <sup>5</sup> (as it is to haue Issue by such a One) what is the Root that beareth it <sup>6</sup>?

But I must hasten: How shall she be Praised in respect of her Parents? euen as *Rachel* <sup>7</sup> for doing seruice to them as to her Masters (the true propertie of one that *feareth the Lord* <sup>8</sup>.) In respect of her kindred by marriage, as *Ruth*, louing them <sup>9</sup>; Dealing kindly with them <sup>10</sup>, and Cleauing vnto them <sup>11</sup>. And in respect of her kindred by bloud, as *Esther*, who did the Commandement of *Mordecai* when she was a Queene, like as when she was brought vp with Him <sup>12</sup>, who was exceedingly grieued at his Griefe <sup>13</sup>, and procured the Enlargement and Deliuerance of her kindred with her *Feasts* <sup>14</sup>, her *Teares* <sup>15</sup>, and the Hazard of her *Life* <sup>16</sup>.

In regard of her Seruants also, she shall be commended; because she Buildeth her House <sup>17</sup>: *Shee is like the Merchants ship, She fetcheth her food from farre* <sup>18</sup>, *She giveth meat to her Household* <sup>19</sup>, *She cloatheth them all with Scarlet* <sup>20</sup>, and *Shee looketh so well to their waies* <sup>21</sup>, that *As the Sunne when it ariseth in the high Heauen*; *So is her beautie in the Ordering of her House* <sup>22</sup>.

Lastly, because all the Essentiall Glory and Fairenesse, which is to bee found in the whole Church, *The Woman cloathed with the Sunne* <sup>23</sup>, as

D 3 that

<sup>1</sup> Eccles. 16. 1.

<sup>2</sup> Eccles. 36. 23. *Sine Muliere igitur Homo non habet Laudem, in Muliere predicatur, &c.*  
<sup>3</sup> Ambros. Instit. Virg. cap. 3. tom. 1.

<sup>4</sup> Prov. 14. 26. & 11. 2.

<sup>5</sup> Deut. 5. 29. Psal. 112. 2.

<sup>6</sup> Psal. 127. 3.

<sup>7</sup> Psal. 128. 3.

<sup>8</sup> Gen. 29. 9.

<sup>9</sup> Eccles. 3. 7.

<sup>10</sup> Ruth 4. 15.

<sup>11</sup> 1. 8.

<sup>12</sup> 1. 14. & 6. 2. 11.

<sup>13</sup> 2. 10.

<sup>14</sup> 4. 4.

<sup>15</sup> 4. 16.

<sup>16</sup> 8. 3.

<sup>17</sup> 4. 11, 16.

<sup>18</sup> Prov. 31. 14.

<sup>19</sup> 31. 15.

<sup>20</sup> 31. 21.

<sup>21</sup> 31. 27.

<sup>22</sup> Eccles. 26. 16.

<sup>23</sup> Revel. 21. 1.

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1 Gal. 3. 28. Ephes. 4. 15. 16. Cant. 2. 10.  
 --Cum ipsos cogita-  
 tis amantes, non vi-  
 rum & Feminam,  
 sed verbum & c. A-  
 nimam sentiat, o-  
 partes. Et si Chri-  
 stum & Ecclesiam  
 dixeris, idem est, ni-  
 si quod Ecclesia no-  
 mine non una Ani-  
 ma, sed multarum  
 unitas, vel potius  
 unanimitas defig-  
 natur. S. Bern. serm.  
 61. in Cant.

that of Iustification & Sanctification &c. belongs to euery Member of the Church <sup>f</sup>, and cōsequently to euery *Woman fearing the Lord*, therefore to Gods people she shall be commended, as one of the Hands of the Church *dropping with sweet smelling Mirrhe* <sup>g</sup>: As the *Curtaines of Salomon*<sup>h</sup>; As a *Lilly among thornes* <sup>i</sup>; A *Garden inclosed*: A *Spring shut up*. A *Fountain sealed* <sup>k</sup>.

But when shall shee haue all this Praise, and of whom? Not by and by, nor of Euery one <sup>l</sup>, for Praise is not comely in the mouth of euery one, of euery scoffing *Ishmael*.

But first of the Time.

II.

*When she shall be Praised.*

3 Cant. 5. 5.  
 1. 5.  
 2. 2.  
 4. 12.  
 1 Luk. 6. 26. Eccles. 13. 9.  
 28. 16.  
 30. 18.  
 40. 31.  
 64. 4.  
 Heb. 10. 36, 37, 38.  
 Hab. 2. 3, 4.  
 1 Cor. 4. 5.

o 1 Pet. 1. 7. Et nos ergo nō a nobis lau-  
 demus exigamus, nec

præcipiamus iudicium Dei & præueniamus sententiam iudicis, sed suo Tempori, suo Iudici refer-  
 amus. S. Ambros. in Luc. 18. c. 17. tom. 5. 2 Tim. 2. 5. Eccles. 11. 27. 28. 1 Nam si laudari au-  
 tē Gubernator non potest quia in portum nauem deduxerit: quomodo laudabis Homine priusquam  
 in stationem mortis successerit? S. Ambr. de Bono Mort. c. 8. tom. 4. Merito ergo differtur, ut se-  
 quatur fuerata eius Laudatio, cuius dilatio non dispendium; sed incrementum est. Et ideo lau-  
 datio eius non in exordia; sed in fine est. Nemo enim nisi legitime certauerit, coronabitur. Ideoq; sa-  
 piens titi dicit: Ante mortem non laudes hominem quemquam. Ratio. Quia in fine hominis nudan-  
 tur opera eius. Id. Instit. Virg. c. 3. tom. 1.

Many when they heare a Promise (and a Pro-  
 mise I told you at first, this is) thinke to haue it by  
 and by; but they marke not, that a Promise and  
 the Fruition of it is not all at once. It must be wai-  
 ted for <sup>m</sup>, especially this Promise of Praise: *Until  
 the Lord come* (as the Apostles limit the Time) and  
 then, at his Appearing, *she shall haue praise of God* <sup>n</sup>.  
 Then at his Appearing <sup>o</sup>, *Her Faith shall be found unto  
 Praise and Honour, and Glory*. Therefore in the  
 mean while, best for her to *Fear the Lord*, and so be  
 praise-worthy, than to be praised for the present.

1. Not only because it is safest praising Her as  
 a Master of a ship is (saith S. Ambrose <sup>p</sup>) when she

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is safely arrived in the Haven, past all danger of shipwracke: or growing more proud by her praise (which many Liuing doe) as *Herod* for one <sup>1</sup>, and that Philosopher for another, whose soule being before no bigger than a mans finger, became so puffed vp and swolne with others commending him, that (as *Arrianus* reports) it grew greater than two Cubits <sup>2</sup>.

<sup>1</sup> *Act. 12. 21.*

<sup>2</sup> *Arrian. Epist. 1.*

<sup>3</sup> *6. 2.*

2. Nor only because actual praise is in the lips of the praiser, and so a wicked woman may be praised, and yet not be worthy of it, and a godly woman may be praise-worthy, and yet not haue it, whereas praise-worthinesse is euer in the partie to be praised, and fewest (you know) haue this worth; but many haue praise without it, therefore praise-worthinesse is the Nobler Grace of the two, and consequently best for a Woman to be worthy of praise, though she be not praised for the present.

3. But one of the chiefest Reasons is this; because indeed all our earthly praise is *Laudatur*, that is, for the present; but continueth not. Is, but shall not be. Sometimes a godly woman is commended, and sometimes she is not. As *S. Paul* praised the *Corinthians* <sup>1</sup>, *Now I praise you Brethren*, and by <sup>2</sup> and by he saith: *Shall I praise you in this? I praise you not*: whereas This praise here promised so Is, that it *shall be* still, and that cannot be in this Transitory world; but in Heauen, where Her praise that seareth the Lord for euer, endureth for euer: *Laudabitur, She shall be praised.*

<sup>1</sup> *1 Cor. 12. 1. 21.*

The best Time then for commending Her is yet to come, and that from Him who can best doe it; But

III.

*Of whom shee  
shall be praised.*

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1 2 Kings 9. 11.  
 24. 24. 5. & 26.  
 24. Neh. 6. 13.

u Tert. Apolog. 1. 7.  
 c. Arnob. aduers.  
 Gent. M. Felix in  
 Orlan.

2 Gratias ago Deo  
 meo, quod dignus  
 sum, quem mundus  
 oderit. S. Ierom. A-  
 felle.

7 Ephes. 5. 15. Phil.  
 4. 8. 9. 2 Cor. 8. 20.  
 1 Pet. 2. 12. Heb.  
 11. 39. Eccl. 4. 1. 12.  
 -Nec ex nobis scin-  
 tilla procedat, per  
 quam aduersus nos  
 sinistra fama flam-  
 ma confletur. Nos  
 id agamus, ut male  
 de nobis nemo loqui,  
 absque Mendacio  
 possit. Paulin. epist.  
 ad Celant.

2 1 Cor. 4. 5.

2 2 Cor. 10. 18.  
 Job. 12. 43.

b 2 Pet. 3. 9.

c Lam. 5. 8, 9.

d 1 Pet. 4. 5.

But I must tell you first, this Time should neuer come, could the scoffing *Ismaels* of our daies be heard railing vpon, iesting at, belying and slander-  
 ing Her and Him *that feareth the Lord*. It was euer  
 their Deuillish propertie <sup>c</sup>, with many disgrace-  
 full censures to dimme the glory of the children of  
 Light, spitefully to aggrauate their tender frail-  
 ties, rather than to commend their vnreprouable  
 Graces. So of old they scourged the Primitiue  
 Christians with their viperous, virulent tongues <sup>u</sup>;  
 but as Saint *Ierome* thanks God that He was coun-  
 ted worthy to be hated of the world <sup>2</sup>; so should  
 euery good man and woman, not much trouble  
 themselues for the vniust censures and disconceits  
 of witlesse and worthlesse prophanenesse; but ra-  
 ther (as *Paulinus* <sup>7</sup> exhorts) haue more regard to  
 their good name, lest any sparkle or appearance of  
 euill truly proceed from them, whereby any flame  
 of euill report may be kindled, and so to liue, that  
 none may speake euill of them without lying. For  
 maugre the malice of all Sensualists, the Time will  
 come, when euery man and woman that feareth  
 God, shall haue praise of God <sup>2</sup>, 1 Cor. 4. which  
 is the best praise, when all is done <sup>a</sup>, 2 Cor. 10. Yea  
 (Beloued) that you may not count *the Lord* slacke  
 concerning his promise <sup>b</sup>, Saint *Iames* tells you,  
 This *comming of the Lord draweth neere* <sup>c</sup>: Behold  
 the Iudge standeth at the doore, He is readie to iudge  
 the Quicke and the Dead (saith Saint *Peter* <sup>d</sup>) readie  
 to commend them, whom the world hath con-  
 demned; and to condemne them, whom world-  
 lings haue commended: readie to reueale vnto the  
 whole



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## A godly Womans Praise.

25

whole world the good workes of the godly, *Hon-  
rifico pietatis testimonio*, with an honourable appro-  
bation of their blessed godlinesse; & also to reueale  
vnto the whole world the wicked Deeds of the vn-  
godly, *Manifesto impietatis vituperio*, with a publike,  
and open, vncontrouleable Discommendation of  
their cursed wickednesse <sup>c</sup>: yea the Iudge is ready <sup>c</sup> *Mat. 25. 34, 41.*  
to turne *Laudabitur* into *Laudatur*, her praise wor-  
thinesse that feareth Him for euer, into euerlasting  
Praise; so that should her Husband and Children  
faile to praise Her, which yet they do not, for they  
commend Her in the 29. verse of this Chapter,  
saying: *Many daughters haue done vertuously; but  
thou excellest them all* <sup>f</sup>: or should the Godly cease <sup>f</sup> *Prou. 31. 18, 29.*  
to praise Her, which they will neuer do either here  
or in Heauen <sup>g</sup>. Here Her remembrance is so <sup>g</sup> *Cant. 6. 9.*  
sweet in all their mouthes, that they say: <sup>h</sup> *Let  
her Memory be blessed: Let her bones flourish out of her  
place; and Let the name of Her that was honoured be* <sup>h</sup> *Eccles. { 39. 10.  
44. 15.  
49. 1.  
46. 11, 12*  
*continued vpon her Children* <sup>i</sup>: or should Her owne  
workes giue ouer praising Her in the Gates, which  
they are forbidden to doe, vers. 31. of this Chap-  
ter, yet God himselfe will haue *Her workes follow  
her to Heauen* <sup>k</sup>, and *Accepting of Her* <sup>l</sup>, and *Them* <sup>k</sup> *Reuel. 4. 13.*  
*by Christ Iesus* <sup>m</sup>, *Hee himselfe will praise Her, that* <sup>l</sup> *Gen. 4. 4. A.B.*  
*hath made Him Her Feare* <sup>n</sup>, *Her praise* <sup>o</sup>, saying: <sup>m</sup> *Hebr. 13. 15.*  
*Well done thou good and faithfull servant, thou hast* <sup>n</sup> *Esai. 8. 13.*  
*beene faithfull ouer a few things, I will make thee ruler* <sup>o</sup> *Deut. 10. 21.*  
*ouer many things, Enter thou into the ioy of thy Lord* <sup>p</sup> *Matth. 25. 21.*  
Where it is best to leaue Her, euen with her Lord,  
taking more ioy (as a Schoole-man teacheth tru-  
ly) in praising Him, than in contemplating her  
E owne

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¶ *Perfecta Dei laudatio magis animā perficit, quā Dei fructio, quia magis latatur in Gloria & plus gaudebit de Dei gloria & honore, quā de sua Glorificatione, & plus iocundabitur in laudando Dominū, quā in considerando proprium bonū.* Bonan. 3. d. 1. q. 1. p. 66. A. s. l. m. Prolog. c. 15. & 16.  
 ¶ *Quid agamus anima? cur ad mortem eius venire formidamus? — S. Ier. Epitaph. Paula.*

*Application.*

*The Lady deceased.*

*Mulier Timor Dominum.*

¶ 1 Pet. 3. 7.

¶ Esai. 33. 6.

¶ 2 Cor. 4. 7.

*Epist. ad Principem Gal. 3. 28.*

¶ *Non considerantes Molem & Anam ac Debitum, viris scētibz prophetaffe, & insensitate Christi nequaquam differentiam Sexuum valere; sed Mentium.* S. Ierom. Euseb.

owne praise, in Glorifying God, than in her owne Glorification.

But though we haue brought a Godly Woman where she would be, to Heauenly Praise, and Honour, and Glory, and found them by Gods free fauour in Christ giuen vnto Her; yet who is such a Woman? We haue not found Her yet; and why not yet? Because among other reasons, as Saint *Ierom* was afraid to entreat of the Death of that Venerable Matron *Paula*; so am I to speake of the Decease of this Honourable Lady. Therefore giue me leaue (beloued) to deferre the vncomfortable Passions of her Death, vntill I be a little better heartned by relating some of the laudable actions of her Life.

For the subiect then of my Text, I dare say, in regard of the Description thereof, your owne consciences haue made the Application, and doe witness for Her, that She was *A Woman fearing the Lord*. A Woman indeed, & so the *Weaker Vessel*, yet neuerthelesse Honour to be giuen Her in that respect; but rather the more (as Saint *Peters* inference will allow) because though shee had *This Treasure of the Feare of the Lord in an Earthen and in a Weaker Vessel*, yet Gods strength was made perfect in her Weaknesse. And it is S. *Ieroms* rule, you should iudge of Vertues, *Non Sexu, sed Animo*: Not by the Sex, but by the Minde and constant purpose of a Regenerate Heart: This makes the Difference of force in the seruice of Christ, not either Male or Female.

Suruey then (if you please) as briefly as you wil, the

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## *A godly Womans Praise.*

27

the severall workings of Her Godly Feare.

First to Her Head, her Subjection and Helpfulnessse like that of Saint *Augustines* Mother to his Father \*.

To Her Children, her tenderest Affection and Sollicitousnesse to plant *the feare of the Lord* in their hearts, to fit them with worthy Matches out of Religious Families, to adorne her onely Sonne with the richest endowments of Grace and Learning: Witnesse her Letters to that Learned Professour \* in our famous Vniuersitie, worthy to be kept as a Monument of her truly Noble spirit and Godly Desire (like that of *Gregory Nazianzen's* Sister) to haue the fruit of her Body become the fruit of the Spirit †.

To Her Parents, shee was another *Rachel*, another *Marcella* ‡.

To Her Kindred by mariage another *Ruth*, and to them by bloud another *Hester*.

To Her Seruants, shee was bountifull in their Health; compassionate (as *Fabiola* § Jin their Sicknesse, either of Minde or of Body, prouiding for them (like the Centurion) both spirituall and corporall Physicke.

To All, Her whole Deportment was so Louely, so sweet, what *by the law of kindnesse in her tongue* ¶, Salutations, Gifts, Almes-Deeds, Visitations, Inuitations, and by other offices of courtesies and Hospitalities, that Her Amiable Behaviour was a powerfull Meanes, an attractive Load-stone to draw vnto Her the hearts and loues of as many as knew Her, yea as but heard of Her.

*The workings of Godly feare in regard of Her: Husband: Children.*

\* S. Aug. confess. lib. 9. cap. 9.

\* Doct. Prideaux Rector of Exeter College in Oxford.

† Greg. Nazian. in Laudem Gorgon. Orat. 25.

*Parents.*

‡ S. Ier. ad Princip. Nusquam sine Matre &c. &c.

*Kindred.*

*Servants.*

§ Id. Epistol. Fabiola.

*Religious Deportment to all.*

\* Prov. 31. 26.

*Especially vnto Gods people.*

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<sup>16-3.</sup>  
 a Psal. { 119. 63.  
           79.  
 Gal. 6. 10. 1 Pet. 2.  
 17. Coloss. 1. 4.

But vnto Gods children she euer only afforded the dearest pangs, the highest Degree of her kindest Affection <sup>a</sup>: Their company she most loued, and they Hers. Not so much in regard of Her fauour towards them, which was great; but chiefly by reason of that spiritual Helpe and refreshment, which they might get by conuersing with Her in the choicest passages of Sanctification. For shee had the Art to vphold holy conferences about perplexities of conscience, Relapses into sin, and Remedies against the same: Shee had the skill to beget many ioyfull Meditations of mortifying Grace and euerlasting Glory: She had the Zeale to nourish Heauenly mindednesse, boldnesse in the waies, and cheerefulnesse in the exercises of Religion and Deuotion.

*Constant use  
 of the Meanes  
 of Salvation.*

Touching Her submission to the Meanes of Salvation: O what delight shee tooke here and in London, to heare conscionable and searching Sermons! It was Her onely Pleasure in that Citie (as she professed) to frequent them there; yea what Griefe was it vnto Her (as it was vnto Saint Ambrose) to heare of the Death of any of Gods zealous Ministers <sup>c</sup>?

<sup>c</sup> Paulin. in Vita  
 D. Ambrosij.

And should I be silent, yet Her Oratory in her house hereby, this Church too (a part whereof her Zeale, together with her Honourable Husbands Loue to Gods House newly erected) that Closset also of Hers in *Truro*, yea euery place almost would speake aloud of her constant reading, hearing, meditating on the Word, solemne Humiliations, solitary conferences with her God, fer-

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uent prayers and ejaculations, which (as the sweetest incense) shee euer and anon sent vp to the Throne of Grace for the pardon of her finnes, the fauour of God, the spirituall Good of her Dearest Husband, Children, and Gods Church.

But adde vnto all these, another more speciall, essentiall, and superiour working of Her Godly Feare, and that was Her continuall Combating against all sinne, euen Her most commanding sin whatsoeuer that was <sup>f</sup>. For there was a time to my knowledge, when after the preaching vnto Her of the power and efficacie of Gods promises, and of Christs Death and Resurrection, for the mortifying and mastering of any bosome and beloued sinne, you might easily see in Her, how willingly she yeelded vnto the Sanctifying worke of the Holy Ghost for the Ouer-comming of her strongest corruptions, how heauily shee was displeased with relapses into smaller offences of daily incursion against the generall and constant purpose <sup>g</sup> of her heart not to sinne in any thing; how faithfully she rested vpon those sweetest <sup>h</sup> promises of God (which she confessed she had not erst so well weighed) for the mortifying of speciall infirmities, and how vnfainedly shee resolved to set her Faith on worke, to draw not onely assurance of pardon from the Merit of Christs Death and Resurrection; but also that Power and efficacie which is in them, to *Die to Sinne, and Liue to Righteousnesse* <sup>i</sup>

<sup>f</sup> Psal. 18. 23 Rom. 7. 21, 22, 23, 24.

*Vnfained Resolution to mortifie her most preuailing Sinne.*

<sup>g</sup> Psal. 119. 6, 8. Act. 11. 23.

<sup>h</sup> Mic. 7. 18. 1 Iob. 1. 9. Rom. 6. 14. Ez. 36. 25. 2 Cor. 12. 7. 9.

<sup>i</sup> Rom. 6. 4, 5, &c. *Vt, inquam, illa Christi mortis nobis communicatur, ut per hanc Christi vim moriamur peccato, sicut Christus peccato se incluserat, id est, non ut peccatum nobis non imputetur, sed enim ad iustificationem pertinet) sed ut peccati vis iam non sit nobis efficax, immo verò contra freti viciū Christi, cui per Spiritum Sanctum coniuncti sumus, peccatum occidamus. --- possumus quia non satis est nō peccare; sed etiam*

*benè agere oportet, eadem via illa Christi, quā victor peccati et mortis in carne nostra nobiscum communicata facit ut &c.* Beza epist. Theolog. 45. p. 211.

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## A godly Womans Praise.

<sup>k</sup> Ecclef. 8. 3.

<sup>i</sup> S. Ierom. Enstoch. Epitaph. Paul.

<sup>m</sup> Neq. parū distat inter has lachrymas Devotionis & etatis utiq. iun. viridis, atque eas quas primæ etas inter infantia vagi<sup>o</sup> emisit, lachrymas utiq. penitentie & Confessionis. Verumtamen longè amplius utrisque procedunt alie quædā lachrymæ, quibus insudat sap. vini. Illas enim lachrymas verè in vinū mutari dixim, quæ Fraternæ Compassionis affectu in fervore prædeunt charitatis, pro qua etiā ad bonitatem to the Poore.

tam tui ipsius immemor esse, sobria quædā ebrietate videri. S. Bern. in Epiph. Dom. Serm. 3. Thankfulnesse for Deliverance from the Plegue.

<sup>n</sup> All. 9. 3d.

<sup>o</sup> Psal. { 91. 7.  
50. 15.  
33. 1.

This was the Life of this Elect Lady fearing the Lord, and therefore she hath right and interest to all those Honourable Attributes of Praise, which you heard even now God himselfe giue her in His owne words.

But O my Soule what dost thou? Why art thou yet afraid to come to her Death? as if while I held my peace and were busied in Her Praises, Her Death could be deferred? Alas it could not by all the Meanes that were vsed. For *No man* (saith the Preacher) *hath power over the spirit to retain the spirit* <sup>k</sup>. Then speake of her Death I must, and yet (to make vse of S. Ierom's words in a like case) *Quis possit siccis oculis Paulam narrare morientem* <sup>l</sup>? Who can relate the Death of the Lady Frances Roberts without shedding some Teares of Compassion, of Deuotion, yea and of Compunction too <sup>m</sup>? Shee deserues some Teares from vs (Beloued) as well as from the Poore, weeping now and shewing the Coats and garments which this *Dorcas* made for them, while she was with them <sup>n</sup>.

But to stop the current of them a little longer. Begin we with Gods mercifull preservation of Her in *London* from the noysome Pestilence; because she acknowledged it (as was meet) with humble Thankfulnesse <sup>o</sup>. And then remember, that vpon Her returne home, being summoned by Sicknesse, by and by she set her *House in order*, like *Hezekiah*; She spake to the Hearts of Her Children, Friends, and Seruants, that were then about Her (like *Jacob*) by putting them in remembrance of Her Departure and their Duties: She hungered and thirsted

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## *A godly Womans Praise.*

31

Aced after the Body and Blood of Her Dearest Sa-  
uour, which shee receiued with Due Examinati-  
on <sup>r</sup> of Her Knowledge; Faith; Loue and Repen-  
tance, with reuerent Gesture, heartie Thankful-  
nesse, deuout Attention, and very Fruitfully to the  
greater strengthening and refreshing of Her Soule  
then traueilling for the other Life.

*Worthy recei-  
uing the Sa-  
crament.*  
<sup>r</sup> 1 Cor. 12.

And now (Beloued) that she lieth on the bed of  
Languishing, we must not be austere in reprehending  
euerie Infirmitie; but Pitifull in considering  
the tender frailtie of it.

For what though shee were (as Sicke folke are  
commonly <sup>\*</sup>) more Passionate than others, yea  
than Her selfe in Her health, yet if God iudgeth  
not according to the strange Effects and Symp-  
toms of Her sicknesse, not according to the short  
moment and violent passions of Her Death; but  
according to the holy Actions of Her Health, the  
former Affections of Her Heart, and the Generall  
Course of Her Life <sup>†</sup>; then it is our Dutie, not  
seuerely to censure her passionatenesse, who by  
reason of the parching Feauer of the Spirit, as well  
as of the Body, was disquieted in her Imagination  
(as the Physitian of the body could discern)  
though not in her Memory. Consider therefore  
O Man (as that excellent Physitian of the Soule  
aduiseth thee <sup>r</sup>) if thou canst beare with a fraile  
Body, that thou must much more beare with a  
fraile Minde and Body too. Consider also O Man,  
that this her Pettishnesse did more wound her to  
the heart, than any iniury thou couldst presse her  
with. Neither doe I speake this to nourish passion

*Passionatenesse  
by reason of  
Spiritual and  
Bodily Distem-  
per.*

<sup>\*</sup> Quodammodo in ro-  
bus sic moritur uir-  
go. Eurip. Orest.

<sup>†</sup> Mr. Greenham.  
1. Treat. for Aff-  
lict. Consc. fol.  
221. part 2.

<sup>r</sup> Id. Of Death.  
fol. 9. part 2.

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<sup>c</sup> Vitemus ergo aut  
temperemus iracū-  
diā: ne sit cū aut  
in laudibus excep-  
tio, aut in vitis ex-  
aggeratio. S. Ambr.  
Off. lib. 1. cap. 21.

*Repentance  
for the same.*

<sup>c</sup> 1am. 1. 20. Psalm.  
4. 4.

<sup>o</sup> Ephes. 4. 26. Vel  
certē sic: Si irasci-  
mini, vobis irasci-  
mini, quia commoti  
estis, & non pecca-  
bitis. Qui enim sibi  
irascitur, quia citō  
cōmotus est, desinit  
irasci alteri. Id. ibid.

*Her Agonie.*

<sup>x</sup> Ezek. 18. 13, 30.

<sup>y</sup> — Si quem vide-  
rimus pauperē mo-  
riturum, sumptu iu-  
uemus, & dicat v-  
nusquisq; nostrūm:  
Benedictio mortu-  
ri in me veniat: Si  
quē viderimus de-  
bilē, non desera-  
mus, si quem in ex-  
tremis positū, non  
relinquamus. S. Am-  
bros. de Bono Mort.  
cap. 8. tom. 4.

in any, or to proue her Anger to be Sinnelesse<sup>c</sup>; but to be a lesse Sinne, because her Spirituall and Bodily Distemper was so great, or rather because her Faith quenched the flame of this fiery passion in Christs Bloud, resolved and melted her hearr into many penitent Teares afterwards. Oh, said she to me, (pressing her with *Dauids* example, *Psalm. 131.*) In my Health I could digest any injury, and deemed it base and vngodly, not to be able to doe so; but now (I know not how) me thinkes I am over-tender in bearing them. I am impatient indeed, and then I weepe for my impatiencie. For I know (as she her selfe vrged) *The wrath of Man doth not accomplish the Righteousnesse of God*<sup>c</sup>.

Thus shee was Angrie with her selfe for being Angrie with others, and then (according to Saint *Ambroses* rule) it ceased towards them before the Sunne went downe<sup>a</sup>; and was not this Holy Reuenge on her selfe a true fruit of Euangelicall Repentance? *2 Cor. 7. 11.*

But aye me! me thinkes I now heare her groaning vnder the dolefull pangs of Death, vnder those pangs of which shee had foretold saying: I shall suffer much more ere I goe hence. And can any haue the heart to heare her groaning pangs, without renting his owne heart from his darling pleasure? without lamenting his owne sinnes, which vnlesse he forsake betimes, will bring him to cuerlasting Burnings<sup>x</sup>? or without learning to compassionate euey weake one, to assist any one yeelding yp the Ghost, because (as Saint *Ambrose* giues the reason<sup>y</sup>) the holy Peopphet *Iob* desired



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## *A godly Womans Praise.*

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the Blessing of one, that lyes a Dying: *Benedictio morituri, in me veniat*: Let the blessing of him that is readie to die, come vpon me!

Let vs then, not yet, leaue this Departing Saint. For in the midst of this her Agonie, after shee had layen groaning many houres without any articulate or distinct speech, yet vpon triall made of Her sense and memory by demanding of Her, whether she would haue prayers made for Her, she answered plainly: VWith all my heart, pray, pray. And then as *Gregory Nazianzen*<sup>a</sup> reports of his Father, that though He was daily, yea hourly, in great paine before his Death, yet He was euer still and quiet from paine, onely while Diuine Service was saying; so this Deuout Lady forgetting (as it were) Her former Groanings, did listen attentiuely to the prayers that were made for Her, without fetching so much as one sob during that time. And afterwards rehearsing distinctly part of the Lords Prayer, you might heare Her, when S. *Stephens* Vision and last words<sup>b</sup> were read vnto Her, repeat very often these last words of Her Sauour<sup>c</sup>: *O Heavenly Father into thy hands I commend my spirit*. Thus on a sudden I haue told you how she *Dyed in the Lord*<sup>d</sup>, and is *with Christ*<sup>e</sup>.

And though we saw her afterwards mouing her lips; but heard not her Voice, no more than they that were at Saint *Ambroses* Death did heare his Voice; but only saw his lips moue<sup>d</sup>; yet we must not thinke *The Spirit of strength*<sup>e</sup>, of *Prayer* and *Grace*<sup>f</sup>, is then onely strong, when we heare a Dying Saint pray, because Christs Spirit cries in

*Deuotion at Her Death.*

<sup>a</sup> *Orat. 28. de Funere Patriæ. Tom. 2.*

<sup>b</sup> *Act. 7. 53, 56, 59.*

<sup>c</sup> *Luke 23. 46.*

<sup>d</sup> *Reuel. 14. 13.*

<sup>e</sup> *Phil. 1. 23.*

<sup>d</sup> *Paulin. in D. Ambrosii Vita.*

<sup>e</sup> *Esaï. 11. 2.*

<sup>f</sup> *Zach. 12. 10.*

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<sup>c</sup> Gal. 4. 6.

<sup>b</sup> Rom. 8. 26.

<sup>a</sup> 1 Tim. 5. 21.

Gods Children, *Abba, Father* <sup>c</sup>, with Vnutterable Groanings <sup>b</sup> which we cannot heare, and therefore I doubt not, but this Elect Lady cried loudest in Gods eares, when we heard not her words; and why may we not thinke now, our sinnes hindered vs from hearing them? I am sure, heretofore she hath spoken againe and againe many Heart-piercing speeches to deterre from Sinne, and to allure to Holinesse of Life. If she be not hearkened to now, henceforth wee shall heare Her speake no more. *I charge you therefore before God and the Lord Iesus Christ, and the Elect Angells*: you (I say) I charge whomsoever shee hath iustly reprobued for any Sin, that you forsake those Sins; and whomsoever shee hath zealously exhorted to holy Duties, that you performe those holy Duties, for henceforth you shall heare Her speake no more.

### Conclusion.

*Sed quid ego temeriter Frater? quid expellam? ut nostrum tecum comariatur et quasi conspectu in oratio? S. Ambrosius. de Obitu fratris. Tom. 3.*

But why should I detaine thee (Honourable Lady) any longer? Or what doe you (Beloued) expect more? That our speech also should Die together with Hers, and (as it were) be Buried together with Her. O my Blessed Brethren, suffer neither this Godly Lady, nor Gods word to depart so dishonourably from you.

### I.

*Imitation of* Suffer not Her so to depart from you; but let her euer liue in your breasts by Esteeming Her very highly in loue for Her workes sake, by Commemorating Gods Graces in Her; but aboue all by *Her Vertues.* Imitating her Faith and Vertues<sup>d</sup>. Then you shall not need to grieue very much for Her Absence

<sup>d</sup> Ideò laude oris ad hominem vivimus, ut alios apud quos laudatur, in bonam opinionem, & Reuerentiam, & Imitationem ipsius inducamus. Thom. Aquin. 22. q. 97.

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## A godly Womans Praise.

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from you ; because she is *with Christ, which is best of all* <sup>k</sup> ; because she is *Taken away*, not from you ; but *from the euill to come*, *Esaï. 57. 1.* From you shee is not Taken, but from seeing the plagues and miseries of this wretched world, yea from seeing the future Deaths of you, Her Dearest friends <sup>l</sup>, for whom she would haue wept full bitterly ; but you haue greater Cause, if you will heare *S. Ambrose* and *S. Ierome* comforting themselves in a like case, to Reioyce <sup>m</sup> and to giue God thanks <sup>n</sup>, that you Haue had Her, nay that you Haue Her, if so be you follow Her good example, and represent her to the life by your Godly Life.

To conclude : I beseech you all (Blessed Brethren) Suffer not the Word of God, which you haue heard this day, for want of the Feare of God, which is *The firmest foundation of Gods word* <sup>o</sup>, to vanish into aire, into nothing, to rebound from your flintie hearts (as a shaft shot against a wall of Adamant <sup>p</sup> ; ) but in Gods Name, Let the Sword of Gods Spirit sunder euery one of our minion finnes from our bosomes: Let Gods pretious promise here of praising a *Woman that feareth the Lord*, feare vs from our strongest corruptions. *Atq; utissimam praeconia feminarum, imitarentur viri.* And I may well wish with Saint *Ierome*, that Men would emulate and imitate Women in their deserved at-

<sup>k</sup> Phil. 1. 23. --- Et Christum ledimus cum euocatos quosque ab illa quasi miserandis non aequanimiter accipimus. Cupio, inquit Apostolus, recipi iam--- Ergo uolum si alios consequutos impatienter dolemus, ipse consequi nolumus. Tertul. de Patient. cap. 9. Temperet sane Dilecti Gaudii, molestiam desolatorum, & tolerabilis fiat nobis, quod Nobiscum non est, quia cum Deo est. Ber. in Cant. ser. 27.

II.

*Practise of Gods word.*

<sup>l</sup> Non enim nobis ereptus es, sed periculis. --- raptus est ne totius orbis excidia, mundi finem, propinquum funeris, &c. S. Ambros. de Obitu Fratru. fol. 17.

<sup>m</sup> Latendum est enim magis, quod talem fratrem ba-

luerim, quam dolendum, quod fratrem amiserim. Illud enim munus, hoc debitum est. Idem ibid. fol. 13. <sup>n</sup> Non maremus quod talem amisimus, sed gratias agimus, quod habuimus, immo habemus. S. Ierom. Epitaph. Paula. <sup>o</sup> Basis quaedam Verbi est Timor sanctus. Sicut enim simulacrum aliquod in Basi statuitur--- ita uerbum Dei in Timore Sancto melius statuitur. foris radiatur, hoc est, in pectore timentis Dominum--- S. Ambros. in Psal. 118. Serm. 5. <sup>p</sup> Iam. 1. 22. Zach. 7. 12.

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<sup>a</sup> S. Ierom. epist. ad Furiam.

## III.

Means to Godly Feare.

<sup>c</sup> 1 Cor. 10. 11.

Reuel. 14. 7.

<sup>d</sup> Esai. 57. 11. &

53. 5. Mat. 27. 46.

<sup>e</sup> Eccles. 3. 14. 1. b

7. 1. Psal. 39. 4. &

90. 12.

<sup>f</sup> 2 Cor. 5. 10.

Matth. 12. 30.

<sup>g</sup> Rom. 2. 15. Rem.

6. 16.

## IV.

So Great a Feare as must feare vs from our Bosome Sinne.

Psal. 18. 23. Prov.

8. 13.

<sup>h</sup> ---Hunc si quis

parum metuit, val-

de contemnit-- B.

Fulg. de Myst. Me-

at. ad Trism. l. 2.

pag. 215.

<sup>i</sup> Si in solo uno pec-

cato decesserit Ho-

mo, irrevocabili-

ter mittitur in ignem

eternum--Gerson. 2. b. de Mendicit. Spirit. lit. D & H. part. 2.

<sup>k</sup> Ex parte enim Aversonis di-

citur lacus, in qui offendit in uno factus est omnium reus, quia scilicet uno peccato peccando incurrit

pœna rectum, ex hoc, quod contemnit Deum, ex cuius contemptu provenit omnium peccatorum reus.

Aquin. 1. 2. q. 73. a. 1. ad 10. Peccatum enim remitti non potest, quamdiu voluntas peccato adheret.

Idem p. 3. q. 87. a. 1. c. & q. 86. a. 2. c. Unde non potest esse vere penitens, qui de uno peccato po-

nitetur, & non de alio. Si enim d. splicet ei illud peccatum, quia est contra Deum super omnia di-

lectum--Sequeretur, quod de omnibus peccatis penitiret. Id. q. 86. a. 3. c.

tributions of Praise <sup>a</sup>. Lastly, if you desire to know, besides this motiue of obtaining Heauenly praise, what other Meanes you should vse to get, keepe and increase such a godly Feare in you, then consider the examples of Gods dreadfull iudgements <sup>b</sup> on them, that Feare Him not, yea on Christ Iesus Himselfe pursued for our sins <sup>c</sup> to the fullness of Bitternesse by the iustice of God, consider that first. Then remember your owne Deaths to haue them before you <sup>d</sup>, remember your strict Accounts to be made <sup>e</sup>, remember the restlessse Terrour of Conscience <sup>f</sup>, which followes the impenitent, and then or neuer you will *Feare the Lord Greatly*, as *Obadiah* and this Blessed Lady did. Be not deceiued (my Brethren) after all this Hearing, it is not a Little Feare will serue the turne. For to Feare God but a little (as *Fulgentius* saith) is to contemne Him very much <sup>g</sup>. It must bee at least so Great a Feare, as must feare you from your Greatest, your Sweetest Sinne whatsoeuer that be, else if you Die in it <sup>h</sup> without Repentance (which God forbid) your *Worme shall not die, neither shall your fire be quenched, and you shall be*, not a praise, but an *Abhorring to all flesh*, the last verse of the Prophet *Esay* with *Iames* 2. 10. <sup>i</sup>, and *Ezekiel*. 18. 10, 11, 13.



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Knowing therefore (as Saint Paul concludes <sup>c</sup>) <sup>c</sup> 2 Cor. 5. 10, 11. the terror of the Lord, we perswade you (Blessed Brethren) to feare God Greatly, and to Giue Glory vnto Him <sup>d</sup>; then you shall haue praise of Him, then hee <sup>d</sup> Reuel. 14. 7. will glorifie you; and to say no more than this (with the Prophet *Jeremie* <sup>e</sup>), which will make the Fear- <sup>e</sup> Jer. 10. 7. lesse Sinner inexcusable: Who would not feare thee O Lord, thou King of Nations, thou King of Saints? 1. For thou onely art Holy: 2. For all Nations shall come vnto thee, and worship thee: 3. For thy iudgements are made manifest <sup>f</sup>: 4. For there is none like <sup>f</sup> Reuel. 15. 4. vnto thee, that pardoneth Iniquitie, and passeth by the <sup>g</sup> Mic. 7. 18. Transgression of the remnant of thy Heritage &? Who would not Feare Thee such an Almighty, All-seeing, Iust, Mercifull Lord God? Put thy feare therefore <sup>h</sup> Ier. 32. 39. in our Hearts (as thou hast promised <sup>h</sup>) that wee may neuer depart from thee; but clinging inseparably by a liuely faith, vnto the bleeding wounds of our Blessed Redeemer, may without all flauish Feare <sup>i</sup> of Death and Iudgement, Louingly <sup>k</sup> appeare before thy Iudgement-seat, and without desperate Crying to the mountains and rocks Fall on vs <sup>l</sup>, may ioyfully heare Thee say vnto vs: Come ye Blessed of my Father, Inherit the Kingdome prepared for you from the foundation of the world <sup>m</sup>.

Which God grant vnto vs all, for the All-sufficient Merits of his Dearest Sonne, the Sweet Lord Iesus: To whom with Himselfe and the Holy Spirit be ascribed All Praise, Honour, Glory, Power, Dominion and Maiestie, now and euer. Amen. Amen.

V.  
Reasons to  
feare the  
Lord.

VI.  
Prayer for  
Godly Feare.

<sup>i</sup> Si enim amamus Christum, utiq; aduentum eius desiderare debemus. Peruersum enim est, & nescio utrum verum, quem diligis, timere ne veniat, orare, Veniat regnum tuum, & timere, ne exaudias. Vnde autem timor? --- Quisquis ergo futurum indicet tuis, presente conscientia tua corripit. S. Aug. in Psal. 147. 100. 8.  
<sup>k</sup> 2 Tim. 4. 8.  
<sup>l</sup> Reuel. 6. 16.  
<sup>m</sup> Mat. 25. 34.

FINIS.

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